

The Works of
William
Shakespeare
Volume I



Edited by
William George Clark
and
William Aldis Wright

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE MERRY
WIVES OF WINDSOR ***

These texts of *The Merry Wives of Windsor* are from Volume I of the nine-volume 1863 Cambridge edition of Shakespeare. The editors' preface ([e-text 23041](#)) and the other plays from this volume are each available as separate e-texts.

General Notes are in their original location at the end of the Folio text, followed by the text-critical notes originally printed at the bottom of each page. All notes are hyperlinked in both directions. In dialogue, a link from a speaker's name generally means that the note applies to the entire line or group of lines. The Quarto text is given separately, after all Notes.

Line numbers—shown in the right margin and used for all notes—are from the original text. In prose passages the exact line counts will depend on your browser settings, and will probably be different from the displayed numbers. Stage directions were not included in the line numbering.

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[Introduction](#)
[Standard Text](#) (folios and later)
[Text of First Quarto](#)

THE WORKS

OF

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE

EDITED BY

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- [Introduction](#)

[*The Merry Wives of Windsor*](#)

[Dramatis Personæ](#)

Act I [Scene 1](#) Windsor. Before Page's house.

[Scene 2](#) The same.

[Scene 3](#) A room in the Garter Inn.

[Scene 4](#) A room in Doctor Caius's house.

Act II [Scene 1](#) Before Page's house.

[Scene 2](#) A room in the Garter Inn.

[Scene 3](#) A field near Windsor.

Act III [Scene 1](#) A field near Frogmore.

[Scene 2](#) The street, in Windsor.

[Scene 3](#) A room in Ford's house.

[Scene 4](#) A room in Page's house.

[Scene 5](#) A room in the Garter Inn.

Act IV [Scene 1](#) A street.

[Scene 2](#) A room in Ford's house.

[Scene 3](#) A room in the Garter Inn.

[Scene 4](#) A room in Ford's house.

[Scene 5](#) A room in the Garter Inn.

[Scene 6](#) The same. Another room in the Garter Inn.

Act V [Scene 1](#) A room in the Garter Inn.

[Scene 2](#) Windsor Park.

[Scene 3](#) A street leading to the Park.

[Scene 4](#) Windsor Park.

[Scene 5](#) Another part of the Park.

[Notes](#)

[Critical Apparatus](#) ("Linenotes") for main text

[*A Pleasant Conceited Comedy of Syr John Falstaffe, &c.*](#)

(*The Merry Wives of Windsor*, First Quarto text)

[Critical Apparatus](#) ("Linenotes") for Quarto text

[Texts Used](#) (from general preface)

THE

MERRY WIVES OF WINDSOR.

BESIDES the copies of the *Merry Wives of Windsor* appearing in the folios and modern editions, a quarto, Q₃, has been collated in these Notes, of which the following is the title:

The | Merry Wives | of Windsor. | with the humours of Sir *John Falstaffe*, | as also, The swaggering Vaine of Ancient | *Pistoll*, and Corporall *Nym*. | WRITTEN BY *William Shake-speare*. | Newly corrected. | LONDON: | printed by *T. H.* for *R. Meighen* and are to be sold | at his Shop, next to the Middle-Temple Gate, and in | *S. Dunstan's* Church-yard in *Fleet Street*. | 1630.

Q₁ and Q₂ are editions of an early sketch of the same play. The variations between the text of these quartos and the received text are so great that collation cannot be attempted. The text printed at the end of the play is taken *literatim* from Q₁, the edition of 1602, of which a copy is preserved among Capell's SHAKESPEARIANA, and this text is collated *verbatim* with Q₂, the second quarto printed in 1619. Q₁ was reprinted in 1842 for the Shakespeare Society by Mr J. O. Halliwell. This text, which differs in one or two places from Capell's Q₁, has also been collated. Q₂ is given among TWENTY OF THE PLAYS OF SHAKESPEARE, edited by Steevens. Their titles are as follows:

(1) A | Most pleasaunt and | excellent conceited Co-|medie, of Syr *John Falstaffe*, and the | Merrie Wiues of *Windsor*. | Enter-mixed with sundrie | variable and pleasing humors of Syr *Hugh* | the Welch Knight, Justice *Shallow*, and his | wise Cousin M. *Slender*. | With the Swaggering vaine of Auncient | *Pistoll*, and Corporall *Nym*. | By *William Shakespeare*. | As it

hath been diuers times Acted by the right Honorable | my Lord
Chamberlaines seruants. Both before her | Maiestie, and else-where. |
London. | Printed by T. C. for Arthur Johnson, and are to be sold at | his
shop in Powles Church-yard, at the signe of the | Flower de Leuse and the
Crowne. | 1602.

[This consists of 7 Quires of 4. In the Quire G one line, which we have
included in brackets, has been cut away by the binder. We have supplied it
from Halliwell's edition and Q₂.]

(2) A | Most pleasant and ex-|cellent Comedy, | *of Sir John Falstaffe, and
the | merry Wives of Windsor.* | With the swaggering vaine of An|cient
Pistoll, and Corporall Nym. | Written by W. SHAKESPEARE. | Printed for
Arthur Johnson, 1619.

-

DRAMATIS PERSONÆ. ¹

SIR JOHN FALSTAFF.

FENTON, a gentleman.

SHALLOW, a country justice.

SLENDER, cousin to Shallow.

FORD, }
PAGE, } two gentlemen dwelling at Windsor.

WILLIAM PAGE, a boy, son to Page.

SIR HUGH EVANS, a Welsh parson.

DOCTOR CAIUS, a French physician.

Host of the Garter Inn.

BARDOLPH,
PISTOL, } sharpers attending on Falstaff.
NYM,

ROBIN, page to Falstaff.

SIMPLE, servant to Slender.

RUGBY, servant to Doctor Caius.

MISTRESS FORD.

MISTRESS PAGE.

ANNE PAGE, her daughter.

MISTRESS QUICKLY, servant to Doctor Caius.

Servants to Page, Ford, &c.

SCENE—Windsor, and the neighbourhood.

[1.](#) Not in Qq Ff. Inserted by Rowe.

THE

MERRY WIVES OF WINDSOR.

ACT I.

I. 1 SCENE I. *Windsor. Before PAGE's house.*

Enter JUSTICE SHALLOW, SLENDER, *and* SIR HUGH EVANS.

Shal. Sir Hugh, persuade me not; I will make a Star-chamber matter of it: if he were twenty Sir John Falstaffs, he shall not abuse Robert Shallow, esquire.

Slen. In the county of Gloucester, justice of peace 5 and 'Coram.'

Shal. Ay, cousin Slender, and 'Custalorum.'

Slen. Ay, and 'Rato-lorum' too; and a gentleman born, master parson; who writes himself 'Armigero,' in any bill, warrant, quittance, or obligation, 'Armigero.'

10 *Shal.* Ay, that I do; and have done any time these three hundred years.

Slen. All his successors gone before him hath done't; and all his ancestors that come after him may: they may 15 give the dozen white luses in their coat.

Shal. It is an old coat.

Evans. The dozen white louses do become an old coat well; it agrees well, passant; it is a familiar beast to man, and signifies love.

Shal. The luce is the fresh fish; the salt fish is an 20 old coat.

Slen. I may quarter, coz.

Shal. You may, by marrying.

Evans. It is marring indeed, if he quarter it.

Shal. Not a whit.

I. 1.

25 *Evans.* Yes, py'r lady; if he has a quarter of your coat, there is but three skirts for yourself, in my simple conjectures: but that is all one. If Sir John Falstaff have committed disparagements unto you, I am of the church, and will be glad to do my benevolence to make atonements and 30 compremises between you.

Shal. The council shall hear it; it is a riot.

Evans. It is not meet the council hear a riot; there is no fear of Got in a riot: the council, look you, shall desire to hear the fear of Got, and not to hear a riot; take your 35 vizaments in that.

Shal. Ha! o' my life, if I were young again, the sword should end it.

Evans. It is petter that friends is the sword, and end it: and there is also another device in my prain, which peradventure 40 prings goot discretions with it:—there is Anne Page, which is daughter to Master Thomas Page, which is pretty virginity.

Slen. Mistress Anne Page? She has brown hair, and speaks small like a woman.

45 *Evans.* It is that fery person for all the orld, as just as you will desire; and seven hundred pounds of moneys, and gold and silver, is her grandsire upon his death's-bed (Got deliver to a joyful resurrections!) give, when she is able to overtake seventeen years old: it were a goot motion if we I. 1.

50 leave our pribbles and prabbles, and desire a marriage between Master Abraham and Mistress Anne Page.

Slen. Did her grandsire leave her seven hundred pound?

Evans. Ay, and her father is make her a petter penny.

Slen. I know the young gentlewoman; she has good 55 gifts.

Evans. Seven hundred pounds and possibilities is good gifts.

Shal. Well, let us see honest Master Page. Is Falstaff there?

60 Evans. Shall I tell you a lie? I do despise a liar as I do despise one that is false, or as I despise one that is not true. The knight, Sir John, is there; and, I beseech you, be ruled by your well-willers. I will peat the door for Master Page. [*Knocks*] What, ho! Got pless your house here!

65 Page. [*Within*] Who's there?

Enter PAGE.

Evans. Here is Got's plessing, and your friend, and Justice Shallow; and here young Master Slender, that peradventures shall tell you another tale, if matters grow to your likings.

70 Page. I am glad to see your worships well. I thank you for my venison, Master Shallow.

Shal. Master Page, I am glad to see you: much good do it your good heart! I wished your venison better; it was ill killed. How doth good Mistress Page?—and I I. 1.

75 thank you always with my heart, la! with my heart.

Page. Sir, I thank you.

Shal. Sir, I thank you; by yea and no, I do.

Page. I am glad to see you, good Master Slender.

Slen. How does your fallow greyhound, sir? I heard 80 say he was outrun on Cotsall.

Page. It could not be judged, sir.

Slen. You'll not confess, you'll not confess.

Shal. That he will not. 'Tis your fault, 'tis your fault; 'tis a good dog.

85 Page. A cur, sir.

Shal. Sir, he's a good dog, and a fair dog: can there be more said? he is good and fair. Is Sir John Falstaff here?

Page. Sir, he is within; and I would I could do a good office between you.

90 *Evans.* It is spoke as a Christians ought to speak.

Shal. He hath wronged me, Master Page.

Page. Sir, he doth in some sort confess it.

Shal. If it be confessed, it is not redressed: is not that so, Master Page? He hath wronged me; indeed he hath; 95 at a word, he hath, believe me: Robert Shallow, esquire, saith, he is wronged.

Page. Here comes Sir John.

Enter SIR JOHN FALSTAFF, BARDOLPH, NYM, and PISTOL.

Fal. Now, Master Shallow, you'll complain of me to the king?

I. 1.

100 *Shal.* Knight, you have beaten my men, killed my deer, and broke open my lodge.

Fal. But not kissed your keeper's daughter?

Shal. Tut, a pin! this shall be answered.

Fal. I will answer it straight; I have done all this.

105 That is now answered.

Shal. The council shall know this.

Fal. 'Twere better for you if it were known in counsel: you'll be laughed at.

Evans. Pauca verba, Sir John; goot worts.

110 *Fal.* Good worts! good cabbage. Slender, I broke your head: what matter have you against me?

Slen. Marry, sir, I have matter in my head against you; and against your cony-catching rascals, Bardolph, Nym, and Pistol.

115 *Bard.* You Banbury cheese!

Slen. Ay, it is no matter.

Pist. How now, Mephostophilus!

Slen. Ay, it is no matter.

Nym. Slice, I say! pauca, pauca: slice! that's my 120 humour.

Slen. Where's Simple, my man? Can you tell, cousin?

Evans. Peace, I pray you. Now let us understand. There is three umpires in this matter, as I understand; I. 1.

125 that is, Master Page, fidelicet Master Page; and there is myself, fidelicet myself; and the three party is, lastly and finally, mine host of the Garter.

Page. We three, to hear it and end it between them.

Evans. Fery goot: I will make a prief of it in my 130 note-book; and we will afterwards ork upon the cause with as great discreetly as we can.

Fal. Pistol!

Pist. He hears with ears.

Evans. The tevil and his tam! what phrase is this, 'He 135 hears with ear'? why, it is affectations.

Fal. Pistol, did you pick Master Slender's purse?

Slen. Ay, by these gloves, did he, or I would I might never come in mine own great chamber again else, of seven groats in mill-sixpences, and two Edward shovel-boards, 140 that cost me two shilling and two pence a-piece of Yead Miller, by these gloves.

Fal. Is this true, Pistol?

Evans. No; it is false, if it is a pick-purse.

145 *Pist.* Ha, thou mountain-foreigner! Sir John and master mine, I combat challenge of this latten bilbo.

Word of denial in thy labras here!

Word of denial: froth and scum, thou liest!

Slen. By these gloves, then, 'twas he.

I. 1.

150 *Nym.* Be avised, sir, and pass good humours: I will say 'marry trap' with you, if you run the nuthook's humour on me; that is the very note of it.

Slen. By this hat, then, he in the red face had it; for though I cannot remember what I did when you made me 155 drunk, yet I am not altogether an ass.

Fal. What say you, Scarlet and John?

Bard. Why, sir, for my part, I say the gentleman had drunk himself out of his five sentences.

Evans. It is his five senses: fie, what the ignorance is!

160 *Bard.* And being fap, sir, was, as they say, cashiered; and so conclusions passed the careires.

Slen. Ay, you spake in Latin then too; but 'tis no matter: I'll ne'er be drunk whilst I live again, but in honest, civil, godly company, for this trick: if I be drunk, 165 I'll be drunk with those that have the fear of God, and not with drunken knaves.

Evans. So Got udge me, that is a virtuous mind.

Fal. You hear all these matters denied, gentlemen; you hear it.

Enter ANNE PAGE, with wine; MISTRESS FORD and MISTRESS PAGE, following.

170 *Page.* Nay, daughter, carry the wine in; we'll drink within.

[Exit Anne Page.]

Slen. O heaven! this is Mistress Anne Page.

Page. How now, Mistress Ford!

Fal. Mistress Ford, by my troth, you are very well I. 1.

175 met: by your leave, good mistress.

[Kisses her.]

Page. Wife, bid these gentlemen welcome. Come, we have a hot venison pasty to dinner: come, gentlemen, I hope we shall drink down all unkindness.

[Exeunt all except Shal., Slen., and Evans.]

Slen. I had rather than forty shillings I had my Book 180 of Songs and Sonnets here.

Enter SIMPLE.

How now, Simple! where have you been? I must wait on myself, must I? You have not the Book of Riddles about you, have you?

Sim. Book of Riddles! why, did you not lend it to 185 Alice Shortcake upon All-hallowmas last, a fortnight afore Michaelmas?

Shal. Come, coz; come, coz; we stay for you. A word with you, coz; marry, this, coz: there is, as 'twere, a tender, a kind of tender, made afar off by Sir Hugh here. Do 190 you understand me?

Slen. Ay, sir, you shall find me reasonable; if it be so, I shall do that that is reason.

Shal. Nay, but understand me.

Slen. So I do, sir.

195 *Evans.* Give ear to his motions, Master Slender: I will description the matter to you, if you be capacity of it.

Slen. Nay, I will do as my cousin Shallow says: I pray you, pardon me; he's a justice of peace in his country, simple though I stand here.

I. 1.

200 *Evans.* But that is not the question: the question is concerning your marriage.

Shal. Ay, there's the point, sir.

Evans. Marry, is it; the very point of it; to Mistress Anne Page.

205 *Slen.* Why, if it be so, I will marry her upon any reasonable demands.

Evans. But can you affection the 'oman? Let us command to know that of your mouth or of your lips; for divers philosophers hold that the lips is parcel of the mouth. 210 Therefore, precisely, can you carry your good will to the maid?

Shal. Cousin Abraham Slender, can you love her?

Slen. I hope, sir, I will do as it shall become one that would do reason.

215 *Evans.* Nay, Got's lords and his ladies! you must speak possitable, if you can carry her your desires towards her.

Shal. That you must. Will you, upon good dowry, marry her?

220 *Slen.* I will do a greater thing than that, upon your request, cousin, in any reason.

Shal. Nay, conceive me, conceive me, sweet coz: what I do is to pleasure you, coz. Can you love the maid?

Slen. I will marry her, sir, at your request: but if there I. 1.
225 be no great love in the beginning, yet heaven may decrease it upon better acquaintance, when we are married and have more occasion to know one another; I hope, upon familiarity will grow more contempt: but if you say, 'Marry her,' I will marry her; that I am freely dissolved, and dissolutely.

230 *Evans.* It is a fery discretion answer; save the fall is in the ort 'dissolutely:' the ort is, according to our meaning, 'resolutely:' his meaning is good.

Shal. Ay, I think my cousin meant well.

Slen. Ay, or else I would I might be hanged, la!

235 *Shal.* Here comes fair Mistress Anne.

Re-enter ANNE PAGE.

Would I were young for your sake, Mistress Anne!

Anne. The dinner is on the table; my father desires your worships' company.

Shal. I will wait on him, fair Mistress Anne.

240 *Evans.* Od's plessed will! I will not be absence at the grace.

[*Exeunt Shallow and Evans.*]

Anne. Will't please your worship to come in, sir?

Slen. No, I thank you, forsooth, heartily; I am very well.

245 *Anne.* The dinner attends you, sir.

Slen. I am not a-hungry, I thank you, forsooth. Go, sirrah, for all you are my man, go wait upon my cousin Shallow. [*Exit Simple.*]

A justice of peace sometimes may be beholding to his friend for a man. I keep but I. 1.

250 three men and a boy yet, till my mother be dead: but what though? yet I live like a poor gentleman born.

Anne. I may not go in without your worship: they will not sit till you come.

Slen. I' faith, I'll eat nothing; I thank you as much as 255 though I did.

Anne. I pray you, sir, walk in.

Slen. I had rather walk here, I thank you. I bruised my shin th' other day with playing at sword and dagger with a master of fence; three veney's for a dish of stewed 260 prunes; and, by my troth, I cannot abide the smell of hot meat since. Why do your dogs bark so? be there bears i' the town?

Anne. I think there are, sir; I heard them talked of.

Slen. I love the sport well; but I shall as soon quarrel 265 at it as any man in England. You are afraid, if you see the bear loose, are you not?

Anne. Ay, indeed, sir.

Slen. That's meat and drink to me, now. I have seen Sackerson loose twenty times, and have taken him by the 270 chain; but, I warrant you, the women have so cried and shrieked at it, that it passed: but women, indeed, cannot abide 'em; they are very ill-favoured rough things.

Re-enter PAGE.

Page. Come, gentle Master Slender, come; we stay for you.

I. 1.

275 *Slen.* I'll eat nothing, I thank you, sir.

Page. By cock and pie, you shall not choose, sir! come, come.

Slen. Nay, pray you, lead the way.

Page. Come on, sir.

280 *Slen.* Mistress Anne, yourself shall go first.

Anne. Not I, sir; pray you, keep on.

Slen. Truly, I will not go first; truly, la! I will not do you that wrong.

Anne. I pray you, sir.

285 *Slen.* I'll rather be unmannerly than troublesome. You do yourself wrong, indeed, la!

[*Exeunt.*

I. 2 SCENE II. *The same.*

Enter SIR HUGH EVANS and SIMPLE.

Evans. Go your ways, and ask of Doctor Caius' house which is the way: and there dwells one Mistress Quickly, which is in the manner of his nurse, or his dry nurse, or his cook, or his laundry, his washer, and his wringer.

5 *Sim.* Well, sir.

Evans. Nay, it is petter yet. Give her this letter; for it is a 'oman that altogether's acquaintance with Mistress Anne Page: and the letter is, to desire and require her to solicit your master's desires to Mistress Anne Page. I 10 pray you, be gone: I will make an end of my dinner; there's pippins and cheese to come.

[*Exeunt.*

I. 3 SCENE III. *A room in the Garter Inn.*

Enter FALSTAFF, Host, BARDOLPH, NYM, PISTOL, and ROBIN.

Fal. Mine host of the Garter!

Host. What says my bully-rook? speak scholarly and wisely.

Fal. Truly, mine host, I must turn away some of my 5 followers.

Host. Discard, bully Hercules; cashier: let them wag; trot, trot.

Fal. I sit at ten pounds a week.

Host. Thou'rt an emperor, Cæsar, Keisar, and Pheezer. 10 I will entertain Bardolph; he shall draw, he shall tap: said I well, bully Hector?

Fal. Do so, good mine host.

Host. I have spoke; let him follow. [*To Bard.*] Let me see thee froth and lime: I am at a word; follow. [*Exit.*

15 *Fal.* Bardolph, follow him. A tapster is a good trade: an old cloak makes a new jerkin; a withered serving-man a fresh tapster. Go; adieu.

Bard. It is a life that I have desired: I will thrive.

Pist. O base Hungarian wight! wilt thou the spigot 20 wield?

[*Exit Bardolph.*

Nym. He was gotten in drink: is not the humour conceited?

Fal. I am glad I am so acquitt of this tinder-box: his thefts were too open; his filching was like an unskilful 1. 3.
25 singer; he kept not time.

Nym. The good humour is to steal at a minute's rest.

Pist. 'Convey,' the wise it call. 'Steal!' foh! a fico for the phrase!

Fal. Well, sirs, I am almost out at heels.

30 *Pist.* Why, then, let kibes ensue.

Fal. There is no remedy; I must cony-catch; I must shift.

Pist. Young ravens must have food.

Fal. Which of you know Ford of this town?

35 *Pist.* I ken the wight: he is of substance good.

Fal. My honest lads, I will tell you what I am about.

Pist. Two yards, and more.

Fal. No quips now, Pistol! Indeed, I am in the waist two yards about; but I am now about no waste; I am 40 about thrift. Briefly, I do mean to make love to Ford's wife: I spy entertainment in her; she discourses, she carves, she gives the leer of invitation: I can construe the action of her familiar style; and the hardest voice of her behaviour, to be Englished rightly, is, 'I am Sir John Falstaff's.'

45 *Pist.* He hath studied her will, and translated her will, out of honesty into English.

Nym. The anchor is deep: will that humour pass?

Fal. Now, the report goes she has all the rule of her husband's purse: he hath a legion of angels.

1. 3.

50 *Pist.* As many devils entertain; and 'To her, boy,' say I.

Nym. The humour rises; it is good: humour me the angels.

Fal. I have writ me here a letter to her: and here another to Page's wife, who even now gave me good eyes 55 too, examined my parts with most judicious œillades; sometimes the beam of her view gilded my foot, sometimes my portly belly.

Pist. Then did the sun on dunghill shine.

Nym. I thank thee for that humour.

60 *Fal.* O, she did so course o'er my exteriors with such a greedy intention, that the appetite of her eye did seem to scorch me up like a burning-glass! Here's another letter to her: she bears the purse too; she is a region in Guiana, all gold and bounty. I will be cheaters to them both, and 65 they shall be exchequers to me; they shall be my East and West Indies, and I will trade to them both. Go bear thou this letter to Mistress Page; and thou this to Mistress Ford: we will thrive, lads, we will thrive.

Pist. Shall I Sir Pandarus of Troy become,
70 And by my side wear steel? then, Lucifer take all!

Nym. I will run no base humour: here, take the humour-letter: I will keep the haviour of reputation.

Fal. [*To Robin*] Hold, sirrah, bear you these letters tightly:
Sail like my pinnacle to these golden shores.

I. 3.

75 Rogues, hence, avaunt! vanish like hailstones, go;
Trudge, plod away o' the hoof; seek shelter, pack!
Falstaff will learn the humour of the age,
French thrift, you rogues; myself and skirted page.

[Exeunt Falstaff and Robin.]

Pist. Let vultures gripe thy guts! for gourd and fullam holds,
80 And high and low beguiles the rich and poor:
Tester I'll have in pouch when thou shalt lack,
Base Phrygian Turk!

Nym. I have operations which be humours of revenge.

Pist. Wilt thou revenge?

85 *Nym.* By welkin and her star!

Pist. With wit or steel?

Nym. With both the humours, I:
I will discuss the humour of this love to Page.

Pist. And I to Ford shall eke unfold
90 How Falstaff, varlet vile,
His dove will prove, his gold will hold,
And his soft couch defile.

Nym. My humour shall not cool: I will incense Page to deal with
poison; I will possess him with yellowness, for 95 the revolt of mine
is dangerous: that is my true humour.

Pist. Thou art the Mars of malecontents: I second thee; troop on.

[*Exeunt.*

I. 4 SCENE IV. *A room in DOCTOR CAIUS's house.*

Enter MISTRESS QUICKLY, SIMPLE, *and* RUGBY.

Quick. What, John Rugby! I pray thee, go to the casement, and see
if you can see my master, Master Doctor Caius, coming. If he do, i'
faith, and find any body in the house, here will be an old abusing of
God's 5 patience and the king's English.

Rug. I'll go watch.

Quick. Go; and we'll have a posset for't soon at night, in faith, at the
latter end of a sea-coal fire. [*Exit Rugby.*] An honest, willing, kind
fellow, as ever servant shall come 10 in house withal; and, I warrant
you, no tell-tale nor no breed-bate: his worst fault is, that he is given
to prayer; he is something peevish that way: but nobody but has his
fault; but let that pass. Peter Simple, you say your name is?

Sim. Ay, for fault of a better.

15 *Quick.* And Master Slender's your master?

Sim. Ay, forsooth.

Quick. Does he not wear a great round beard, like a glover's paring-knife?

Sim. No, forsooth: he hath but a little wee face, with 20 a little yellow beard,—a Cain-coloured beard.

Quick. A softly-sprighted man, is he not?

Sim. Ay, forsooth: but he is as tall a man of his hands as any is between this and his head; he hath fought with a warrener.

I. 4.

25 *Quick.* How say you?—O, I should remember him: does he not hold up his head, as it were, and strut in his gait?

Sim. Yes, indeed, does he.

Quick. Well, heaven send Anne Page no worse fortune! Tell Master Parson Evans I will do what I can 30 for your master: Anne is a good girl, and I wish—

Re-enter RUGBY.

Rug. Out, alas! here comes my master.

Quick. We shall all be shent. Run in here, good young man; go into this closet: he will not stay long. [Shuts Simple in the closet.] What, John Rugby! John! 35 what, John, I say! Go, John, go inquire for my master; I doubt he be not well, that he comes not home.

[*Singing*] And down, down, adown-a, &c.

Enter DOCTOR CAIUS.

Caius. Vat is you sing? I do not like des toys. Pray you, go and vetch me in my closet un boitier vert,—a box, 40 a green-a box: do intend vat I speak? a green-a box.

Quick. Ay, forsooth; I'll fetch it you. [*Aside*] I am glad he went not in himself: if he had found the young man, he would have been horn-mad.

Caius. Fe, fe, fe, fe! ma foi, il fait fort chaud. Je 45 m'en vais à la cour,—la grande affaire.

Quick. Is it this, sir?

Caius. Oui; mette le au mon pocket: dépêche, quickly. Vere is dat knave Rugby?

Quick. What, John Rugby! John!

I. 4.

50 *Rug.* Here, sir!

Caius. You are John Rugby, and you are Jack Rugby. Come, take-a your rapier, and come after my heel to the court.

Rug. 'Tis ready, sir, here in the porch.

55 *Caius.* By my trot, I tarry too long. —Od's me! Qu'ai-j'oublié! dere is some simples in my closet, dat I vill not for the varld I shall leave behind.

Quick. Ay me, he'll find the young man there, and be mad!

60 *Caius.* O diable, diable! vat is in my closet? Villain! larron! [Pulling Simple out.] Rugby, my rapier!

Quick. Good master, be content.

Caius. Wherefore shall I be content-a?

Quick. The young man is an honest man.

65 *Caius.* What shall de honest man do in my closet? dere is no honest man dat shall come in my closet.

Quick. I beseech you, be not so phlegmatic. Hear the truth of it: he came of an errand to me from Parson Hugh.

Caius. Vell.

70 *Sim.* Ay, forsooth; to desire her to—

Quick. Peace, I pray you.

Caius. Peace-a your tongue. Speak-a your tale.

Sim. To desire this honest gentlewoman, your maid, to speak a good word to Mistress Anne Page for my I. 4.

75 master in the way of marriage.

Quick. This is all, indeed, la! but I'll ne'er put my finger in the fire, and need not.

Caius. Sir Hugh send-a you? Rugby, baille me some paper. Tarry you a little-a while. [Writes.]

80 *Quick.* [Aside to Simple] I am glad he is so quiet: if he had been throughly moved, you should have heard him so loud and so melancholy. But notwithstanding, man, I'll do you your master what good I can: and the very yea and the no is, the French doctor, my master,—I 85 may call him my master, look you, for I keep his house; and I wash, wring, brew, bake, scour, dress meat and drink, make the beds, and do all myself,—

Sim. [Aside to Quickly] 'Tis a great charge to come under one body's hand.

90 *Quick.* [Aside to Simple] Are you avised o' that? you shall find it a great charge: and to be up early and down late;—but notwithstanding,—to tell you in your ear; I would have no words of it,—my master himself is in love with Mistress Anne Page: but notwithstanding that, I know 95 Anne's mind,—that's neither here nor there.

Caius. You jack'nape, give-a this letter to Sir Hugh; by gar, it is a shallenge: I will cut his troat in de park; and I will teach a scurvy jack-a-nape priest to meddle or make. You may be gone; it is not good you tarry here. —By I. 4.

100 gar, I will cut all his two stones; by gar, he shall not have a stone to throw at his dog.

[Exit Simple.]

Quick. Alas, he speaks but for his friend.

Caius. It is no matter-a ver dat:—do not you tell-a me dat I shall have Anne Page for myself?—By gar, I vill 105 kill de Jack priest; and I have appointed mine host of de Jarteer to measure our weapon:—By gar, I will myself have Anne Page.

Quick. Sir, the maid loves you, and all shall be well. We must give folks leave to prate: what, the good-jer!

110 *Caius.* Rugby, come to the court with me. By gar, if I have not Anne Page, I shall turn your head out of my door. Follow my heels, Rugby.

[Exeunt Caius and Rugby.]

Quick. You shall have An fool's-head of your own. No, I know Anne's mind for that: never a woman in 115 Windsor knows more of Anne's mind than I do; nor can do more than I do with her, I thank heaven.

Fent. *[Within]* Who's within there? ho!

Quick. Who's there, I trow? Come near the house, I pray you.

Enter FENTON.

120 *Fent.* How now, good woman! how dost thou?

Quick. The better that it pleases your good worship to ask.

Fen. What news? how does pretty Mistress Anne?

Quick. In truth, sir, and she is pretty, and honest, and I. 4.
125 gentle; and one that is your friend, I can tell you that by the way; I praise heaven for it.

Fent. Shall I do any good, thinkest thou? shall I not lose my suit?

Quick. Troth, sir, all is in his hands above: but notwithstanding, 130 Master Fenton, I'll be sworn on a book, she loves you. Have not your worship a wart above your eye?

Fent. Yes, marry, have I; what of that?

Quick. Well, thereby hangs a tale:—good faith, it is such another Nan; but, I detest, an honest maid as ever ¹³⁵ broke bread:—we had an hour’s talk of that wart. —I shall never laugh but in that maid’s company!—But, indeed, she is given too much to allicholy and musing: but for you—well, go to.

Fent. Well, I shall see her to-day. Hold, there’s ¹⁴⁰ money for thee; let me have thy voice in my behalf: if thou seest her before me, commend me.

Quick. Will I? i’ faith, that we will; and I will tell your worship more of the wart the next time we have confidence; and of other wooers.

¹⁴⁵ *Fent.* Well, farewell; I am in great haste now.

Quick. Farewell to your worship. [*Exit Fenton.*] Truly, an honest gentleman: but Anne loves him not; for I know Anne’s mind as well as another does. —Out upon’t! what have I forgot? [*Exit.*

ACT II.

II. 1 SCENE I. *Before PAGE’s house.*

Enter MISTRESS PAGE, with a letter.

Mrs Page. What, have I scaped love-letters in the holiday-time of my beauty, and am I now a subject for them? Let me see. [*Reads:*

‘Ask me no reason why I love you; for though Love use Reason ⁵ for his physician, he admits him not for his counsellor. You are not young, no more am I; go to, then, there’s sympathy: you are merry, so am I; ha, ha! then there’s more sympathy: you love sack, and so do I; would you desire better sympathy? Let it suffice thee, Mistress Page,—at the least, if the love of soldier can suffice,—that ¹⁰ I love thee. I will not say, pity me, —’tis not a soldier-like phrase; but I say, love me. By me,

Thine own true knight,
By day or night,
Or any kind of light,
¹⁵ With all his might
For thee to fight, JOHN FALSTAFF.’

What a Herod of Jewry is this! O wicked, wicked world! One that is well-nigh worn to pieces with age to show himself a young gallant! What an unweighed behaviour hath 20 this Flemish drunkard picked—with the devil's name!—out of my conversation, that he dares in this manner assay me? Why, he hath not been thrice in my company! What should I say to him? I was then frugal of my mirth: Heaven forgive me! Why, I'll exhibit a bill in the II. 1.
25 parliament for the putting down of men. How shall I be revenged on him? for revenged I will be, as sure as his guts are made of puddings.

Enter MISTRESS FORD.

Mrs Ford. Mistress Page! trust me, I was going to your house.

30 *Mrs Page.* And, trust me, I was coming to you. You look very ill.

Mrs Ford. Nay, I'll ne'er believe that; I have to show to the contrary.

Mrs Page. Faith, but you do, in my mind.

35 *Mrs Ford.* Well, I do, then; yet, I say, I could show you to the contrary. O Mistress Page, give me some counsel!

Mrs Page. What's the matter, woman?

Mrs Ford. O woman, if it were not for one trifling respect, 40 I could come to such honour!

Mrs Page. Hang the trifle, woman! take the honour. What is it?—dispense with trifles;—what is it?

Mrs Ford. If I would but go to hell for an eternal moment or so, I could be knighted.

45 *Mrs Page.* What? thou liest! Sir Alice Ford! These knights will hack; and so thou shouldst not alter the article of thy gentry.

Mrs Ford. We burn daylight:—here, read, read; perceive how I might be knighted. I shall think the worse of II. 1.

50 fat men, as long as I have an eye to make difference of men's liking: and yet he would not swear; praised women's modesty; and

gave such orderly and well-behaved reproof to all uncomeliness, that I would have sworn his disposition would have gone to the truth of his words; but they do no 55 more adhere and keep place together than the Hundredth Psalm to the tune of 'Green Sleeves.' What tempest, I trow, threw this whale, with so many tuns of oil in his belly, ashore at Windsor? How shall I be revenged on him? I think the best way were to entertain him with 60 hope, till the wicked fire of lust have melted him in his own grease. Did you ever hear the like?

Mrs Page. Letter for letter, but that the name of Page and Ford differs! To thy great comfort in this mystery of ill opinions, here's the twin-brother of thy letter: 65 but let thine inherit first; for, I protest, mine never shall. I warrant he hath a thousand of these letters, writ with blank space for different names,—sure, more,—and these are of the second edition: he will print them, out of doubt; for he cares not what he puts into the press, when he would 70 put us two. I had rather be a giantess, and lie under Mount Pelion. Well, I will find you twenty lascivious turtles ere one chaste man.

Mrs Ford. Why, this is the very same; the very hand, the very words. What doth he think of us?

II. 1.

75 *Mrs Page.* Nay, I know not: it makes me almost ready to wrangle with mine own honesty. I'll entertain myself like one that I am not acquainted withal; for, sure, unless he know some strain in me, that I know not myself, he would never have boarded me in this fury.

80 *Mrs Ford.* 'Boarding,' call you it? I'll be sure to keep him above deck.

Mrs Page. So will I: if he come under my hatches, I'll never to sea again. Let's be revenged on him: let's appoint him a meeting; give him a show of comfort in his 85 suit, and lead him on with a fine-baited delay, till he hath pawned his horses to mine host of the Garter.

Mrs Ford. Nay, I will consent to act any villany against him, that may not sully the chariness of our honesty. O, that my husband saw this letter! it would give 90 eternal food to his jealousy.

Mrs Page. Why, look where he comes; and my good man too: he's as far from jealousy as I am from giving him cause; and that, I hope, is an unmeasurable distance.

95 *Mrs Ford.* You are the happier woman.

Mrs Page. Let's consult together against this greasy knight. Come hither. [They retire.]

Enter FORD, with PISTOL, and PAGE, with NYM.

Ford. Well, I hope it be not so.

Pist. Hope is a curtal dog in some affairs:

II. 1.

100 Sir John affects thy wife.

Ford. Why, sir, my wife is not young.

Pist. He wooes both high and low, both rich and poor,
Both young and old, one with another, Ford;
He loves the gallimaufry: Ford, perpend.

105 *Ford.* Love my wife!

Pist. With liver burning hot. Prevent, or go thou,
Like Sir Actæon he, with Ringwood at thy heels:
O, odious is the name!

Ford. What name, sir?

110 *Pist.* The horn, I say. Farewell.

Take heed; have open eye; for thieves do foot by night:
Take heed, ere summer comes, or cuckoo-birds do sing.

Away, Sir Corporal Nym!—

Believe it, Page; he speaks sense.

[Exit.]

115 *Ford.* [Aside] I will be patient; I will find out this.

Nym. [To Page] And this is true; I like not the humour of lying. He hath wronged me in some humours: I should have borne the humoured letter to her; but I have a sword, and it shall bite upon my necessity. He 120 loves your wife; there's the short and the long. My

name is Corporal Nym; I speak, and I avouch; 'tis true: my name is Nym, and Falstaff loves your wife. Adieu. I love not the humour of bread and cheese [and there's the humour of it]. Adieu. [Exit.

II. 1.

125 *Page*. 'The humour of it,' quoth 'a! here's a fellow frights English out of his wits.

Ford. I will seek out Falstaff.

Page. I never heard such a drawling, affecting rogue.

Ford. If I do find it:—well.

130 *Page*. I will not believe such a Cataian, though the priest o' the town commended him for a true man.

Ford. 'Twas a good sensible fellow:—well.

Page. How now, Meg!

[Mrs Page and Mrs Ford come forward.

Mrs Page. Whither go you, George? Hark you.

135 *Mrs Ford*. How now, sweet Frank! why art thou melancholy?

Ford. I melancholy! I am not melancholy. Get you home, go.

Mrs Ford. Faith, thou hast some crotchets in thy 140 head. Now, will you go, Mistress Page?

Mrs Page. Have with you. You'll come to dinner, George? [*Aside to Mrs Ford*] Look who comes yonder: she shall be our messenger to this paltry knight.

Mrs Ford. [*Aside to Mrs Page*] Trust me, I thought on 145 her: she'll fit it.

Enter MISTRESS QUICKLY.

Mrs Page. You are come to see my daughter Anne?

Quick. Ay, forsooth; and, I pray, how does good Mistress Anne?

Mrs Page. Go in with us and see: we have an hour's II. 1.
150 talk with you.

[Exeunt Mrs Page, Mrs Ford, and Mrs Quickly.]

Page. How now, Master Ford!

Ford. You heard what this knave told me, did you not?

Page. Yes: and you heard what the other told me?

Ford. Do you think there is truth in them?

155 *Page.* Hang 'em, slaves! I do not think the knight would offer it:
but these that accuse him in his intent towards our wives are a yoke
of his discarded men; very rogues, now they be out of service.

Ford. Were they his men?

160 *Page.* Marry, were they.

Ford. I like it never the better for that. Does he lie at the Garter?

Page. Ay, marry, does he. If he should intend this voyage toward my
wife, I would turn her loose to him; and 165 what he gets more of her
than sharp words, let it lie on my head.

Ford. I do not misdoubt my wife; but I would be loath to turn them
together. A man may be too confident: I would have nothing lie on
my head: I cannot be thus 170 satisfied.

Page. Look where my ranting host of the Garter comes: there is
either liquor in his pate, or money in his purse, when he looks so
merrily.

Enter Host.

How now, mine host!

II. 1.

175 *Host.* How now, bully-rook! thou'rt a gentleman. Cavaleiro-
justice, I say!

Enter SHALLOW.

Shal. I follow, mine host, I follow. Good even and twenty, good Master Page! Master Page, will you go with us? we have sport in hand.

180 *Host.* Tell him, cavaleiro-justice; tell him, bully-rook.

Shal. Sir, there is a fray to be fought between Sir Hugh the Welsh priest and Caius the French doctor.

Ford. Good mine host o' the Garter, a word with you.

[Drawing him aside.]

Host. What sayest thou, my bully-rook?

185 *Shal.* *[To Page]* Will you go with us to behold it? My merry host hath had the measuring of their weapons; and, I think, hath appointed them contrary places; for, believe me, I hear the parson is no jester. Hark, I will tell you what our sport shall be.

[They converse apart.]

Host. Hast thou no suit against my knight, my 190 guest-cavaleire?

Ford. None, I protest: but I'll give you a pottle of burnt sack to give me recourse to him, and tell him my name is Brook; only for a jest.

195 *Host.* My hand, bully; thou shalt have egress and regress;—said I well?—and thy name shall be Brook. It is a merry knight. Will you go, An-heires?

Shal. Have with you, mine host.

Page. I have heard the Frenchman hath good skill in II. 1.
200 his rapier.

Shal. Tut, sir, I could have told you more. In these times you stand on distance, your passes, stoccadoes, and I know not what: 'tis the heart, Master Page; 'tis here, 'tis here. I have seen the time, with my long sword I would 205 have made you four tall fellows skip like rats.

Host. Here, boys, here, here! shall we wag?

Page. Have with you. I had rather hear them scold than fight.

[Exeunt Host, Shal., and Page.]

Ford. Though Page be a secure fool, and stands so 210 firmly on his wife's frailty, yet I cannot put off my opinion so easily: she was in his company at Page's house; and what they made there, I know not. Well, I will look further into't: and I have a disguise to sound Falstaff. If I find her honest, I lose not my labour; if she be otherwise, 215 'tis labour well bestowed. [Exit.]

II. 2 SCENE II. *A room in the Garter Inn.*

Enter FALSTAFF and PISTOL.

Fal. I will not lend thee a penny.

Pist. Why, then the world's mine oyster,
Which I with sword will open.

Fal. Not a penny. I have been content, sir, you 5 should lay my countenance to pawn: I have grated upon my good friends for three reprieves for you and your coach-fellow Nym; or else you had looked through the grate, like a geminy of baboons. I am damned in hell for swearing to gentlemen my friends, you were good soldiers and 10 tall fellows; and when Mistress Bridget lost the handle of her fan, I took't upon mine honour thou hadst it not.

Pist. Didst not thou share? hadst thou not fifteen pence?

Fal. Reason, you rogue, reason: thinkest thou I'll endanger 15 my soul gratis? At a word, hang no more about me, I am no gibbet for you. Go. A short knife and a throng!—To your manor of Pickt-hatch! Go. You'll not bear a letter for me, you rogue! you stand upon your honour! Why, thou unconfinable baseness, it is as much as 20 I can do to keep the terms of my honour precise: I, I, I myself sometimes, leaving the fear of God on the left hand, and hiding mine honour in my necessity, am fain to shuffle, to hedge, and to lurch; and yet you, rogue, will ensconce your rags, your cat-a-mountain looks, your red-lattice II. 2.

25 phrases, and your bold-beating oaths, under the shelter of your honour! You will not do it, you!

Pist. I do relent: what would thou more of man?

Enter ROBIN.

Rob. Sir, here's a woman would speak with you.

Fal. Let her approach.

Enter MISTRESS QUICKLY.

30 *Quick.* Give your worship good morrow.

Fal. Good morrow, good wife.

Quick. Not so, an't please your worship.

Fal. Good maid, then.

Quick. I'll be sworn;

35 As my mother was, the first hour I was born.

Fal. I do believe the swearer. What with me?

Quick. Shall I vouchsafe your worship a word or two?

Fal. Two thousand, fair woman: and I'll vouchsafe thee the hearing.

40 *Quick.* There is one Mistress Ford, sir:—I pray, come a little nearer this ways:—I myself dwell with Master Doctor Caius,—

Fal. Well, on: Mistress Ford, you say,—

Quick. Your worship says very true:—I pray your 45 worship, come a little nearer this ways.

Fal. I warrant thee, nobody hears;—mine own people, mine own people.

Quick. Are they so? God bless them, and make them his servants!

II. 2.

50 *Fal.* Well, Mistress Ford;—what of her?

Quick. Why, sir, she's a good creature. —Lord, Lord! your worship's a wanton! Well, heaven forgive you and all of us, I pray!

Fal. Mistress Ford;—come, Mistress Ford,—

55 *Quick.* Marry, this is the short and the long of it; you have brought her into such a canaries as 'tis wonderful. The best courtier of them all, when the court lay at Windsor, could never have brought her to such a canary. Yet there has been knights, and lords, and gentlemen, with their 60 coaches; I warrant you, coach after coach, letter after letter, gift after gift; smelling so sweetly, all musk, and so rushling, I warrant you, in silk and gold; and in such alligant terms; and in such wine and sugar of the best and the fairest, that would have won any woman's heart; and, I 65 warrant you, they could never get an eye-wink of her: I had myself twenty angels given me this morning; but I defy all angels—in any such sort, as they say—but in the way of honesty: and, I warrant you, they could never get her so much as sip on a cup with the proudest of them all: and yet there has been earls, nay, which is more, pensioners; 70 but, I warrant you, all is one with her.

Fal. But what says she to me? be brief, my good she-Mercury.

Quick. Marry, she hath received your letter; for the 11. 2.
75 which she thanks you a thousand times; and she gives you to notify, that her husband will be absence from his house between ten and eleven.

Fal. Ten and eleven.

Quick. Ay, forsooth; and then you may come and see 80 the picture, she says, that you wot of: Master Ford, her husband, will be from home. Alas, the sweet woman leads an ill life with him! he's a very jealousy man: she leads a very frampold life with him, good heart.

Fal. Ten and eleven. Woman, commend me to her; 85 I will not fail her.

Quick. Why, you say well. But I have another messenger to your worship. Mistress Page hath her hearty commendations to you, too:

and let me tell you in your ear, she's as fartuous a civil modest wife, and one, I tell 90 you, that will not miss you morning nor evening prayer, as any is in Windsor, whoe'er be the other: and she bade me tell your worship that her husband is seldom from home; but, she hopes, there will come a time. I never knew a woman so dote upon a man: surely, I think you have 95 charms, la; yes, in truth.

Fal. Not I, I assure thee: setting the attraction of my good parts aside, I have no other charms.

Quick. Blessing on your heart for't!

Fal. But, I pray thee, tell me this: has Ford's wife 11. 2.
100 and Page's wife acquainted each other how they love me?

Quick. That were a jest indeed! they have not so little grace, I hope: that were a trick indeed! But Mistress Page would desire you to send her your little page, of all loves: her husband has a marvellous infection to the 105 little page; and, truly, Master Page is an honest man. Never a wife in Windsor leads a better life than she does: do what she will, say what she will, take all, pay all, go to bed when she list, rise when she list, all is as she will: and, truly, she deserves it; for if there be a kind woman in 110 Windsor, she is one. You must send her your page; no remedy.

Fal. Why, I will.

Quick. Nay, but do so, then: and, look you, he may come and go between you both; and, in any case, have a 115 nay-word, that you may know one another's mind, and the boy never need to understand any thing; for 'tis not good that children should know any wickedness: old folks, you know, have discretion, as they say, and know the world.

Fal. Fare thee well: commend me to them both: 120 there's my purse; I am yet thy debtor. Boy, go along with this woman. [*Exeunt Mistress Quickly and Robin.*] This news distracts me!

Pist. This punk is one of Cupid's carriers:
Clap on more sails; pursue; up with your fights:

II. 2.

125 Give fire: she is my prize, or ocean overwhelm them all!

[Exit.

Fal. Sayest thou so, old Jack? go thy ways; I'll make more of thy old body than I have done. Will they yet look after thee? Wilt thou, after the expense of so much money, be now a gainer? Good body, I thank thee. Let 130 them say 'tis grossly done; so it be fairly done, no matter.

Enter BARDOLPH.

Bard. Sir John, there's one Master Brook below would fain speak with you, and be acquainted with you; and hath sent your worship a morning's draught of sack.

Fal. Brook is his name?

135 *Bard.* Ay, sir.

Fal. Call him in. [Exit Bardolph.] Such Brooks are welcome to me, that o'erflow such liquor. Ah, ha! Mistress Ford and Mistress Page have I encompassed you? go to; via!

Re-enter BARDOLPH, with FORD disguised.

Ford. Bless you, sir!

140 *Fal.* And you, sir! Would you speak with me?

Ford. I make bold to press with so little preparation upon you.

Fal. You're welcome. What's your will?—Give us leave, drawer.

[Exit Bardolph.

145 *Ford.* Sir, I am a gentleman that have spent much; my name is Brook.

Fal. Good Master Brook, I desire more acquaintance of you.

Ford. Good Sir John, I sue for yours: not to charge II. 2.

150 you; for I must let you understand I think myself in better plight for a lender than you are: the which hath something emboldened me

to this unseasoned intrusion; for they say, if money go before, all ways do lie open.

Fal. Money is a good soldier, sir, and will on.

¹⁵⁵ *Ford.* Troth, and I have a bag of money here troubles me: if you will help to bear it, Sir John, take all, or half, for easing me of the carriage.

Fal. Sir, I know not how I may deserve to be your porter.

¹⁶⁰ *Ford.* I will tell you, sir, if you will give me the hearing.

Fal. Speak, good Master Brook: I shall be glad to be your servant.

Ford. Sir, I hear you are a scholar,—I will be brief with you,—and you have been a man long known to me, though ¹⁶⁵ I had never so good means, as desire, to make myself acquainted with you. I shall discover a thing to you, wherein I must very much lay open mine own imperfection: but, good Sir John, as you have one eye upon my follies, as you hear them unfolded, turn another into the register of your ¹⁷⁰ own; that I may pass with a reproof the easier, sith you yourself know how easy it is to be such an offender.

Fal. Very well, sir; proceed.

Ford. There is a gentlewoman in this town; her husband's name is Ford.

II. 2.

¹⁷⁵ *Fal.* Well, sir.

Ford. I have long loved her, and, I protest to you, bestowed much on her; followed her with a doting observance; engrossed opportunities to meet her; fee'd every slight occasion that could but niggardly give me sight of her; not only ¹⁸⁰ bought many presents to give her, but have given largely to many to know what she would have given; briefly, I have pursued her as love hath pursued me; which hath been on the wing of all occasions. But whatsoever I have merited, either in my mind or in my means, meed, I am sure, I have ¹⁸⁵ received none;

unless experience be a jewel that I have purchased at an infinite rate,
and that hath taught me to say this:

‘Love like a shadow flies when substance love pursues;
Pursuing that that flies, and flying what pursues.’

190 *Fal.* Have you received no promise of satisfaction at her hands?

Ford. Never.

Fal. Have you importuned her to such a purpose?

Ford. Never.

195 *Fal.* Of what quality was your love, then?

Ford. Like a fair house built on another man’s ground; so that I have
lost my edifice by mistaking the place where I erected it.

Fal. To what purpose have you unfolded this to me?

II. 2.

200 *Ford.* When I have told you that, I have told you all. Some say,
that though she appear honest to me, yet in other places she enlargeth
her mirth so far that there is shrewd construction made of her. Now,
Sir John, here is the heart of my purpose: you are a gentleman of
excellent 205 breeding, admirable discourse, of great admittance,
authentic in your place and person, generally allowed for your many
war-like, court-like, and learned preparations.

Fal. O, sir!

Ford. Believe it, for you know it. There is money; 210 spend it,
spend it; spend more; spend all I have; only give me so much of your
time in exchange of it, as to lay an amiable siege to the honesty of
this Ford’s wife: use your art of wooing; win her to consent to you: if
any man may, you may as soon as any.

215 *Fal.* Would it apply well to the vehemency of your affection, that
I should win what you would enjoy? Methinks you prescribe to
yourself very preposterously.

Ford. O, understand my drift. She dwells so securely on the
excellency of her honour, that the folly of my soul 220 dares not

present itself: she is too bright to be looked against. Now, could I come to her with any detection in my hand, my desires had instance and argument to commend themselves: I could drive her then from the ward of her purity, her reputation, her marriage-vow, and a thousand II. 2.

225 other her defences, which now are too, too strongly embattled against me. What say you to't, Sir John?

Fal. Master Brook, I will first make bold with your money; next, give me your hand; and last, as I am a gentleman, you shall, if you will, enjoy Ford's wife.

230 *Ford.* O good sir!

Fal. I say you shall.

Ford. Want no money, Sir John; you shall want none.

Fal. Want no Mistress Ford, Master Brook; you shall want none. I shall be with her, I may tell you, by her 235 own appointment; even as you came in to me, her assistant, or go-between, parted from me: I say I shall be with her between ten and eleven; for at that time the jealous rascally knave her husband will be forth. Come you to me at night; you shall know how I speed.

240 *Ford.* I am blest in your acquaintance. Do you know Ford, sir?

Fal. Hang him, poor cuckoldly knave! I know him not: —yet I wrong him to call him poor; they say the jealous wittolly knave hath masses of money; for the which his wife 245 seems to me well-favoured. I will use her as the key of the cuckoldly rogue's coffer; and there's my harvest-home.

Ford. I would you knew Ford, sir, that you might avoid him, if you saw him.

Fal. Hang him, mechanical salt-butter rogue! I will II. 2.

250 stare him out of his wits; I will awe him with my cudgel: it shall hang like a meteor o'er the cuckold's horns. Master Brook, thou shalt know I will predominate over the peasant, and thou shalt lie with his wife. —Come to me soon at night. Ford's a knave, and I will

aggravate his ²⁵⁵ style; thou, Master Brook, shalt know him for knave and cuckold. Come to me soon at night. [Exit.

Ford. What a damned Epicurean rascal is this! My heart is ready to crack with impatience. Who says this is improvident jealousy? my wife hath sent to him; the hour ²⁶⁰ is fixed; the match is made. Would any man have thought this? See the hell of having a false woman! My bed shall be abused, my coffers ransacked, my reputation gnawn at; and I shall not only receive this villanous wrong, but stand under the adoption of abominable terms, and by him ²⁶⁵ that does me this wrong. Terms! names!—Amaimon sounds well; Lucifer, well; Barbason, well; yet they are devils' additions, the names of fiends: but Cuckold! Wittol!—Cuckold! the devil himself hath not such a name. Page is an ass, a secure ass: he will trust his wife; he will not ²⁷⁰ be jealous. I will rather trust a Fleming with my butter, Parson Hugh the Welshman with my cheese, an Irishman with my aqua-vitæ bottle, or a thief to walk my ambling gelding, than my wife with herself: then she plots, then she ruminates, then she devises; and what they think in II. 2.

²⁷⁵ their hearts they may effect, they will break their hearts but they will effect. God be praised for my jealousy!—Eleven o'clock the hour. I will prevent this, detect my wife, be revenged on Falstaff, and laugh at Page. I will about it; better three hours too soon than a minute too ²⁸⁰ late. Fie, fie, fie! cuckold! cuckold! cuckold!

[Exit.

II. 3 SCENE III. *A field near Windsor.*

Enter CAIUS and RUGBY.

Caius. Jack Rugby!

Rug. Sir?

Caius. Vat is de clock, Jack?

Rug. Tis past the hour, sir, that Sir Hugh promised ⁵ to meet.

Caius. By gar, he has save his soul, dat he is no come; he has pray his Pible well, dat he is no come: by gar, Jack Rugby, he is dead already, if he be come.

Rug. He is wise, sir; he knew your worship would 10 kill him, if he came.

Caius. By gar, de herring is no dead so as I vill kill him. Take your rapier, Jack; I vill tell you how I vill kill him.

Rug. Alas, sir, I cannot fence.

15 *Caius.* Villainy, take your rapier.

Rug. Forbear; here's company.

Enter HOST, SHALLOW, SLENDER, *and* PAGE.

Host. Bless thee, bully doctor!

Shal. Save you, Master Doctor Caius!

Page. Now, good master doctor!

20 *Slen.* Give you good morrow, sir.

Caius. Vat be all you, one, two, tree, four, come for?

Host. To see thee fight, to see thee foin, to see thee traverse; to see thee here, to see thee there; to see thee pass thy punto, thy stock, thy reverse, thy distance, thy II. 3.

25 montant. Is he dead, my Ethiopian? is he dead, my Francisco? ha, bully! What says my Æsculapius? my Galen? my heart of elder? ha! is he dead, bully-stale? is he dead?

Caius. By gar, he is de coward Jack priest of de world; he is not show his face.

30 *Host.* Thou art a Castalion-King-Urinal. Hector of Greece, my boy!

Caius. I pray you, bear vitness that me have stay six or seven, two, tree hours for him, and he is no come.

Shal. He is the wiser man, master doctor: he is a 35 curer of souls, and you a curer of bodies; if you should fight, you go against the hair of your professions. Is it not true, Master Page?

Page. Master Shallow, you have yourself been a great fighter, though now a man of peace.

40 *Shal.* Bodykins, Master Page, though I now be old, and of the peace, if I see a sword out, my finger itches to make one. Though we are justices, and doctors, and churchmen, Master Page, we have some salt of our youth in us; we are the sons of women, Master Page.

45 *Page.* 'Tis true, Master Shallow.

Shal. It will be found so, Master Page. Master Doctor Caius, I am come to fetch you home. I am sworn of the peace: you have shewed yourself a wise physician, and Sir Hugh hath shewn himself a wise and patient II. 3.

50 churchman. You must go with me, master doctor.

Host. Pardon, guest-justice. —A word, Mounseur Mock-water.

Caius. Mock-vater! vat is dat?

Host. Mock-water, in our English tongue, is valour, 55 bully.

Caius. By gar, den, I have as mush mock-vater as de Englishman. —Scurvy jack-dog priest! by gar, me vill cut his ears.

Host. He will clapper-claw thee tightly, bully.

60 *Caius.* Clapper-de-claw! vat is dat?

Host. That is, he will make thee amends.

Caius. By gar, me do look he shall clapper-de-claw me; for, by gar, me vill have it.

Host. And I will provoke him to't, or let him wag.

65 *Caius.* Me tank you for dat.

Host. And, moreover, bully,—But first, master guest, and Master Page, and eke Cavaleiro Slender, go you through the town to

Frogmore.

[*Aside to them.*

Page. Sir Hugh is there, is he?

70 *Host.* He is there: see what humour he is in; and I will bring the doctor about by the fields. Will it do well?

Shal. We will do it.

Page, Shal., and Slen. Adieu, good master doctor.

[*Exeunt Page, Shal., and Slen.*

II. 3.

75 *Caius.* By gar, me vill kill de priest; for he speak for a jack-an-ape to Anne Page.

Host. Let him die: sheathe thy impatience, throw cold water on thy choler: go about the fields with me through Frogmore: I will bring thee where Mistress Anne Page is, so at a farm-house a-feasting; and thou shalt woo her. Cried I aim? said I well?

Caius. By gar, me dank you for dat: by gar, I love you; and I shall procure-a you de good guest, de earl, de knight, de lords, de gentlemen, my patients.

85 *Host.* For the which I will be thy adversary toward Anne Page. Said I well?

Caius. By gar, 'tis good; vell said.

Host. Let us wag, then.

Caius. Come at my heels, Jack Rugby.

[*Exeunt.*

ACT III.

III. 1 SCENE I. *A field near Frogmore.*

Enter SIR HUGH EVANS *and* SIMPLE.

Evans. I pray you now, good Master Slender's serving-man, and friend Simple by your name, which way have you looked for Master Caius, that calls himself doctor of physic?

5 *Sim.* Marry, sir, the pittie-ward, the park-ward, every way; old Windsor way, and every way but the town way.

Evans. I most feheemently desire you you will also look that way.

Sim. I will, sir. [Exit.

10 *Evans.* Pless my soul, how full of chollors I am, and trempling of mind!—I shall be glad if he have deceived me. —How melancholies I am!—I will knog his urinals about his knave's costard when I have goot opportunities for the ork. —Pless my soul!— [Sings.

15 To shallow rivers, to whose falls
Melodious birds sings madrigals;
There will we make our peds of roses,
And a thousand fragrant posies.
To shallow—

20 Mercy on me! I have a great dispositions to cry. [Sings.

Melodious birds sing madrigals—
Whenas I sat in Pabylon—
And a thousand vagram posies.
To shallow &c.

Re-enter SIMPLE.

III. 1.

25 *Sim.* Yonder he is coming, this way, Sir Hugh.

Evans. He's welcome. — [Sings.

To shallow rivers, to whose falls—

Heaven prosper the right!—What weapons is he?

Sim. No weapons, sir. There comes my master, 30 Master Shallow, and another gentleman, from Frogmore, over the stile, this way.

Evans. Pray you, give me my gown; or else keep it in your arms.

Enter PAGE, SHALLOW, and SLENDER.

Shal. How now, master parson! Good morrow, good 35 Sir Hugh.
Keep a gamester from the dice, and a good student from his book,
and it is wonderful.

Slen. [Aside] Ah, sweet Anne Page!

Page. Save you, good Sir Hugh!

Evans. Pless you from his mercy sake, all of you!

40 *Shal.* What, the sword and the word! do you study them both,
master parson?

Page. And youthful still! in your doublet and hose this raw
rheumatic day!

Evans. There is reasons and causes for it.

45 *Page.* We are come to you to do a good office, master parson.

Evans. Fery well: what is it?

Page. Yonder is a most reverend gentleman, who, belike having
received wrong by some person, is at most odds III. 1.
50 with his own gravity and patience that ever you saw.

Shal. I have lived fourscore years and upward; I never heard a man
of his place, gravity, and learning, so wide of his own respect.

Evans. What is he?

55 *Page.* I think you know him; Master Doctor Caius, the renowned
French physician.

Evans. Got's will, and his passion of my heart! I had as lief you
would tell me of a mess of porridge.

Page. Why?

60 *Evans.* He has no more knowledge in Hibocrates and Galen,—
and he is a knave besides; a cowardly knave as you would desires to
be acquainted withal.

Page. I warrant you, he's the man should fight with him.

65 *Slen.* [Aside] O sweet Anne Page!

Shal. It appears so, by his weapons. Keep them asunder: here comes Doctor Caius.

Enter HOST, CAIUS, and RUGBY.

Page. Nay, good master parson, keep in your weapon.

Shal. So do you, good master doctor.

70 *Host.* Disarm them, and let them question: let them keep their limbs whole, and hack our English.

Caius. I pray you, let-a me speak a word with your ear. Verefore vill you not meet-a me?

Evans. [Aside to Caius] Pray you, use your patience: III. 1.
75 in good time.

Caius. By gar, you are de coward, de Jack dog, John ape.

Evans. [Aside to Caius] Pray you, let us not be laughing-stocks to other men's humours; I desire you in friendship, 80 and I will one way or other make you amends. [Aloud] I will knog your urinals about your knave's cogscomb [for missing your meetings and appointments].

Caius. Diable!—Jack Rugby,—mine host de Jarterer,—have I not stay for him to kill him? have I not, at de 85 place I did appoint?

Evans. As I am a Christians soul, now, look you, this is the place appointed: I'll be judgement by mine host of the Garter.

Host. Peace, I say, Gallia and Gaul, French and 90 Welsh, soul-curer and body-curer!

Caius. Ay, dat is very good; excellent.

Host. Peace, I say! hear mine host of the Garter. Am I politic? am I subtle? am I a Machiavel? Shall I lose my doctor? no; he gives me the potions and the motions. 95 Shall I lose my parson, my priest, my

Sir Hugh? no; he gives me the proverbs and the no-verbs. [Give me thy hand, terrestrial; so.] Give me thy hand, celestial; so. Boys of art, I have deceived you both; I have directed you to wrong places: your hearts are mighty, your skins III. 1.

100 are whole, and let burnt sack be the issue. Come, lay their swords to pawn. Follow me, lads of peace; follow, follow, follow.

Shal. Trust me, a mad host. Follow, gentlemen, follow.

105 *Slen.* [Aside] O sweet Anne Page!

[*Exeunt Shal., Slen., Page, and Host.*]

Caius. Ha, do I perceive dat? have you make-a de sot of us, ha, ha?

Evans. This is well; he has made us his vlouting-stog. —I desire you that we may be friends; and let us knog our 110 prains together to be revenge on this same scall, scurvy, cogging companion, the host of the Garter.

Caius. By gar, with all my heart. He promise to bring me where is Anne Page; by gar, he deceive me too.

Evans. Well, I will smite his noddles. Pray you, 115 follow.

[*Exeunt.*]

III. 2 SCENE II. *The street, in Windsor.*

Enter MISTRESS PAGE *and* ROBIN.

Mrs Page. Nay, keep your way, little gallant; you were wont to be a follower, but now you are a leader. Whether had you rather lead mine eyes, or eye your master's heels?

Rob. I had rather, forsooth, go before you like a man 5 than follow him like a dwarf.

Mrs Page. O, you are a flattering boy: now I see you'll be a courtier.

Enter FORD.

Ford. Well met, Mistress Page. Whither go you?

Mrs Page. Truly, sir, to see your wife. Is she at home?

10 *Ford.* Ay; and as idle as she may hang together, for want of company. I think, if your husbands were dead, you two would marry.

Mrs Page. Be sure of that,—two other husbands.

Ford. Where had you this pretty weathercock?

15 *Mrs Page.* I cannot tell what the dickens his name is husband had him of. —What do you call your knight's name, sirrah?

Rob. Sir John Falstaff.

Ford. Sir John Falstaff!

20 *Mrs Page.* He, he; I can never hit on's name. There is such a league between my good man and he!—Is your wife at home indeed?

Ford. Indeed she is.

Mrs Page. By your leave, sir: I am sick till I see her.

[Exeunt Mrs Page and Robin.]

III. 2.

25 *Ford.* Has Page any brains? hath he any eyes? hath he any thinking? Sure, they sleep; he hath no use of them. Why, this boy will carry a letter twenty mile, as easy as a cannon will shoot point-blank twelve score. He pieces out his wife's inclination; he gives her folly motion and advantage: 30 and now she's going to my wife, and Falstaff's boy with her. A man may hear this shower sing in the wind. And Falstaff's boy with her! Good plots, they are laid; and our revolted wives share damnation together. Well; I will take him, then torture my wife, pluck the borrowed 35 veil of modesty from the so seeming Mistress Page, divulge Page himself for a secure and wilful Actæon; and to these violent proceedings all my neighbours shall cry aim. [Clock heard.] The clock gives me my cue, and my assurance bids me search: there I shall find Falstaff: I shall be rather 40 praised for this than mocked; for it is as positive as the earth is firm that Falstaff is there: I will go.

Enter PAGE, SHALLOW, SLENDER, HOST, SIR HUGH EVANS, CAIUS, and
RUGBY.

Shal., Page, &c. Well met, Master Ford.

Ford. Trust me, a good knot: I have good cheer at home; and I pray you all go with me.

45 *Shal.* I must excuse myself, Master Ford.

Slen. And so must I, sir: we have appointed to dine with Mistress Anne, and I would not break with her for more money than I'll speak of.

Shal. We have lingered about a match between Anne III. 2.

50 Page and my cousin Slender, and this day we shall have our answer.

Slen. I hope I have your good will, father Page.

Page. You have, Master Slender; I stand wholly for you:—but my wife, master doctor, is for you altogether.

55 *Caius.* Ay, be-gar; and de maid is love-a me: my nursh-a Quickly tell me so mush.

Host. What say you to young Master Fenton? he capers, he dances, he has eyes of youth, he writes verses, he speaks holiday, he smells April and May: he will 60 carry't, he will carry't; 'tis in his buttons; he will carry't.

Page. Not by my consent, I promise you. The gentleman is of no having: he kept company with the wild prince and Poins; he is of too high a region; he knows too much. No, he shall not knit a knot in his fortunes with 65 the finger of my substance: if he take her, let him take her simply; the wealth I have waits on my consent, and my consent goes not that way.

Ford. I beseech you heartily, some of you go home with me to dinner: besides your cheer, you shall have sport; 70 I will show you a monster. Master doctor, you shall go; so shall you, Master Page; and you, Sir Hugh.

Shal. Well, fare you well: we shall have the freer wooing at Master Page's.

[Exeunt Shal. and Slen.

Caius. Go home, John Rugby; I come anon.

[Exit Rugby.

III. 2.

75 *Host.* Farewell, my hearts: I will to my honest knight Falstaff, and drink canary with him. *[Exit.*

Ford. *[Aside]* I think I shall drink in pipe-wine first with him; I'll make him dance. Will you go, gentles?

All. Have with you to see this monster.

[Exeunt.

III. 3 SCENE III. *A room in FORD's house.*

Enter MISTRESS FORD and MISTRESS PAGE.

Mrs Ford. What, John! What, Robert!

Mrs Page. Quickly, quickly!—is the buck-basket—

Mrs Ford. I warrant. What, Robin, I say!

Enter Servants with a basket.

Mrs Page. Come, come, come.

5 *Mrs Ford.* Here, set it down.

Mrs Page. Give your men the charge; we must be brief.

Mrs Ford. Marry, as I told you before, John and Robert, be ready here hard by in the brew-house; and when I suddenly call you, come forth, and, without any 10 pause or staggering, take this basket on your shoulders: that done, trudge with it in all haste, and carry it among

the whitsters in Datchet-mead, and there empty it in the muddy ditch close by the Thames side.

Mrs Page. You will do it?

15 *Mrs Ford.* I ha' told them over and over; they lack no direction.
Be gone, and come when you are called.

[*Exeunt Servants.*]

Mrs Page. Here comes little Robin.

Enter ROBIN.

Mrs Ford. How now, my eyas-musket! what news with you?

20 *Rob.* My master, Sir John, is come in at your back-door, Mistress Ford, and requests your company.

Mrs Page. You little Jack-a-Lent, have you been true to us?

Rob. Ay, I'll be sworn. My master knows not of your III. 3.
25 being here, and hath threatened to put me into everlasting liberty, if I tell you of it; for he swears he'll turn me away.

Mrs Page. Thou'rt a good boy: this secrecy of thine shall be a tailor to thee, and shall make thee a new doublet and hose. I 'll go hide me.

30 *Mrs Ford.* Do so. Go tell thy master I am alone. [*Exit Robin.*]
Mistress Page, remember you your cue.

Mrs Page. I warrant thee; if I do not act it, hiss me. [Exit.]

Mrs Ford. Go to, then: we'll use this unwholesome humidity, this gross watery pumpion; we'll teach him to 35 know turtles from jays.

Enter FALSTAFF.

Fal. 'Have I caught' thee, 'my heavenly jewel?' Why, now let me die, for I have lived long enough: this is the period of my ambition: O this blessed hour!

Mrs Ford. O sweet Sir John!

40 *Fal.* Mistress Ford, I cannot cog, I cannot prate, Mistress Ford.
Now shall I sin in my wish: I would thy husband were dead: I'll
speak it before the best lord; I would make thee my lady.

Mrs Ford. I your lady, Sir John! alas, I should be a 45 pitiful lady!

Fal. Let the court of France show me such another. I see how thine
eye would emulate the diamond: thou hast the right arched beauty of
the brow that becomes the ship-tire, the tire-valiant, or any tire of
Venetian admittance.

III. 3.

50 *Mrs Ford.* A plain kerchief, Sir John: my brows become nothing
else; nor that well neither.

Fal. By the Lord, thou art a traitor to say so: thou wouldst make an
absolute courtier; and the firm fixture of thy foot would give an
excellent motion to thy gait in a semi-circled 55 farthingale. I see
what thou wert, if Fortune thy foe were not, Nature thy friend. Come,
thou canst not hide it.

Mrs Ford. Believe me, there's no such thing in me.

Fal. What made me love thee? let that persuade thee there's
something extraordinary in thee. Come, I cannot 60 cog, and say thou
art this and that, like a many of these lipping hawthorn-buds, that
come like women in men's apparel, and smell like Bucklersbury in
simple time; I cannot: but I love thee; none but thee; and thou
deservest it.

Mrs Ford. Do not betray me, sir. I fear you love 65 Mistress Page.

Fal. Thou mightst as well say I love to walk by the Counter-gate,
which is as hateful to me as the reek of a lime-kiln.

Mrs Ford. Well, heaven knows how I love you; and 70 you shall one
day find it.

Fal. Keep in that mind; I'll deserve it.

Mrs Ford. Nay, I must tell you, so you do; or else I could not be in
that mind.

Rob. [Within] Mistress Ford, Mistress Ford! here's III. 3.

75 Mistress Page at the door, sweating, and blowing, and looking wildly, and would needs speak with you presently.

Fal. She shall not see me: I will ensconce me behind the arras.

Mrs Ford. Pray you, do so: she's a very tattling 80 woman.

[*Falstaff hides himself.*]

Re-enter MISTRESS PAGE and ROBIN.

What's the matter? how now!

Mrs Page. O Mistress Ford, what have you done? You're shamed, you're overthrown, you're undone for ever!

Mrs Ford. What's the matter, good Mistress Page?

85 *Mrs Page.* O well-a-day, Mistress Ford! having an honest man to your husband, to give him such cause of suspicion!

Mrs Ford. What cause of suspicion?

Mrs Page. What cause of suspicion! Out upon you! 90 how am I mistook in you!

Mrs Ford. Why, alas, what's the matter?

Mrs Page. Your husband's coming hither, woman, with all the officers in Windsor, to search for a gentleman that he says is here now in the house, by your consent, to 95 take an ill advantage of his absence: you are undone.

Mrs Ford. 'Tis not so, I hope.

Mrs Page. Pray heaven it be not so, that you have such a man here! but 'tis most certain your husband's coming, with half Windsor at his heels, to search for such a one. III. 3.

100 I come before to tell you. If you know yourself clear, why, I am glad of it; but if you have a friend here, convey, convey him out. Be not amazed; call all your senses to you; defend your reputation, or bid farewell to your good life for ever.

105 *Mrs Ford.* What shall I do? There is a gentleman my dear friend; and I fear not mine own shame so much as his peril: I had rather than a thousand pound he were out of the house.

Mrs Page. For shame! never stand ‘you had rather’ 110 and ‘you had rather:’ your husband’s here at hand; bethink you of some conveyance: in the house you cannot hide him. O, how have you deceived me! Look, here is a basket: if he be of any reasonable stature, he may creep in here; and throw foul linen upon him, as if it were going 115 to bucking: or,—it is whiting-time,—send him by your two men to Datchet-mead.

Mrs Ford. He’s too big to go in there. What shall I do?

Fal. [Coming forward] Let me see’t, let me see’t, 120 O, let me see’t! —I’ll in, I’ll in. —Follow your friend’s counsel. —I’ll in.

Mrs Page. What, Sir John Falstaff! Are these your letters, knight?

Fal. I love thee. —Help me away. —Let me creep in III. 3.
125 here. —I’ll never—

[Gets into the basket; they cover him with foul linen.

Mrs Page. Help to cover your master, boy. —Call your men, Mistress Ford. —You dissembling knight!

Mrs Ford. What, John! Robert! John!

[Exit Robin.

Re-enter Servants.

Go take up these clothes here quickly. —Where’s the cowl-staff? 130 look, how you drumble!—Carry them to the laundress in Datchet-mead; quickly, come.

Enter FORD, PAGE, CAIUS, and SIR HUGH EVANS.

Ford. Pray you, come near: if I suspect without cause, why then make sport at me; then let me be your jest; I deserve it. —How now! whither bear you this?

135 *Serv.* To the laundress, forsooth.

Mrs Ford. Why, what have you to do whither they bear it? You were best meddle with buck-washing.

Ford. Buck!—I would I could wash myself of the buck!—Buck, buck, buck! Ay, buck; I warrant you, buck; and 140 of the season too, it shall appear. [Exeunt Servants with the basket.] Gentlemen, I have dreamed to-night; I'll tell you my dream. Here, here, here be my keys: ascend my chambers; search, seek, find out: I'll warrant we'll unkennel the fox. Let me stop this way first. [Locking the door.] So, 145 now uncape.

Page. Good Master Ford, be contented: you wrong yourself too much.

Ford. True, Master Page. Up, gentlemen; you shall see sport anon: follow me, gentlemen. [Exit.]

III. 3.

150 *Evans.* This is fery fantastical humours and jealousies.

Caius. By gar, 'tis no the fashion of France; it is not jealous in France.

Page. Nay, follow him, gentlemen; see the issue of his search.

[Exeunt Page, Caius, and Evans.]

155 *Mrs Page.* Is there not a double excellency in this?

Mrs Ford. I know not which pleases me better, that my husband is deceived, or Sir John.

Mrs Page. What a taking was he in when your husband asked who was in the basket!

160 *Mrs Ford.* I am half afraid he will have need of washing; so throwing him into the water will do him a benefit.

Mrs Page. Hang him, dishonest rascal! I would all of the same strain were in the same distress.

Mrs Ford. I think my husband hath some special suspicion 165 of Falstaff's being here; for I never saw him so gross in his jealousy till

now.

Mrs Page. I will lay a plot to try that; and we will yet have more tricks with Falstaff: his dissolute disease will scarce obey this medicine.

170 *Mrs Ford.* Shall we send that foolish carrion, Mistress Quickly, to him, and excuse his throwing into the water; and give him another hope, to betray him to another punishment?

Mrs Page. We will do it: let him be sent for to-morrow, III. 3.
175 eight o'clock, to have amends.

Re-enter FORD, PAGE, CAIUS, *and* SIR HUGH EVANS.

Ford. I cannot find him: may be the knave bragged of that he could not compass.

Mrs Page. [Aside to Mrs Ford] Heard you that?

Mrs Ford. You use me well, Master Ford, do you?

180 *Ford.* Ay, I do so.

Mrs Ford. Heaven make you better than your thoughts!

Ford. Amen!

Mrs Page. You do yourself mighty wrong, Master Ford.

185 *Ford.* Ay, ay; I must bear it.

Evans. If there be any pody in the house, and in the chambers, and in the coffers, and in the presses, heaven forgive my sins at the day of judgement!

Caius. By gar, nor I too: there is no bodies.

190 *Page.* Fie, fie, Master Ford! are you not ashamed? What spirit, what devil suggests this imagination? I would not ha' your distemper in this kind for the wealth of Windsor Castle.

Ford. 'Tis my fault, Master Page: I suffer for it.

195 *Evans.* You suffer for a pad conscience: your wife is as honest a
'omans as I will desires among five thousand, and five hundred too.

Caius. By gar, I see 'tis an honest woman.

Ford. Well, I promised you a dinner. —Come, come, III. 3.
200 walk in the Park: I pray you, pardon me; I will hereafter make
known to you why I have done this. —Come, wife; come, Mistress
Page. —I pray you, pardon me; pray heartily pardon me.

Page. Let's go in, gentlemen; but, trust me, we'll 205 mock him. I do
invite you to-morrow morning to my house to breakfast: after, we'll
a-birding together; I have a fine hawk for the bush. Shall it be so?

Ford. Any thing.

210 *Evans.* If there is one, I shall make two in the company.

Caius. If dere be one or two, I shall make-a the turd.

Ford. Pray you, go, Master Page.

Evans. I pray you now, remembrance to-morrow on the lousy knave,
mine host.

215 *Caius.* Dat is good; by gar, with all my heart!

Evans. A lousy knave, to have his gibes and his mockeries!

[*Exeunt.*

III. 4 SCENE IV. *A room in PAGE's house.*

Enter FENTON and ANNE PAGE.

Fent. I see I cannot get thy father's love;
Therefore no more turn me to him, sweet Nan.

Anne. Alas, how then?

Fent. Why, thou must be thyself.
He doth object I am too great of birth;

5 And that, my state being gall'd with my expense,
I seek to heal it only by his wealth:
Besides these, other bars he lays before me,—
My riots past, my wild societies;
And tells me 'tis a thing impossible
10 I should love thee but as a property.

Anne. May be he tells you true.

Fent. No, heaven so speed me in my time to come!
Albeit I will confess thy father's wealth
Was the first motive that I woo'd thee, Anne:
15 Yet, wooing thee, I found thee of more value
Than stamps in gold or sums in sealed bags;
And 'tis the very riches of thyself
That now I aim at.

Anne. Gentle Master Fenton,
Yet seek my father's love; still seek it, sir:
20 If opportunity and humblest suit
Cannot attain it, why, then,—hark you hither!

[They converse apart.]

Enter SHALLOW, SLENDER, and MISTRESS QUICKLY.

Shal. Break their talk, Mistress Quickly: my kinsman shall speak for himself.

Sle. I'll make a shaft or a bolt on't: 'slid, 'tis but III. 4.
25 venturing.

Shal. Be not dismayed.

Slen. No, she shall not dismay me: I care not for that, but that I am
afeard.

Quick. Hark ye; Master Slender would speak a word 30 with you.

Anne. I come to him. *[Aside]* This is my father's choice.
O, what a world of vile ill-favour'd faults
Looks handsome in three hundred pounds a-year!

Quick. And how does good Master Fenton? Pray you, 35 a word with you.

Shal. She's coming; to her, coz. O boy, thou hadst a father!

Slen. I had a father, Mistress Anne;—my uncle can tell you good jests of him. Pray you, uncle, tell Mistress 40 Anne the jest, how my father stole two geese out of a pen, good uncle.

Shal. Mistress Anne, my cousin loves you.

Slen. Ay, that I do; as well as I love any woman in Gloucestershire.

45 *Shal.* He will maintain you like a gentlewoman.

Slen. Ay, that I will, come cut and long-tail, under the degree of a squire.

Shal. He will make you a hundred and fifty pounds jointure.

III. 4.

50 *Anne.* Good Master Shallow, let him woo for himself.

Shal. Marry, I thank you for it; I thank you for that good comfort. She calls you, coz: I'll leave you.

Anne. Now, Master Slender,—

Slen. Now, good Mistress Anne,—

55 *Anne.* What is your will?

Slen. My will! od's heartlings, that's a pretty jest indeed! I ne'er made my will yet, I thank heaven; I am not such a sickly creature, I give heaven praise.

Anne. I mean, Master Slender, what would you with 60 me?

Slen. Truly, for mine own part, I would little or nothing with you. Your father and my uncle hath made motions: if it be my luck, so; if not, happy man be his dole! They can tell you how things go better than I can: you may 65 ask your father; here he comes.

Enter PAGE and MISTRESS PAGE.

Page. Now, Master Slender: love him, daughter Anne.—
Why, how now! what does Master Fenton here?
You wrong me, sir, thus still to haunt my house:
I told you, sir, my daughter is disposed of.

70 *Fent.* Nay, Master Page, be not impatient.

Mrs Page. Good Master Fenton, come not to my child.

Page. She is no match for you.

Fent. Sir, will you hear me?

Page. No, good Master Fenton.
Come, Master Shallow; come, son Slender, in.

III. 4.

75 Knowing my mind, you wrong me, Master Fenton.

[*Exeunt Page, Shal., and Slen.*]

Quick. Speak to Mistress Page.

Fent. Good Mistress Page, for that I love your daughter
In such a righteous fashion as I do,
Perforce, against all checks, rebukes and manners,
80 I must advance the colours of my love,
And not retire: let me have your good will.

Anne. Good mother, do not marry me to yond fool.

Mrs Page. I mean it not; I seek you a better husband.

Quick. That's my master, master doctor.

85 Anne. Alas, I had rather be set quick i' the earth,
And bowl'd to death with turnips!

Mrs Page. Come, trouble not yourself. Good Master Fenton,
I will not be your friend nor enemy:
My daughter will I question how she loves you,
90 And as I find her, so am I affected.
Till then farewell, sir: she must needs go in;
Her father will be angry.

Fent. Farewell, gentle mistress: farewell, Nan.

[*Exeunt Mrs Page and Anne.*

Quick. This is my doing now: ‘Nay,’ said I, ‘will you ⁹⁵ cast away your child on a fool, and a physician? Look on Master Fenton:’ this is my doing.

Fent. I thank thee; and I pray thee, once to-night
Give my sweet Nan this ring: there’s for thy pains.

Quick. Now heaven send thee good fortune! [*Exit* III. 4.
¹⁰⁰ *Fenton.*] A kind heart he hath: a woman would run through fire and water for such a kind heart. But yet I would my master had Mistress Anne; or I would Master Slender had her; or, in sooth, I would Master Fenton had her: I will do what I can for them all three; ¹⁰⁵ for so I have promised, and I’ll be as good as my word; but speciously for Master Fenton. Well, I must of another errand to Sir John Falstaff from my two mistresses: what a beast am I to slack it!
[*Exit.*

III. 5 SCENE V. *A room in the Garter Inn.*

Enter FALSTAFF *and* BARDOLPH.

Fal. Bardolph, I say,—

Bard. Here, sir.

Fal. Go fetch me a quart of sack; put a toast in’t. [*Exit Bard.*] Have I lived to be carried in a basket, like a barrow ⁵ of butcher’s offal, and to be thrown in the Thames? Well, if I be served such another trick, I’ll have my brains ta’en out, and buttered, and give them to a dog for a new-year’s gift. The rogues slighted me into the river with as little remorse as they would have drowned a blind bitch’s puppies, ¹⁰ fifteen i’ the litter: and you may know by my size that I have a kind of alacrity in sinking; if the bottom were as deep as hell, I should down. I had been drowned, but that the shore was shelvy and shallow,—a death that I abhor; for the water swells a man; and what a thing ¹⁵

should I have been when I had been swelled! I should have been a mountain of mummy.

Re-enter BARDOLPH with sack.

Bard. Here's Mistress Quickly, sir, to speak with you.

Fal. Come, let me pour in some sack to the Thames water; for my belly's as cold as if I had swallowed snow-balls 20 for pills to cool the reins. Call her in.

Bard. Come in, woman!

Enter MISTRESS QUICKLY.

Quick. By your leave; I cry you mercy: give your worship good morrow.

Fal. Take away these chalices. Go brew me a pottle III. 5.
25 of sack finely.

Bard. With eggs, sir?

Fal. Simple of itself; I'll no pullet-sperm in my brewage. [*Exit Bardolph.*] How now!

Quick. Marry, sir, I come to your worship from Mistress 30 Ford.

Fal. Mistress Ford! I have had ford enough; I was thrown into the ford; I have my belly full of ford.

Quick. Alas the day! good heart, that was not her fault: she does so take on with her men; they mistook 35 their erection.

Fal. So did I mine, to build upon a foolish woman's promise.

Quick. Well, she laments, sir, for it, that it would yearn your heart to see it. Her husband goes this morning 40 a-birding; she desires you once more to come to her between eight and nine: I must carry her word quickly: she'll make you amends, I warrant you.

Fal. Well, I will visit her: tell her so; and bid her think what a man is: let her consider his frailty, and then 45 judge of my merit.

Quick. I will tell her.

Fal. Do so. Between nine and ten, sayest thou?

Quick. Eight and nine, sir.

Fal. Well, be gone: I will not miss her.

III. 5.

50 *Quick.* Peace be with you, sir. *[Exit.*

Fal. I marvel I hear not of Master Brook; he sent me word to stay within: I like his money well. —O, here he comes.

Enter FORD.

Ford. Bless you, sir!

55 *Fal.* Now, Master Brook,—you come to know what hath passed between me and Ford's wife?

Ford. That, indeed, Sir John, is my business.

Fal. Master Brook, I will not lie to you: I was at her house the hour she appointed me.

60 *Ford.* And sped you, sir?

Fal. Very ill-favouredly, Master Brook.

Ford. How so, sir? Did she change her determination?

Fal. No, Master Brook; but the peaking Cornuto her husband, Master Brook, dwelling in a continual 'larum of 65 jealousy, comes me in the instant of our encounter, after we had embraced, kissed, protested, and, as it were, spoke the prologue of our comedy; and at his heels a rabble of his companions, thither provoked and instigated by his distemper, and, forsooth, to search his house for his wife's 70 love.

Ford. What, while you were there?

Fal. While I was there.

Ford. And did he search for you, and could not find you?

III. 5.

75 *Fal.* You shall hear. As good luck would have it, comes in one Mistress Page; gives intelligence of Ford's approach; and, in her invention and Ford's wife's distraction, they conveyed me into a buck-basket.

Ford. A buck-basket!

80 *Fal.* By the Lord, a buck-basket!—rammed me in with foul shirts and smocks, socks, foul stockings, greasy napkins; that, Master Brook, there was the rankest compound of villanous smell that ever offended nostril.

Ford. And how long lay you there?

85 *Fal.* Nay, you shall hear, Master Brook, what I have suffered to bring this woman to evil for your good. Being thus crammed in the basket, a couple of Ford's knaves, his hinds, were called forth by their mistress to carry me in the name of foul clothes to Datchet-lane: they took me on their 90 shoulders; met the jealous knave their master in the door, who asked them once or twice what they had in their basket: I quaked for fear, lest the lunatic knave would have searched it; but fate, ordaining he should be a cuckold, held his hand. Well: on went he for a search, and 95 away went I for foul clothes. But mark the sequel, Master Brook: I suffered the pangs of three several deaths; first, an intolerable fright, to be detected with a jealous rotten bell-wether; next, to be compassed, like a good bilbo, in the circumference of a peck, hilt to point, heel to head; III. 5.

100 and then, to be stopped in, like a strong distillation, with stinking clothes that fretted in their own grease: think of that,—a man of my kidney,—think of that,—that am as subject to heat as butter; a man of continual dissolution and thaw: it was a miracle to scape suffocation. And in 105 the height of this bath, when I was more than half stewed in grease, like a Dutch dish, to be thrown into the Thames, and cooled, glowing hot, in that surge, like a horse-shoe; think of that,—hissing hot,—think of that, Master Brook.

Ford. In good sadness, sir, I am sorry that for my sake 110 you have suffered all this. My suit, then, is desperate; you'll undertake her no more?

Fal. Master Brook, I will be thrown into Etna, as I have been into Thames, ere I will leave her thus. Her husband is this morning gone a-birding: I have received 115 from her another embassy of meeting; 'twixt eight and nine is the hour, Master Brook.

Ford. 'Tis past eight already, sir.

Fal. Is it? I will then address me to my appointment. Come to me at your convenient leisure, and you 120 shall know how I speed; and the conclusion shall be crowned with your enjoying her. Adieu. You shall have her, Master Brook; Master Brook, you shall cuckold Ford.

[Exit.

Ford. Hum! ha! is this a vision? is this a dream? do I sleep? Master Ford, awake! awake, Master Ford! there's III. 5.
125 a hole made in your best coat, Master Ford. This 'tis to be married! this 'tis to have linen and buck-baskets! Well, I will proclaim myself what I am: I will now take the lecher; he is at my house; he cannot 'scape me; 'tis impossible he should; he cannot creep into a halfpenny 130 purse, nor into a pepper-box: but, lest the devil that guides him should aid him, I will search impossible places. Though what I am I cannot avoid, yet to be what I would not shall not make me tame: if I have horns to make one mad, let the proverb go with me,—I'll be horn-mad.

[Exit.

ACT IV.

IV. 1 SCENE I. A street.

Enter MISTRESS PAGE, MISTRESS QUICKLY, *and* WILLIAM.

Mrs Page. Is he at Master Ford's already, think'st thou?

Quick. Sure he is by this, or will be presently: but, truly, he is very courageous mad about his throwing into 5 the water. Mistress Ford desires you to come suddenly.

Mrs Page. I'll be with her by and by; I'll but bring my young man here to school. Look, where his master comes; 'tis a playing-day, I see.

Enter SIR HUGH EVANS.

How now, Sir Hugh! no school to-day?

10 *Evans.* No; Master Slender is let the boys leave to play.

Quick. Blessing of his heart!

Mrs Page. Sir Hugh, my husband says my son profits nothing in the world at his book. I pray you, ask him 15 some questions in his accidence.

Evans. Come hither, William; hold up your head; come.

Mrs Page. Come on, sirrah; hold up your head; answer your master, be not afraid.

Evans. William, how many numbers is in nouns?

20 *Will.* Two.

Quick. Truly, I thought there had been one number more, because they say, 'Od's nouns.'

Evans. Peace your tattlings! What is 'fair,' William?

Will. Pulcher.

IV. 1.

25 *Quick.* Polecats! there are fairer things than polecats, sure.

Evans. You are a very simplicity 'oman: I pray you, peace. —What is 'lapis,' William?

Will. A stone.

30 *Evans.* And what is 'a stone,' William?

Will. A pebble.

Evans. No, it is 'lapis:' I pray you, remember in your prain.

Will. Lapis.

35 *Evans.* That is a good William. What is he, William, that does lend articles?

Will. Articles are borrowed of the pronoun, and be thus declined, Singulariter, nominativo, hic, hæc, hoc.

Evans. Nominativo, hig, hag, hog; pray you, mark: 40 genitivo, hujus. Well, what is your accusative case?

Will. Accusativo, hinc.

Evans. I pray you, have your remembrance, child; accusativo, hung, hang, hog.

Quick. 'Hang-hog' is Latin for bacon, I warrant you.

45 *Evans.* Leave your prabbles, 'oman. —What is the focative case, William?

Will. O,—vocativo, O.

Evans. Remember, William; focative is caret.

Quick. And that's a good root.

IV. 1.

50 *Evans.* 'Oman, forbear.

Mrs Page. Peace!

Evans. What is your genitive case plural, William?

Will. Genitive case!

Evans. Ay.

55 *Will.* Genitive,—horum, harum, horum.

Quick. Vengeance of Jenny's case! fie on her! never name her, child, if she be a whore.

Evans. For shame, 'oman.

Quick. You do ill to teach the child such words:—he 60 teaches him to hick and to hack, which they'll do fast enough of themselves, and to call 'horum':—fie upon you!

Evans. 'Oman, art thou lunaties? hast thou no understandings for thy cases, and the numbers of the genders? 65 Thou art as foolish Christian creatures as I would desires.

Mrs Page. Prithee, hold thy peace.

Evans. Show me now, William, some declensions of your pronouns.

Will. Forsooth, I have forgot.

70 *Evans.* It is qui, quæ, quod: if you forget your 'quies,' your 'quæs,' and your 'quods,' you must be preeches. Go your ways, and play; go.

Mrs Page. He is a better scholar than I thought he was.

IV. 1.

75 *Evans.* He is a good sprag memory. Farewell, Mistress Page.

Mrs Page. Adieu, good Sir Hugh.

[*Exit Sir Hugh.*

Get you home, boy. Come, we stay too long.

[*Exeunt.*

IV. 2 SCENE II. *A room in FORD's house.*

Enter FALSTAFF and MISTRESS FORD.

Fal. Mistress Ford, your sorrow hath eaten up my sufferance. I see you are obsequious in your love, and I profess requital to a hair's breadth; not only, Mistress Ford, in the simple office of love, but in

all the accoutrement, 5 complement, and ceremony of it. But are you sure of your husband now?

Mrs Ford. He's a-birding, sweet Sir John.

Mrs Page. [*Within*] What, ho, gossip Ford! what, ho!

Mrs Ford. Step into the chamber, Sir John.

[*Exit Falstaff.*

Enter MISTRESS PAGE.

10 *Mrs Page.* How now, sweetheart! who's at home besides yourself?

Mrs Ford. Why, none but mine own people.

Mrs Page. Indeed!

Mrs Ford. No, certainly. [*Aside to her*] Speak louder.

15 *Mrs Page.* Truly, I am so glad you have nobody here.

Mrs Ford. Why?

Mrs Page. Why, woman, your husband is in his old lunes again: he so takes on yonder with my husband; so rails against all married mankind; so curses all Eve's 20 daughters, of what complexion soever; and so buffets himself on the forehead, crying, 'Peer out, peer out!' that any madness I ever yet beheld seemed but tameness, civility, and patience, to this his distemper he is in now: I am glad the fat knight is not here.

IV. 2.

25 *Mrs Ford.* Why, does he talk of him?

Mrs Page. Of none but him; and swears he was carried out, the last time he searched for him, in a basket; protests to my husband he is now here; and hath drawn him and the rest of their company from their sport, to make 30 another experiment of his suspicion: but I am glad the knight is not here; now he shall see his own foolery.

Mrs Ford. How near is he, Mistress Page?

Mrs Page. Hard by; at street end; he will be here anon.

Mrs Ford. I am undone!—the knight is here.

35 *Mrs Page.* Why, then, you are utterly shamed, and he's but a dead man. What a woman are you!—Away with him, away with him! better shame than murder.

Mrs Ford. Which way should he go? how should I bestow him? Shall I put him into the basket again?

Re-enter FALSTAFF.

40 *Fal.* No, I'll come no more i' the basket. May I not go out ere he come?

Mrs Page. Alas, three of Master Ford's brothers watch the door with pistols, that none shall issue out; otherwise you might slip away ere he came. But what make you 45 here?

Fal. What shall I do?—I'll creep up into the chimney.

Mrs Ford. There they always use to discharge their birding-pieces. Creep into the kiln-hole.

Fal. Where is it?

IV. 2.

50 *Mrs Ford.* He will seek there, on my word. Neither press, coffer, chest, trunk, well, vault, but he hath an abstract for the remembrance of such places, and goes to them by his note: there is no hiding you in the house.

Fal. I'll go out, then.

55 *Mrs Page.* If you go out in your own semblance, you die, Sir John. Unless you go out disguised,—

Mrs Ford. How might we disguise him?

Mrs Page. Alas the day, I know not! There is no woman's gown big enough for him; otherwise he might put 60 on a hat, a muffler, and a kerchief, and so escape.

Fal. Good hearts, devise something: any extremity rather than a mischief.

Mrs Ford. My maid's aunt, the fat woman of Brentford, has a gown above.

65 *Mrs Page.* On my word, it will serve him; she's as big as he is: and there's her thrummed hat, and her muffler too. Run up, Sir John.

Mrs Ford. Go, go, sweet Sir John: Mistress Page and I will look some linen for your head.

70 *Mrs Page.* Quick, quick! we'll come dress you straight: put on the gown the while. *[Exit Falstaff.]*

Mrs Ford. I would my husband would meet him in this shape: he cannot abide the old woman of Brentford; he swears she's a witch; forbade her my house, and hath IV. 2.

75 threatened to beat her.

Mrs Page. Heaven guide him to thy husband's cudgel, and the devil guide his cudgel afterwards!

Mrs Ford. But is my husband coming?

Mrs Page. Ay, in good sadness, is he; and talks of 80 the basket too, howsoever he hath had intelligence.

Mrs Ford. We'll try that; for I'll appoint my men to carry the basket again, to meet him at the door with it, as they did last time.

Mrs Page. Nay, but he'll be here presently: let's go 85 dress him like the witch of Brentford.

Mrs Ford. I'll first direct my men what they shall do with the basket. Go up; I'll bring linen for him straight. *[Exit.]*

Mrs Page. Hang him, dishonest varlet! we cannot misuse him enough.

90 We'll leave a proof, by that which we will do,

Wives may be merry, and yet honest too:

We do not act that often jest and laugh;

'Tis old, but true,—

Still swine eat all the draff.

[Exit.

Re-enter MISTRESS FORD *with two* SERVANTS.

Mrs Ford. Go, sirs, take the basket again on your 95 shoulders: your master is hard at door; if he bid you set it down, obey him: quickly, dispatch. [Exit.

First Serv. Come, come, take it up.

Sec. Serv. Pray heaven it be not full of knight again.

First Serv. I hope not; I had as lief bear so much lead.

Enter FORD, PAGE, SHALLOW, CAIUS, and SIR HUGH EVANS.

IV. 2.

100 *Ford.* Ay, but if it prove true, Master Page, have you any way then to unfool me again? Set down the basket, villain! Somebody call my wife. Youth in a basket!—O you panderly rascals! there's a knot, a ging, a pack, a conspiracy against me: now shall the devil be shamed. —What, 105 wife, I say!—Come, come forth! Behold what honest clothes you send forth to bleaching!

Page. Why, this passes, Master Ford; you are not to go loose any longer; you must be pinioned.

Evans. Why, this is lunatics! this is mad as a mad 110 dog!

Shal. Indeed, Master Ford, this is not well, indeed.

Ford. So say I too, sir.

Re-enter MISTRESS FORD.

Come hither, Mistress Ford; Mistress Ford, the honest woman, the modest wife, the virtuous creature, that hath the 115 jealous fool to her husband! I suspect without cause, mistress, do I?

Mrs Ford. Heaven be my witness you do, if you suspect me in any dishonesty.

Ford. Well said, brazen-face! hold it out. Come forth, 120 sirrah!
[Pulling clothes out of the basket.

Page. This passes!

Mrs Ford. Are you not ashamed? let the clothes alone.

Ford. I shall find you anon.

Evans. 'Tis unreasonable! Will you take up your IV. 2.
125 wife's clothes? Come away.

Ford. Empty the basket, I say!

Mrs Ford. Why, man, why?

Ford. Master Page, as I am a man, there was one conveyed out of my house yesterday in this basket: why may 130 not he be there again? In my house I am sure he is: my intelligence is true; my jealousy is reasonable. Pluck me out all the linen.

Mrs Ford. If you find a man there, he shall die a flea's death.

135 *Page.* Here's no man.

Shal. By my fidelity, this is not well, Master Ford; this wrongs you.

Evans. Master Ford, you must pray, and not follow the imaginations of your own heart: this is jealousies.

140 *Ford.* Well, he's not here I seek for.

Page. No, nor nowhere else but in your brain.

Ford. Help to search my house this one time. If I find not what I seek, show no colour for my extremity; let me for ever be your table-sport; let them say of me, 'As 145 jealous as Ford, that searched a hollow walnut for his wife's leman.' Satisfy me once more; once more search with me.

Mrs Ford. What, ho, Mistress Page! come you and the old woman down; my husband will come into the chamber.

Ford. Old woman! what old woman's that?

IV. 2.

150 *Mrs Ford.* Why, it is my maid's aunt of Brentford.

Ford. A witch, a quean, an old cozening quean! Have I not forbid her my house? She comes of errands, does she? We are simple men; we do not know what's brought to pass under the profession of fortune-telling. She works ¹⁵⁵ by charms, by spells, by the figure, and such daubery as this is, beyond our element: we know nothing. Come down, you witch, you hag, you; come down, I say!

Mrs Ford. Nay, good, sweet husband!—Good gentlemen, let him not strike the old woman.

Re-enter FALSTAFF in woman's clothes, and MISTRESS PAGE.

¹⁶⁰ *Mrs Page.* Come, Mother Prat; come, give me your hand.

Ford. I'll prat her. [*Beating him*] Out of my door, you witch, you hag, you baggage, you polecat, you ronyon! out, out! I'll conjure you, I'll fortune-tell you.

[*Exit Falstaff.*]

¹⁶⁵ *Mrs Page.* Are you not ashamed? I think you have killed the poor woman.

Mrs Ford. Nay, he will do it. 'Tis a goodly credit for you.

Ford. Hang her, witch!

¹⁷⁰ *Evans.* By yea and no, I think the 'oman is a witch indeed: I like not when a 'oman has a great peard; I spy a great peard under his muffler.

Ford. Will you follow, gentlemen? I beseech you, follow; see but the issue of my jealousy: if I cry out thus IV. 2.

¹⁷⁵ upon no trail, never trust me when I open again.

Page. Let's obey his humour a little further: come, gentlemen.

[*Exeunt Ford, Page, Shal., Caius, and Evans.*]

Mrs Page. Trust me, he beat him most pitifully.

Mrs Ford. Nay, by the mass, that he did not; he beat ¹⁸⁰ him most unpitifully methought.

Mrs Page. I'll have the cudgel hallowed and hung o'er the altar; it hath done meritorious service.

Mrs Ford. What think you? may we, with the warrant of womanhood and the witness of a good conscience, pursue 185 him with any further revenge?

Mrs Page. The spirit of wantonness is, sure, scared out of him: if the devil have him not in fee-simple, with fine and recovery, he will never, I think, in the way of waste, attempt us again.

190 *Mrs Ford.* Shall we tell our husbands how we have served him?

Mrs Page. Yes, by all means; if it be but to scrape the figures out of your husband's brains. If they can find in their hearts the poor unvirtuous fat knight shall be any 195 further afflicted, we two will still be the ministers.

Mrs Ford. I'll warrant they'll have him publicly shamed: and methinks there would be no period to the jest, should he not be publicly shamed.

Mrs Page. Come, to the forge with it, then; shape it: IV. 2.
200 I would not have things cool.

[*Exeunt.*

IV. 3 SCENE III. *A room in the Garter Inn.*

Enter HOST *and* BARDOLPH.

Bard. Sir, the Germans desire to have three of your horses: the duke himself will be to-morrow at court, and they are going to meet him.

Host. What duke should that be comes so secretly? I 5 hear not of him in the court. Let me speak with the gentlemen: they speak English?

Bard. Ay, sir; I'll call them to you.

Host. They shall have my horses; but I'll make them pay; I'll sauce them: they have had my house a week at 10 command; I have turned away my other guests: they must come off; I'll sauce them. Come.

[*Exeunt.*

IV. 4 SCENE IV. *A room in FORD's house.*

Enter PAGE, FORD, MISTRESS PAGE, MISTRESS FORD, *and* SIR HUGH EVANS.

Evans. 'Tis one of the best discretions of a 'oman as ever I did look upon.

Page. And did he send you both these letters at an instant?

5 *Mrs Page.* Within a quarter of an hour.

Ford. Pardon me, wife. Henceforth do what thou wilt;
I rather will suspect the sun with cold
Than thee with wantonness: now doth thy honour stand,
In him that was of late an heretic,
As firm as faith.

10 *Page.* 'Tis well, 'tis well; no more:
Be not as extreme in submission
As in offence.

But let our plot go forward: let our wives
Yet once again, to make us public sport,
15 Appoint a meeting with this old fat fellow,
Where we may take him, and disgrace him for it.

Ford. There is no better way than that they spoke of.

Page. How? to send him word they'll meet him in the Park at midnight? Fie, fie! he'll never come.

20 *Evans.* You say he has been thrown in the rivers, and has been grievously peaten, as an old 'oman: methinks there should be terrors

in him that he should not come; methinks his flesh is punished, he shall have no desires.

Page. So think I too.

IV. 4.

25 *Mrs Ford.* Devise but how you'll use him when he comes,

And let us two devise to bring him thither.

Mrs Page. There is an old tale goes that Herne the hunter,
Sometime a keeper here in Windsor forest,
Doth all the winter-time, at still midnight,
30 Walk round about an oak, with great ragg'd horns;
And there he blasts the tree, and takes the cattle,
And makes milch-kine yield blood, and shakes a chain
In a most hideous and dreadful manner:
You have heard of such a spirit; and well you know
35 The superstitious idle-headed eld
Receiv'd, and did deliver to our age,
This tale of Herne the hunter for a truth.

Page. Why, yet there want not many that do fear
In deep of night to walk by this Herne's oak:
But what of this?

40 *Mrs Ford.* Marry, this is our device;
That Falstaff at that oak shall meet with us.

Page. Well, let it not be doubted but he'll come:
And in this shape when you have brought him thither,
What shall be done with him? what is your plot?

45 *Mrs Page.* That likewise have we thought upon, and thus:
Nan Page my daughter and my little son
And three or four more of their growth we'll dress
Like urchins, ouphes and fairies, green and white,
With rounds of waxen tapers on their heads,

IV. 4.

50 And rattles in their hands: upon a sudden,

As Falstaff, she, and I, are newly met,
Let them from forth a sawpit rush at once
With some diffused song: upon their sight,
We two in great amazedness will fly:
55 Then let them all encircle him about,
And, fairy-like, to-pinch the unclean knight;
And ask him why, that hour of fairy revel,
In their so sacred paths he dares to tread
In shape profane.

Mrs Ford. And till he tell the truth,
60 Let the supposed fairies pinch him sound,
And burn him with their tapers.

Mrs Page. The truth being known,
We'll all present ourselves, dis-horn the spirit,
And mock him home to Windsor.

Ford. The children must
Be practised well to this, or they'll ne'er do't.

65 *Evans.* I will teach the children their behaviours; and I will be like
a jack-an-apes also, to burn the knight with my taber.

Ford. That will be excellent. I'll go and buy them vizards.

70 *Mrs Page.* My Nan shall be the queen of all the fairies,
Finely attired in a robe of white.

Page. That silk will I go buy. [*Aside*] And in that time
Shall Master Slender steal my Nan away,
And marry her at Eton. Go send to Falstaff straight.

IV. 4.

75 *Ford.* Nay, I'll to him again in name of Brook:
He'll tell me all his purpose: sure, he'll come.

Mrs Page. Fear not you that. Go get us properties
And tricking for our fairies.

Evans. Let us about it: it is admirable pleasures and so fery honest knaveries.

[*Exeunt Page, Ford, and Evans.*

Mrs Page. Go, Mistress Ford,
Send quickly to Sir John, to know his mind.

[*Exit Mrs Ford.*

I'll to the doctor: he hath my good will,
And none but he, to marry with Nan Page.
85 That Slender, though well landed, is an idiot;
And he my husband best of all affects.
The doctor is well money'd, and his friends
Potent at court: he, none but he, shall have her,
Though twenty thousand worthier come to crave her. [Exit.

IV. 5 SCENE V. *A room in the Garter Inn.*

Enter HOST and SIMPLE.

Host. What wouldst thou have, boor? what, thick-skin? speak,
breathe, discuss; brief, short, quick, snap.

Sim. Marry, sir, I come to speak with Sir John Falstaff from Master Slender.

5 *Host.* There's his chamber, his house, his castle, his standing-bed,
and truckle-bed; 'tis painted about with the story of the Prodigal,
fresh and new. Go knock and call; he'll speak like an
Anthropophaginian unto thee: knock, I say.

10 *Sim.* There's an old woman, a fat woman, gone up into his
chamber: I'll be so bold as stay, sir, till she come down; I come to
speak with her, indeed.

Host. Ha! a fat woman! the knight may be robbed: I'll call. —Bully
knight! bully Sir John! speak from thy 15 lungs military: art thou
there? it is thine host, thine Ephesian, calls.

Fal. [Above] How now, mine host!

Host. Here's a Bohemian-Tartar tarries the coming down of thy fat woman. Let her descend, bully, let her 20 descend; my chambers are honourable: fie! privacy? fie!

Enter FALSTAFF.

Fal. There was, mine host, an old fat woman even now with me; but she's gone.

Sim. Pray you, sir, was't not the wise woman of Brentford?

IV. 5.

25 *Fal.* Ay, marry, was it, muscle-shell: what would you with her?

Sim. My master, sir, Master Slender, sent to her, seeing her go thorough the streets, to know, sir, whether one Nym, sir, that beguiled him of a chain, had the chain or no.

30 *Fal.* I spake with the old woman about it.

Sim. And what says she, I pray, sir?

Fal. Marry, she says that the very same man that beguiled Master Slender of his chain cozened him of it.

Sim. I would I could have spoken with the woman 35 herself; I had other things to have spoken with her too from him.

Fal. What are they? let us know.

Host. Ay, come; quick.

Sim. I may not conceal them, sir.

40 Host. Conceal them, or thou diest.

Sim. Why, sir, they were nothing but about Mistress Anne Page; to know if it were my master's fortune to have her or no.

Fal. 'Tis, 'tis his fortune.

45 *Sim.* What, sir?

Fal. To have her, or no. Go; say the woman told me so.

Sim. May I be bold to say so, sir?

Fal. Ay, sir; like who more bold.

IV. 5.

50 *Sim.* I thank your worship: I shall make my master glad with these tidings. [Exit.

Host. Thou art clerkly, thou art clerkly, Sir John. Was there a wise woman with thee?

Fal. Ay, that there was, mine host; one that hath 55 taught me more wit than ever I learned before in my life; and I paid nothing for it neither, but was paid for my learning.

Enter BARDOLPH.

Bard. Out, alas, sir! cozenage, mere cozenage!

Host. Where be my horses? speak well of them, 60 varletto.

Bard. Run away with the cozeners: for so soon as I came beyond Eton, they threw me off, from behind one of them, in a slough of mire; and set spurs and away, like three German devils, three Doctor Faustuses.

65 *Host.* They are gone but to meet the duke, villain: do not say they be fled; Germans are honest men.

Enter SIR HUGH EVANS.

Evans. Where is mine host?

Host. What is the matter, sir?

Evans. Have a care of your entertainments: there is a 70 friend of mine come to town, tells me there is three cozen-germans that has cozened all the hosts of Readins, of Maidenhead, of Colebrook, of horses and money. I tell you for good will, look you: you are wise, and full of gibes and vlouting-stocks, and 'tis not convenient you should be IV. 5.

75 cozened. Fare you well. [Exit.

Enter DOCTOR CAIUS.

Caius. Vere is mine host de Jarteer?

Host. Here, master doctor, in perplexity and doubtful dilemma.

Caius. I cannot tell vat is dat: but it is tell-a me dat 80 you make grand preparation for a duke de Jamany: by my trot, dere is no duke dat the court is know to come. I tell you for good vill: adieu.

[Exit.

Host. Hue and cry, villain, go!—Assist me, knight. —I am undone! —Fly, run, hue and cry, villain!—I am 85 undone!

[Exeunt Host and Bard.]

Fal. I would all the world might be cozened; for I have been cozened and beaten too. If it should come to the ear of the court, how I have been transformed, and how my transformation hath been washed and cudgelled, they 90 would melt me out of my fat drop by drop, and liquor fishermen's boots with me: I warrant they would whip me with their fine wits till I were as crest-fallen as a dried pear. I never prospered since I forswore myself at primero. Well, if my wind were but long enough [to say my prayers,] I 95 would repent.

Enter MISTRESS QUICKLY.

Now, whence come you?

Quick. From the two parties, forsooth.

Fal. The devil take one party, and his dam the other! and so they shall be both bestowed. I have suffered more IV. 5.
100 for their sakes, more than the villanous inconstancy of man's disposition is able to bear.

Quick. And have not they suffered? Yes, I warrant; speciously one of them; Mistress Ford, good heart, is beaten black and blue, that you cannot see a white spot 105 about her.

Fal. What tellest thou me of black and blue? I was beaten myself into all the colours of the rainbow; and I was like to be apprehended for the witch of Brentford: but that my admirable dexterity of wit, my

counterfeiting the 110 action of an old woman, delivered me, the knave constable had set me i' the stocks, i' the common stocks, for a witch.

Quick. Sir, let me speak with you in your chamber: you shall hear how things go; and, I warrant, to your content. 115 Here is a letter will say somewhat. Good hearts, what ado here is to bring you together! Sure, one of you does not serve heaven well, that you are so crossed.

Fal. Come up into my chamber.

[*Exeunt.*

IV. 6 SCENE VI. *The same. Another room in the Garter Inn.*

Enter FENTON and HOST.

Host. Master Fenton, talk not to me; my mind is heavy: I will give over all.

Fent. Yet hear me speak. Assist me in my purpose,
And, as I am a gentleman, I'll give thee
5 A hundred pound in gold more than your loss.

Host. I will hear you, Master Fenton; and I will at the least keep your counsel.

Fent. From time to time I have acquainted you
With the dear love I bear to fair Anne Page;
10 Who mutually hath answer'd my affection,
So far forth as herself might be her chooser,
Even to my wish: I have a letter from her
Of such contents as you will wonder at;
The mirth whereof so larded with my matter,
15 That neither singly can be manifested,
Without the show of both; fat Falstaff
Hath a great scene: the image of the jest
I'll show you here at large. Hark, good mine host.

To-night at Herne's oak, just 'twixt twelve and one,
20 Must my sweet Nan present the Fairy Queen;
The purpose why, is here: in which disguise,
While other jests are something rank on foot,
Her father hath commanded her to slip
Away with Slender, and with him at Eton

IV. 6.

25 Immediately to marry: she hath consented:

Now, sir,
Her mother, even strong against that match,
And firm for Doctor Caius, hath appointed
That he shall likewise shuffle her away,
While other sports are tasking of their minds,
And at the deanery, where a priest attends,
Straight marry her: to this her mother's plot
She seemingly obedient likewise hath
Made promise to the doctor. Now, thus it rests:
35 Her father means she shall be all in white;
And in that habit, when Slender sees his time
To take her by the hand and bid her go,
She shall go with him: her mother hath intended,
The better to denote her to the doctor,—
40 For they must all be mask'd and vizarded,—
That quaint in green she shall be loose enrobed,
With ribands pendent, flaring 'bout her head;
And when the doctor spies his vantage ripe,
To pinch her by the hand, and, on that token,
45 The maid hath given consent to go with him.

Host. Which means she to deceive, father or mother?

Fent. Both, my good host, to go along with me:
And here it rests,—that you'll procure the vicar
To stay for me at church 'twixt twelve and one,

IV. 6.

50 And, in the lawful name of marrying,
To give our hearts united ceremony.

Host. Well, husband your device; I'll to the vicar:
Bring you the maid, you shall not lack a priest.

Fent. So shall I evermore be bound to thee;
55 Besides, I'll make a present recompense.

[*Exeunt.*

ACT V.

v. 1 SCENE I. *A room in the Garter Inn.*

Enter FALSTAFF and MISTRESS QUICKLY.

Fal. Prithee, no more prattling; go. I'll hold. This is the third time;
I hope good luck lies in odd numbers. Away! go. They say there is
divinity in odd numbers, either in nativity, chance, or death. Away!

5 *Quick.* I'll provide you a chain; and I'll do what I can to get you a
pair of horns.

Fal. Away, I say; time wears: hold up your head, and mince.

[*Exit Mrs Quickly.*

Enter FORD.

How now, Master Brook! Master Brook, the matter will 10 be known
to-night, or never. Be you in the Park about midnight, at Herne's oak,
and you shall see wonders.

Ford. Went you not to her yesterday, sir, as you told me you had
appointed?

Fal. I went to her, Master Brook, as you see, like a 15 poor old man:
but I came from her, Master Brook, like a poor old woman. That
same knave Ford, her husband, hath the finest mad devil of jealousy
in him, Master Brook, that ever governed frenzy. I will tell you:—he
beat me grievously, in the shape of a woman; for in the shape of 20

man, Master Brook, I fear not Goliath with a weaver's beam; because I know also life is a shuttle. I am in haste; go along with me: I'll tell you all, Master Brook. Since I plucked geese, played truant, and whipped top, I knew not what 'twas to be beaten till lately. Follow v.

1.

25 me: I'll tell you strange things of this knave Ford, on whom to-night I will be revenged, and I will deliver his wife into your hand. Follow. Strange things in hand, Master Brook! Follow.

[*Exeunt.*]

v. 2 SCENE II. Windsor Park.

Enter PAGE, SHALLOW, *and* SLENDER.

Page. Come, come; we'll couch i' the castle-ditch till we see the light of our fairies. Remember, son Slender, my daughter.

Slen. Ay, forsooth; I have spoke with her, and we 5 have a nay-word how to know one another: I come to her in white, and cry, 'mum;' she cries 'budget;' and by that we know one another.

Shal. That's good too: but what needs either your 'mum' or her 'budget?' the white will decipher her well 10 enough. It hath struck ten o'clock.

Page. The night is dark; light and spirits will become it well. Heaven prosper our sport! No man means evil but the devil, and we shall know him by his horns. Let's away; follow me.

[*Exeunt.*]

v. 3 SCENE III. A street leading to the Park.

Enter MISTRESS PAGE, MISTRESS FORD, *and* DOCTOR CAIUS.

Mrs Page. Master doctor, my daughter is in green: when you see your time, take her by the hand, away with her to the deanery, and dispatch it quickly. Go before into the Park: we two must go together.

5 *Caius.* I know vat I have to do. Adieu.

Mrs Page. Fare you well, sir. [*Exit Caius.*] My husband will not rejoice so much at the abuse of Falstaff as he will chafe at the doctor's marrying my daughter: but 'tis no matter; better a little chiding than a great deal of 10 heart-break.

Mrs Ford. Where is Nan now and her troop of fairies, and the Welsh devil Hugh?

Mrs Page. They are all couched in a pit hard by Herne's oak, with obscured lights; which, at the very instant 15 of Falstaff's and our meeting, they will at once display to the night.

Mrs Ford. That cannot choose but amaze him.

Mrs Page. If he be not amazed, he will be mocked; if he be amazed, he will every way be mocked.

20 *Mrs Ford.* We'll betray him finely.

Mrs Page. Against such lewdsters and their lechery Those that betray them do no treachery.

Mrs Ford. The hour draws on. To the oak, to the oak!

[*Exeunt.*

v. 4 SCENE IV. *Windsor Park.*

Enter SIR HUGH EVANS disguised, with others as Fairies.

Evans. Trib, trib, fairies; come; and remember your parts: be pold, I pray you; follow me into the pit; and when I give the watch-'ords, do as I pid you: come, come; trib, trib.

[*Exeunt.*

v. 5 SCENE V. Another part of the Park.

Enter FALSTAFF disguised as Horne.

Fal. The Windsor bell hath struck twelve; the minute draws on. Now, the hot-blooded gods assist me! Remember, Jove, thou wast a bull for thy Europa; love set on thy horns. O powerful love! that, in some respects, 5 makes a beast a man; in some other, a man a beast. You were also, Jupiter, a swan for the love of Leda. O omnipotent Love! how near the god drew to the complexion of a goose!—A fault done first in the form of a beast;—O Jove, a beastly fault! And then another fault in the semblance 10 of a fowl;—think on't, Jove; a foul fault! When gods have hot backs, what shall poor men do? For me, I am here a Windsor stag; and the fattest, I think, i' the forest. Send me a cool rut-time, Jove, or who can blame me to piss my tallow?—Who comes here? my doe?

Enter MISTRESS FORD and MISTRESS PAGE.

15 *Mrs Ford.* Sir John! art thou there, my deer? my male deer?

Fal. My doe with the black scut! Let the sky rain potatoes; let it thunder to the tune of Green Sleeves, hail kissing-comfits, and snow eringoes; let there come a tempest 20 of provocation, I will shelter me here.

Mrs Ford. Mistress Page is come with me, sweetheart.

Fal. Divide me like a bribe buck, each a haunch: I will keep my sides to myself, my shoulders for the fellow of this walk, and my horns I bequeath your husbands. v. 5.

25 Am I a woodman, ha? Speak I like Herne the hunter? Why, now is Cupid a child of conscience; he makes restitution. As I am a true spirit, welcome!

[Noise within.]

Mrs Page. Alas, what noise?

Mrs Ford. Heaven forgive our sins!

30 *Fal.* What should this be?

Mrs Ford. }
Mrs Page. } Away, away! [*They run off.*]

Fal. I think the devil will not have me damned, lest the oil that's in me should set hell on fire; he would never else cross me thus.

Enter SIR HUGH EVANS, disguised as before; PISTOL, as Hobgoblin; MISTRESS QUICKLY, ANNE PAGE, and others, as Fairies, with tapers.

35 *Quick.* Fairies, black, grey, green, and white,
You moonshine revellers, and shades of night,
You orphan heirs of fixed destiny,
Attend your office and your quality.
Crier Hobgoblin, make the fairy oyes.

40 *Pist.* Elves, list your names; silence, you airy toys.
Cricket, to Windsor chimneys shalt thou leap:
Where fires thou find'st unraked and hearths unswept,
There pinch the maids as blue as bilberry:
Our radiant queen hates sluts and sluttery.

45 *Fal.* They are fairies; he that speaks to them shall die: I'll wink
and couch: no man their works must eye.

[*Lies down upon his face.*]

Evans. Where's Bede? Go you, and where you find a maid
That, ere she sleep, has thrice her prayers said,
Raise up the organs of her fantasy;

V. 5.

50 Sleep she as sound as careless infancy:
But those as sleep and think not on their sins,
Pinch them, arms, legs, backs, shoulders, sides, and shins.

Quick. About, about;
Search Windsor Castle, elves, within and out:
55 Strew good luck, outhes, on every sacred room;

That it may stand till the perpetual doom,
In state as wholesome as in state 'tis fit,
Worthy the owner, and the owner it.
The several chairs of order look you scour
60 With juice of balm and every precious flower:
Each fair instalment, coat, and several crest,
With loyal blazon, evermore be blest!
And nightly, meadow-fairies, look you sing,
Like to the Garter's compass, in a ring:
65 Th' expressure that it bears, green let it be,
More fertile-fresh than all the field to see;
And *Honi soit qui mal y pense* write
In emerald tufts, flowers purple, blue, and white;
Like sapphire, pearl, and rich embroidery,
70 Buckled below fair knighthood's bending knee:
Fairies use flowers for their charactery.
Away; disperse: but till 'tis one o'clock,
Our dance of custom round about the oak
Of Herne the hunter, let us not forget.

V. 5.

75 *Evans.* Pray you, lock hand in hand; yourselves in order
set;

And twenty glow-worms shall our lanterns be,
To guide our measure round about the tree.—
But, stay; I smell a man of middle-earth.

Fal. Heavens defend me from that Welsh fairy, lest he 80 transform
me to a piece of cheese!

Pist. Vile worm, thou wast o'erlook'd even in thy birth.

Quick. With trial-fire touch me his finger-end:
If he be chaste, the flame will back descend,
And turn him to no pain; but if he start,
85 It is the flesh of a corrupted heart.

Pist. A trial, come.

Evans. Come, will this wood take fire?

[They burn him with their tapers.]

Fal. Oh, Oh, Oh!

Quick. Corrupt, corrupt, and tainted in desire!
About him, fairies; sing a scornful rhyme;
90 And, as you trip, still pinch him to your time.

SONG.

Fie on sinful fantasy!
Fie on lust and luxury!
Lust is but a bloody fire,
Kindled with unchaste desire,
95 Fed in heart, whose flames aspire,
As thoughts do blow them, higher and higher.
Pinch him, fairies, mutually;
Pinch him for his villany;
Pinch him, and burn him, and turn him about,
V. 5.

100 Till candles and starlight and moonshine be out.

During this song they pinch FALSTAFF. DOCTOR CAIUS comes one way, and steals away a boy in green; SLENDER another way, and takes off a boy in white; and FENTON comes, and steals away Mrs ANNE PAGE. A noise of hunting is heard within. All the Fairies run away. FALSTAFF pulls off his buck's head, and rises.

Enter PAGE, FORD, MISTRESS PAGE and MISTRESS FORD.

Page. Nay, do not fly; I think we have watch'd you now:
Will none but Herne the hunter serve your turn?

Mrs Page. I pray you, come, hold up the jest no higher.
Now, good Sir John, how like you Windsor wives?
105 See you these, husband? do not these fair yokes
Become the forest better than the town?

Ford. Now, sir, who's a cuckold now? Master Brook, Falstaff's a knave, a cuckoldly knave; here are his horns, Master Brook: and, Master Brook, he hath enjoyed nothing 110 of Ford's but his buck-

basket, his cudgel, and twenty pounds of money, which must be paid to Master Brook; his horses are arrested for it, Master Brook.

Mrs Ford. Sir John, we have had ill luck; we could never meet. I will never take you for my love again; but 115 I will always count you my deer.

Fal. I do begin to perceive that I am made an ass.

Ford. Ay, and an ox too: both the proofs are extant.

Fal. And these are not fairies? I was three or four times in the thought they were not fairies: and yet the 120 guiltiness of my mind, the sudden surprise of my powers, drove the grossness of the foppery into a received belief, in despite of the teeth of all rhyme and reason, that they were fairies. See now how wit may be made a Jack-a-Lent, when 'tis upon ill employment!

V. 5.

125 *Evans.* Sir John Falstaff, serve Got, and leave your desires, and fairies will not pinse you.

Ford. Well said, fairy Hugh.

Evans. And leave you your jealousies too, I pray you.

Ford. I will never mistrust my wife again, till thou art 130 able to woo her in good English.

Fal. Have I laid my brain in the sun, and dried it, that it wants matter to prevent so gross o'erreaching as this?

Am I ridden with a Welsh goat too? shall I have a coxcomb of frize? Tis time I were choked with a piece of 135 toasted cheese.

Evans. Seese is not good to give putter; your nelly is all putter.

Fal. 'Seese' and 'putter'! have I lived to stand at the taunt of one that makes fritters of English? This is enough 140 to be the decay of lust and late-walking through the realm.

Mrs Page. Why, Sir John, do you think, though we would have thrust virtue out of our hearts by the head and shoulders, and have

given ourselves without scruple to hell, that ever the devil could have made you our delight?

145 *Ford*. What, a hodge-pudding? a bag of flax?

Mrs Page. A puffed man?

Page. Old, cold, withered, and of intolerable entrails?

Ford. And one that is as slanderous as Satan?

Page. And as poor as Job?

V. 5.

150 *Ford*. And as wicked as his wife?

Evans. And given to fornications, and to taverns, and sack, and wine, and metheglins, and to drinkings, and swearings, and starings, pribbles and prabbles?

Fal. Well, I am your theme: you have the start of 155 me; I am dejected; I am not able to answer the Welsh flannel; ignorance itself is a plummet o'er me: use me as you will.

Ford. Marry, sir, we'll bring you to Windsor, to one Master Brook, that you have cozened of money, to whom 160 you should have been a pander: over and above that you have suffered, I think to repay that money will be a biting affliction.

Page. Yet be cheerful, knight: thou shalt eat a posset to-night at my house; where I will desire thee to laugh at 165 my wife, that now laughs at thee: tell her Master Slender hath married her daughter.

Mrs Page. [*Aside*] Doctors doubt that: if Anne Page be my daughter, she is, by this, Doctor Caius' wife.

Enter SLENDER.

Slen. Whoa, ho! ho, father Page!

170 *Page*. Son, how now! how now, son! have you dispatched?

Slen. Dispatched!—I'll make the best in Gloucestershire know on't; would I were hanged, la, else!

Page. Of what, son?

V. 5.

175 *Slen.* I came yonder at Eton to marry Mistress Anne Page, and she's a great lubberly boy. If it had not been i' the church, I would have swung him, or he should have swung me. If I did not think it had been Anne Page, would I might never stir!—and 'tis a postmaster's boy.

180 *Page.* Upon my life, then, you took the wrong.

Slen. What need you tell me that? I think so, when I took a boy for a girl. If I had been married to him, for all he was in woman's apparel, I would not have had him.

Page. Why, this is your own folly. Did not I tell you 185 how you should know my daughter by her garments?

Slen. I went to her in white, and cried 'mum,' and she cried 'budget,' as Anne and I had appointed; and yet it was not Anne, but a postmaster's boy.

Mrs Page. Good George, be not angry: I knew of 190 your purpose; turned my daughter into green; and, indeed, she is now with the doctor at the deanery, and there married.

Enter CAIUS.

Caius. Vere is Mistress Page? By gar, I am cozened: I ha' married un garçon, a boy; un paysan, by gar, a boy; it 195 is not Anne Page: by gar, I am cozened.

Mrs Page. Why, did you take her in green?

Caius. Ay, by gar, and 'tis a boy: by gar, I'll raise all Windsor.

[*Exit.*

Ford. This is strange. Who hath got the right Anne?

V. 5.

200 *Page.* My heart misgives me:—here comes Master Fenton.

Enter FENTON and ANNE PAGE.

How now, Master Fenton!

Anne. Pardon, good father! good my mother, pardon!

Page. Now, mistress, how chance you went not with 205 Master Slender?

Mrs Page. Why went you not with master doctor, maid?

Fent. You do amaze her: hear the truth of it.
You would have married her most shamefully,
Where there was no proportion held in love.
210 The truth is, she and I, long since contracted,
Are now so sure that nothing can dissolve us.
The offence is holy that she hath committed;
And this deceit loses the name of craft,
Of disobedience, or unduteous title;
215 Since therein she doth evitate and shun
A thousand irreligious cursed hours,
Which forced marriage would have brought upon her.

Ford. Stand not amazed; here is no remedy:
In love the heavens themselves do guide the state;
220 Money buys lands, and wives are sold by fate.

Fal. I am glad, though you have ta'en a special stand to strike at me,
that your arrow hath glanced.

Page. Well, what remedy? Fenton, heaven give thee joy!

V. 5.

225 What cannot be eschew'd must be embraced.

Fal. When night-dogs run, all sorts of deer are chased.

Mrs Page. Well, I will muse no further. Master Fenton,
Heaven give you many, many merry days!
Good husband, let us every one go home,
230 And laugh this sport o'er by a country fire;
Sir John and all.

Ford. Let it be so. Sir John,

To Master Brook you yet shall hold your word;
For he to-night shall lie with Mistress Ford.

[Exeunt.]

NOTES.

NOTE I.

[I. 1. 41.](#) Master Page is called 'George' in three places, [II. 1. 134](#) and [142](#), and [V. 5. 189](#), but we have left the text of the Folios uncorrected, as the mistake may have been Shakespeare's own. It is however possible that a transcriber or printer may have mistaken 'Geo.' for 'Tho.'

In [I. 3. 89, 90](#), on the other hand, we have not hesitated to correct the reading of the Folio, substituting 'Page' for 'Ford,' and 'Ford' for 'Page,' because, as the early Quartos have the names right, it seems likely that the blunder was *not* due to Shakespeare.

NOTE II.

[I. 1. 49.](#) Here again, as in line 40, F₂ F₃ F₄ read 'good,' F₁ Q₃ 'goot,' but we have not thought it necessary to do more than give a specimen of such variations. Capell, in order to make Dr Caius's broken English consistent with itself, corrects it throughout and substitutes 'de' for 'the,' 'vill' for 'will,' and so forth. As a general rule, we have silently followed the first Folio.

NOTE III.

[I. 1. 114.](#) With regard to this and other passages which Pope, Theobald, Malone, &c. have inserted from the early Quartos, our rule has been to introduce, between brackets, such, and such only, as seemed to be absolutely essential to the understanding of the text, taking care to give in the note all those which we have rejected.

The fact that so many omissions can be supplied from such mutilated copies as the early Quartos, indicates that there may be many more omissions for the detection of which we have no clue. The text of the *Merry Wives* given in F₁ was probably printed from a carelessly written copy of the author's MS.

NOTE IV.

[I. 3. 95.](#) Perhaps, as in the *Two Gentlemen of Verona*, III. 1. 315, and other passages, some of which are mentioned by Sidney Walker in his 'Criticisms,' Vol. II. p. 13 sqq., this vexed passage may be emended by supplying a word. We venture to suggest 'the revolt of mine *anger* is dangerous.' The

recurrence of the same letters a n g e r in the word 'dangerous,' might mislead the printer's eye and cause the omission.

NOTE V.

[II. 1. 5.](#) In the copy of Johnson's Edition, which belongs to Emmanuel College, there is a MS. note of Dr Farmer's referring to Sonnet CXLVII. in support of the conjecture 'physician' for 'precisian;' we find there

'My reason, the physician to my love,' &c.

NOTE VI.

[II. 1. 194, 196.](#) Here again we have followed the early Quartos in reading 'Brook' instead of 'Broome,' the name given by Ff Q3. That the former was the original name is proved by the jest in [II. 2. 136](#), where the Folios make sheer nonsense.

Mr Halliwell suggests that the following lines, [IV. 4. 75, 76](#),

'Nay I'll to him again in name of Broome;

He'll tell me all his purpose: sure he'll come,'

were intended to rhyme and therefore favour the later reading. But in this scene there are no rhyming lines except the couplet at the end.

On the whole, it seems likely that the name was altered in the stage copies at the instance of some person of the name of Brook living at Windsor, who had sufficient acquaintance with the players, or interest with their patrons, to get it done.

NOTE VII.

[III. 1. 74, 78.](#) Mr Staunton is unquestionably right in supposing that one part of Evans's speech is spoken aside to his opponent, and the other part aloud. It is impossible else to account for the sudden change of tone. It might have been conjectured that, being a parson, he wished to appear peacefully minded, and therefore made his offers of reconciliation aloud and his menaces in an under tone, but Caius's reply shews that it was the threat which had been made aloud. Evans's valour, it would seem, had already evaporated when he had 'a great dispositions to cry' ([III. 1. 20](#)) and, besides, he had just begun to see that he was being made a laughing-stock. As his former speech (74, 75,) is also conciliatory, it was probably spoken so as to be heard by Caius only. He wished to keep up his credit for courage in the eyes of the bystanders. In the corresponding scene of the first Quartos we have the words 'Hark van urd in your ear,' and the meaning of the text may have been obscured by some omission in the Folio.

NOTE VIII.

[IV. 4. 41.](#) No doubt there is an omission here in the Folio, which may be partly supplied from the Quarto. But it is probable that Mrs Ford gave a still fuller explanation of her device and the grounds

on which the disguise was recommended to Falstaff, otherwise Page would not have been so confident of his falling into the snare.

NOTE IX.

[IV. 5. 49.](#) In the edition of 1778 Steevens reads 'Ay, sir Tike, like' ... but it is clear from Farmer's note that it should be 'Ay, sir Tike,' ... and so it is corrected in the later Editions of Steevens. In the Edition annotated by Fanner, mentioned in [note V.](#), we find another conjecture of his: 'Ay, sir, if you like,' ... or it may have been 'Ay, sir, an you like,' for the word preceding 'you' has been cut away by the binder.

NOTE X.

The [stage direction](#) of the early Quartos is: *Enter Sir Hugh like a Satyre, and boyes drest like Fayries, Mistresse Quickly, like the Queene of Fayries; they sing a song about him and afterward speake.*

The Folio enumerates at the commencement of the scene all who take part in it, including *Anne Page, Fairies, Quickly and Pistol*, and in this place has merely *Enter Fairies*. Malone introduced *Anne Page as the Fairy Queen*, and at the end, *with waxen tapers on their heads*. He however still assigned the speeches 35-39, 53-74, 82-85, and 88-90 to *Quickly*. Recent Editors have generally given them to *Anne*, on the ground that it is proved by [IV. 6. 20](#) and [V. 3. 11, 12](#), that she was to 'present the Fairy Queen,' and that the character of the speeches is unsuitable to Mrs Quickly. It has been argued, too, that the *Qui.* of the folios, line 35, may be a misprint for *Qu.*, i.e. *Queen*. This however is contradicted by the fact that Mrs Quickly plays the Queen in the early Quartos, and that the recurrence of *Qui.*, line 88, proves that the printer of the first Folio used either *Qui.* or *Qu.* indifferently as the abbreviation of *Quickly*.

Most likely, in this and other respects the play was altered by its author, but the stage MSS. were not corrected throughout with sufficient care. This will account for the mistake about the colours 'green' and 'white' in the final scene, lines 186, 190, 196.

Or we may suppose Mrs Quickly to have agreed to take Anne's part in order to facilitate her escape with Fenton.

CRITICAL APPARATUS (“Linenotes”).

Act I: Scene 1

- [6.](#) *Custalorum*] *Custos* Farmer conj.
- [7.](#) *Rato-lorum*] Ff. *Rotulorum* Q3.
- [10.](#) I] *We Steevens* (Farmer conj.).
- [12.](#) *hath*] F1 Q3 F2. *have* F3 F4.
- [19.](#) *The luce is*] *The luce* [To *Slen.* showing him his seal-ring] *is* Capell.
- [23.](#) *marring*] F1 Q3. *marrying* F2 F3 F4.
- [25.](#) *py'r lady*] *per-lady* Ff Q3.
- [26.](#) *skirts*] *shirts* Q3.
- [28.](#) *unto*] *upon* Pope.
- [30.](#) *compremisses*] *compromises* Pope.
- [32.](#) *hear*] F1 Q3. *hear of* F2 F3 F4.
- [34.](#) *take your*] F1 Q3. *take you* F2 F3 F4.
- [38.](#) *and*] *that* Pope.
- [40.](#) *goot*] F1 Q3. *good* F2 F3 F4.
- [41.](#) *Thomas*] Ff Q3. *George Theobald.* See [note \(i\)](#).
- [44.](#) *small*] F1 Q3. om. F2 F3 F4.
- [45.](#) *orld*] Ff. *world* Q3.
- [49.](#) See [note \(ii\)](#).
- [52.](#) [54.](#) [55.](#) Given to Shallow by Capell.
- [53.](#) *her father*] *his father* Capell (corrected in MS.).
- [56.](#) *possibilities*] F1 Q3. *possibility* F2 F3 F4.
- [63.](#) *well-willers*] *well-wishers* Rowe.
- [65.](#) Enter PAGE.] Edd. Enter Page. Rowe (after line 64). Halliwell (after line 69).
- [65.](#) SCENE II. Pope.
- [67.](#) *here*] F1 Q3. *here's* F2 F3 F4.
- [70.](#) *worships*] *worship's* Rowe.
- [75.](#) *thank*] *love* (Q1 Q2) Steevens (Farmer conj.).
- [77.](#) *thank*] *love* Farmer conj. MS.
- [80.](#) *Cotsall* F1 Q3.] *Cotsale* F2 F3 F4.
- [82-84.](#) *Slen ... dog*] *Shall. You'll ... confess.* *Slen. That ... not.* *Shall. 'Tis ... dog.* Farmer conj. MS.
- [98.](#) SCENE III. Pope.
- [99.](#) *king*] *council* (Q1 Q2) Warburton.
- [102.](#) *daughter?*] F1 Q3 F2 F3. *daughter.* (Q1 Q2) F4.
- [106.](#) [107.](#) *council ... counsel*] *councell ... counsell* (Q1 Q2). *councell ... councill* F1 Q3 F2. *council ... counsell* F3. *council ... council* F4.
- [107.](#) [108.](#) *you if ... you'll*] *you: if it were known in council, you'll* Harness (Johnson conj.).

[107.](#) *known*] *not known* Pope.
[114.](#) *Pistol.*] *Pistol; they carried me to the tavern and made me drunk, and afterward picked my pocket.* Malone (from Q1 Q2). See [note \(iii\)](#).
[119-120.](#) *pauca, pauca ... humour*] Evans. *Pauca, pauca.* Nym. *Slice ... humour.* Farmer conj.
[126.](#) *three*] *third* Pope.
[127.](#) *Garter*] Q3. *Gater* Ff.
[131.](#) *discreetly*] *discretions* Pope.
[146.](#) *latten*] *laten* (Q1 Q3). *latine* Ff Q3.
latten bilbo.] *latten. Bilbo!* Becket conj.
[147.](#) *thy labras here*] *my labras hear* Johnson conj.
[150.](#) *avised*] *advis'd* F4.
[151.](#) *the nuthook's humour*] *the base humour* Pope. *bace humors* (Q1 Q2).
[160.](#) *fap*] *sap* A. A. conj. *vap* Boys conj.
[161.](#) *careires*] *car-eires* Ff Q3. *careeres* Capell.
[171.](#) [Exit A. P.] Theobald.
[175.](#) [Kisses her.] Pope.
[179.](#) SCENE IV. Pope.
[186.](#) *Michaelmas*] *Martlemas* Theobald.
[188.](#) *this, coz*] *this* Q3.
[192.](#) *that that*] *that* F3 F4.
[209.](#) *mouth*] *mind* Pope.
[210.](#) *carry*] F1 Q3. *marry* F2 F3 F4.
[216.](#) *carry her*] *carry-her* F1 Q3 F2 F3. *carre-her* F4.
[228.](#) *contempt*] Theobald. *content* Ff Q3.
[230.](#) *fall*] Ff Q3. *faul'* Hanmer. *fault* Collier. *fall'* Singer. *faul* Dyce.
[234.](#) *hanged*] *hang'* F2 F3 F4.
[236.](#) SCENE V. Pope.
[249.](#) *beholding*] *beholden* Pope.
[251.](#) *like*] om. F2 F3 F4.
[275.](#) *I'll eat*] *I chuse to eat* Hanmer.

Act I: Scene 2

[SCENE II.](#)] SCENE VI. Pope.
 The same.] Capell. An outer room in Page's house. Dyce.
[3.](#) *dry*] *try* (Q1 Q2) Dyce.
[4.](#) *wringer*] Theobald. *Ringer* Ff Q3.

[11.](#) *cheese*] *seese* Dyce.

Act I: Scene 3

[SCENE III.](#)] SCENE VII. Pope.

[2.](#) *bully-rook*] *Bully Rock* Rowe, *passim*.

[10.](#) *shall ... shall*] F₁ Q₃. *will ... will* F₂ F₃ F₄.

[14.](#) *see thee froth*] *see thee, froth* Staunton.

lime] Steevens. *lyme* (Q₁ Q₂). *live* Ff Q₃.

[19.](#) *Hungarian*] Ff Q₃. *Gongarian* (Q₁ Q₂) Capell.

[22.](#) *conceited?*] Theobald here inserts (from Q₁ Q₂), *His mind is not heroic and there's the humour of it*.

[23.](#) *acquit*] *quit* Pope.

[26.](#) *minute's*] Ff. *minutes* Q₃. *minim's* Singer (Bennet-Langton conj.).

[41.](#) *carves*] Ff (Q₁ Q₂). *craves* Q₃.

[45.](#) *studied her will*] Ff Q₃. *studied her well* (Q₁ Q₂) Pope.

translated her will] Ff Q₃ (om. Q₁ Q₂). *translated her well* Pope. *translated her* Hanmer.

studied her well and translated her will Grant White. *studied her well and translated her ill* Edd. conj.

[47.](#) *anchor*] *author* Johnson conj.

[49.](#) *he*] *she* (Q₁ Q₂) Pope.

a legion] Pope. *a legend* Ff. Q₃. *legians* (Q₁). *legions* (Q₂) Capell.

[50.](#) *entertain*] Ff Q₃. *attend her* (Q₁ Q₂). *enter swine* Coleridge conj. *in her train* Anon. conj.

[55.](#) *æillades*] *illiads* Ff Q₃. *eyelids* Halliwell (Pope conj.).

[56.](#) *gilded*] *guilded* F₁ Q₃. *guided* F₂ F₃ F₄.

[64.](#) *cheaters*] (Q₁ Q₂) F₁ Q₃ F₃ F₄. *cheators* F₂. *cheater* Theobald. *escheator* Hanmer. *'cheator* Capell.

[73.](#) *tightly*] F₁. *titely* (Q₁ Q₂). *rightly* Q₃ F₂ F₃ F₄.

[74.](#) [Exit Robin. Dyce.

[76.](#) *o' the*] *oth'* F₂ F₃ F₄. *ith'* F₁ Q₃.

[77.](#) *learn*] *earn* Anon. conj.

humour] (Q₁ Q₂) Theobald. *honour* Ff Q₃.

the] Ff Q₃. *this* (Q₁ Q₂) Capell.

[78.](#) [Exeunt Falstaff and Robin.] Rowe. [Exit. Dyce.

[79.](#) SCENE VIII. Pope.

fullam holds] *fullams hold* Hanmer.

[80.](#) *beguiles*] *beguile* Hanmer.

[83.](#) *operations*] Ff Q₃. *operations in my head* (Q₁ Q₂) Pope.

[85.](#) *star*] *fairies* (Q1 Q2). *stars* Collier MS.
[88.](#) *discuss*] *disclose* Pope.
[88, 89.](#) *Page ... Ford*] (Q1 Q2) Steevens. *Ford ... Page* Ff Q3. See [note \(i\)](#).
[93.](#) *Page*] Steevens. *Ford* Ff Q3.
[94.](#) *yellowness*] *jealousies* Pope.
[95.](#) *the*] *this* Pope.
[95.](#) *mine*] *mien* Theobald. *mind* Jackson conj. *meisne* or *men* Anon. conj. See [note \(iv\)](#).

Act I: Scene 4

[SCENE IV.](#)] SCENE IX. Pope.

[4.](#) *an*] om. Pope.
[19.](#) *wee*] *whey* Capell.
[20.](#) *Cain*] F3 F4. *Kane* (Q1 Q2). *Caine* F1 Q3 F2. *cane* Pope.
[31.](#) [Exit. Grant White.
[34.](#) [Shuts S. in the closet] Rowe.
[38.](#) SCENE X. Pope.
des toys] F3 F4. *des-toyes* F1 Q3 F2. *dese toys* Theobald.
[39.](#) *un boitier*] Rowe. *unboyteene* F1 F2 Q3. *unboyteen* F3 F4.
[44, 45.](#) *ma foi ... affaire*] Rowe. *mai* (*moi* F2 F3 F4) *foy*, *il fait for chando*, *le man voi a le Court la grand affaires*. Ff Q3.
[47.](#) *dépêche*] *de-peech* Ff Q3.
[51.](#) *Jack Rugby*] *Jack Rogoby* Halliwell.
[52.](#) *take-a*] *take* Q3.
[56.](#) *vill*] *will* F2 F3 F4.
[60.](#) *villain*] Q3. *villainie* Ff.
[61.](#) *larron*] *La-roone* Ff Q3.
 [Pulling S. out] Theobald.
[63, 66.](#) *shall*] F1 Q3. *should* F2 F3 F4.
[78.](#) *baille*] *ballow* Ff Q3. *baillez* Theobald.
[83.](#) *you*] *yoe* F1 Q3. *for* F2 F3 F4. om. Capell.
[84.](#) *the French*] Ff. *that French* Q3.
[86.](#) *wring*] *ring* Ff Q3.
[96.](#) *give-a*] F1 Q3. *givie-a* F2 F3 F4.
[97, 98, 100.](#) *will*] *vill* Pope.
[101.](#) *throw*] F1 Q3. *trow* F2 F3 F4.
[103.](#) *ver*] Ff Q3. *for* Capell.

- [106.](#) *Jarteer*] F1 Q3 F2 F3. *Garter* F4.
[109.](#) *good-jeer*] *goujeres* Hanmer. *goujere* Johnson. *good year* Capell.
[120.](#) SCENE XI. Pope.
[131.](#) *above*] *about* Steevens.
[132.](#) *what of that?*] *and what of that?* Pope.
[142.](#) *we will*] *I will* Halliwell MS.

Act II: Scene 1

- [1.](#) *I*] om. F1.
[5.](#) *physician*] Dyce (Johnson conj.). *precisian* Ff Q3. See [note \(v\)](#).
[8.](#) *you*] F1 F3 F4. *yout* Q3. *your* F2.
[9.](#) *at the least*] *at the last* F4.
soldier] F1 Q3 F2. *a soldier* F3 F4.
[19.](#) *an*] om. F3 F4.
[20.](#) *with the*] *i' th'*] F3 F4.
[25.](#) *putting*] *pulling* Jackson conj.
men] *fat men* Theobald. *mum* Hanmer.
[28.](#) SCENE II. Pope.
[30.](#) *coming*] *going* Q3.
[45.](#) *What? thou liest!*] *What thou liest?* F1 Q3 F2 F3. *What, thou liest!* F4.
[46.](#) *will hack*] *will lack* Warburton. *we'll hack* Johnson conj.
[51.](#) *praised*] Theobald. *praise* Ff Q3.
[55.](#) *place*] *pace* Capell conj.
[55, 56.](#) *Hundredth Psalm*] Rowe. *hundred Psalms* Ff Q3.
[57.](#) *tuns*] Ff Q3. *tun* Rowe. *tons* Dyce.
[67.](#) *sure*] F1 Q3. *sue* F2 F3 F4. *nay* Rowe.
[78.](#) *know*] *knew* F4.
strain] *stain* Pope.
[97.](#) [They retire] Theobald.
[98.](#) SCENE III. Pope.
[102-104.](#) Printed as prose in Ff Q3.
[103.](#) *one*] *and one* F4.
[104.](#) *the*] F1 Q3. *thy* F2 F3 F4. *a* Anon. (N. & Q.) conj.
[107.](#) *he*] om. F3 F4.
[113, 114.](#) *Away ... sense*] *Away Sir Corporal!* Nym. *Believe ... sense.* Johnson conj.
[117.](#) *hath*] *have* Q3.

- [119.](#) *bite ... He*] *bite—upon my necessity, he* Warburton conj.
- [121.](#) *avouch; 'tis*] F1 Q3 F2. *avouch, tis* F3 F4.
- [123.](#) [*and there's the humour of it*] These words, not found in Ff Q3 are added from Q1 Q2 by Capell.
- [126.](#) *English*] humour Pope (from Q1 Q2).
- his*] *its* Pope.
- [128.](#) *drawling, affecting*] F2 F3 F4. *drawling-affecting* F1 Q3.
- [133.](#) [*Mrs ... forward.*] Theobald.
- SCENE IV. Page and Ford meeting their wives. Pope.
- [140.](#) *head. Now,*] *head, Now:* F1. *head, Now,* Q3. *head. Now:* F2 F3 F4. *head now.* Johnson.
- [149.](#) *have*] *would have* S. Walker conj.
- [151.](#) SCENE V. Pope.
- [163.](#) *this*] *his* Pope.
- [175.](#) SCENE VI. Pope.
- [176, 180.](#) *Cavaleiro*] F1 Q3 F2. *Cavalerio* F3 F4.
- [184.](#) *my*] om. Rowe
- [186.](#) *hath*] om. Q3. *he hath* Warburton.
- [192-194.](#) This speech is given to Shallow in Ff, to Ford in Q3.
- [194, 196.](#) *Brook*] (Q1 Q2) Pope. Broome Ff Q3. See [note \(vi\)](#).
- [197.](#) *An-heires*] F1 Q3 F2. *An-heirs* F3. *an-heirs* F4. *mynheers* Theobald conj. *on, here* Id. conj. *on, heris* Warburton. *on, hearts* Heath conj. *on, heroes* Steevens conj. *and hear us* Malone conj. *cavaleires* Singer (Boaden conj.). *eh, sir* Becket conj.
- [207.](#) *hear*] *have* Hanmer.
- [209.](#) *stands*] *stand* F4.
- [210.](#) *frailty*] *fealty* Theobald. *fidelity* Collier MS.

Act II: Scene 2

- [SCENE II.](#)] SCENE VII. Pope.
- [3.](#) *open*] *open.* —*I will retort the sum in equipage.* Theobald (from Q1 Q2). *open.* — ... *equipoize* Jackson conj.
- [6.](#) *coach-fellow*] *couch-fellow* Theobald.
- [12.](#) *Didst not thou*] F1 Q3 F2. *Didst thou not* F3 F4.
- [17.](#) *throng*] (Q1 Q2) Ff Q3. *thong* Pope.
- [20.](#) *terms*] *termes* F1 Q3. *terme* F2. *term* F3 F4.
- honour*] *honor* F1.
- I, I, I*] *I* Pope. *I, ay, I* Grant White.
- [21.](#) *God*] (Q1 Q2). *heaven* Ff Q3.

- [23.](#) *yet you, rogue,*] Pope. *yet, you rogue*, Ff Q3. *yet you, you rogue*, Collier MS.
- [24.](#) *rags*] *rages* Becket conj. *brags* Singer (Anon., N. & Q., conj.).
- [25.](#) *bold-beating*] *bull-baiting* Hanmer. *bold-bearing* Warburton. *bold cheating* Heath conj. *blunderbust* Halliwell MS.
- [27.](#) *relent*] Ff Q3. *recant* (Q1 Q3).
would thou] *would'st thou* Pope. *would you* Anon. conj.
- [30.](#) SCENE VIII. Pope.
- [43.](#) *on: Mistress*] *one Mistress* Grant White (Douce conj.).
- [48.](#) *God*] (Q1 Q2). *Heaven* Ff Q3.
- [63.](#) *in*] om. Hanmer.
- [66.](#) *this*] *of a* Collier MS.
- [104.](#) *loves*] *love* Rowe.
- [110.](#) *she is one*] *truly she is one* Rowe.
- [116.](#) *need*] *heede* Q3.
- [123.](#) *punk*] *pink* Warburton.
- [124.](#) *your fights*] *yond' frigat* Hanmer (Warburton conj.).
- [125.](#) *them all*] *all* Q3.
[Exit] Rowe.
- [131.](#) SCENE IX. Pope.
- [131.](#) [136.](#) *Brook, Brooks*] Pope (from Q1 Q2). *Broome, Broomes* Ff Q3, and passim. See [note \(vi\)](#).
- [137.](#) *that o'erflow*] Capell. *that oreflows* Ff. *that that ore'flowes* Q3. *that o'erflow with* Pope.
- [139.](#) *Bless*] F4. 'Bless F1 Q3 F2 F3. *God save* (Q1 Q2).
- [156.](#) *all, or half*] *half, or all* Collier MS.
- [167.](#) *imperfection*] *imperfections* Pope.
- [178.](#) *fee'd*] *free'd* Q3.
- [180.](#) *bought*] *brought* Q3.
- [185.](#) *jewel that*] F4. *jewel, that* F1 Q3 F2 F3. *jewel; that* Theobald.
that] om. Rowe.
- [215.](#) *vehemency*] *vehemence* F4.
- [219.](#) *soul*] *suit* Collier MS.
- [225.](#) *other her*] *other* Pope.
too, too] *too-too* Ff Q3. *too* Rowe.
- [231.](#) *I say you shall*] *Master Brooke, I say you shall* (Q1 Q2) Theobald.
- [242.](#) *cuckoldly*] *cuckoldy* Rowe.
- [246.](#) *cuckoldly rogue's*] F1 Q3. *cuckold-rogue's* F2 F3 F4.
- [257.](#) SCENE X. Pope.
- [261.](#) *false*] *fair* Q3.

[263.](#) *this wrong*] *the wrong* Pope.

[267.](#) *Wittol!—Cuckold*] *Wittoll, Cuckold* Ff Q3. *wittol-cuckold* Malone.

[276.](#) *God*] (Q1 Q2). *Heaven* Ff Q3.

Act II: Scene 3

[SCENE III.](#)] SCENE XI. Pope.

[3.](#) *de*] F3 F4. *the* F1 Q3 F2.

[11.](#) *is no dead so as I vill kill him*] Ff Q3. *is not so dead as me vill make him* Pope. *be not so dead as I shall make him* (Q1 Q2).

[21.](#) *tree*] *trees* F4.

[25.](#) *Francisco*] *Frånçeyes* (Q1 Q2) Warburton.

[26.](#) *Galen*] *Gallon* (Q1 Q2). *Galien* F1 F2. *Gallen* Q3 F3 F4.

[29.](#) *world*] *varld* Hanmer.

[30.](#) *Castalion*] *Castallian* (Q1 Q2). *Cardalion* Hanmer. *Castillian* Capell.

[41.](#) *the*] F1 Q3. om. F2 F3 F4.

[51.](#) *A word*] Theobald (from Q1 Q2). *A* Ff Q3. *Ah* Hanmer.

[51.](#) [54.](#) *Mock-water*] *Muck-water* Malone (Farmer conj.).

[71.](#) *by*] om. F3 F4.

[80.](#) *Cried I aim?*] Dyce (Douce conj.). *Cried game* (Q1 Q2). *Cride-game* Ff Q3. *Try'd game* Theobald. *Cock o' th' game* Hanmer. *Cry aim* Warburton. *and cry 'amie'* Becket conj. *Dry'd game* Jackson conj. *Curds and cream* Collier MS.

[89.](#) This line given to *Host* in F3 F4.

Act III: Scene 1

[5.](#) *pittie-ward*] F1 Q3. *pitty-wary* F2 F3 F4. *city-ward* Capell. *pit way* Collier MS. *the park-ward*] *the park way* Collier MS.

[7.](#) *also*] om. Q3.

[10.](#) *chollors*] F1 Q3 F2. *chollars* F3 F4.

[14.](#) *sings*] Ff. *sing* Q3.

[15.](#) [19.](#) [24.](#) [27.](#) *To shallow*] (Q1 Q2) Ff Q3. *By shallow* Theobald.

[18.](#) *fragrant*] (Q1 Q2) Ff. *vagram* Q3. *vragrant* Hanmer. *vagrant* Johnson.

[20.](#) *dispositions*] F1 Q3. *disposition* F2 F3 F4.

[21.](#) *madrigals*] *madrigall* F2 F3 F4.

[23.](#) *vagram*] Ff Q3. *vagrant* Pope. *vragant* Hanmer. *vagrant* Johnson.

[27.](#) *to whose*] *in whose* Q3.

- [34.](#) SCENE II. Pope.
- [36.](#) *student*] F3 F4. *student* F1 Q3 F2.
- [37.](#) [65.](#) [105.](#) [Aside] Edd.
- [62.](#) *desires*] F1 Q3. *desire* F2 F3 F4.
- [66.](#) SCENE III. Pope.
- [68.](#) *in*] om. Q3.
- [74.](#) [Aside...] Edd. See [note \(vii\)](#).
- [78.](#) [Aside...] Staunton.
- Pray you*] *I pray you* Q3.
- laughing-stocks*] *laughing stogs* J. rec. Edd.
- [81.](#) [Aloud] Staunton.
- your*] *your your* F4. *you your* Rowe.
- urinals*] (Q1 Q2) Capell. *urinal*] Ff Q3.
- [82.](#) [for ... *appointments*] Pope (from Q1 Q2). om. Ff Q3.
- [89.](#) *Gallia and Gaul*] F3 F4. *Gallia and Gaule* F1 Q3 F2. *Gawle and Gawlia* (Q1 Q2). *Gallia and Wallia* Halliwell MS. Hanmer. *Guallia and Gaul* Malone (Farmer conj.). *Gallia and Guallia* Collier (Farmer MS. conj.).
- [95.](#) *lose my parson, my priest*] *lose my Priest* Pope.
- [96.](#) [Give me thy hand, *terrestrial*; so] Theobald (from Q1 Q2). om. Ff Q3. *Give me thy hands, celestial and terrestrial*; so. Collier MS.
- [101.](#) *lads*] (Q1 Q2) Warburton. *lad* Ff Q3.
- [108.](#) *vlouting-stog*] *vlouting-stock* Pope.
- [110.](#) *scall*] *scald* Pope. *Scal'* Capell.
- [112.](#) *with*] *vith* Hanmer. *vit* rec. Capell.
- [113.](#) *where*] *vhere* Pope. *ver* Hanmer. *vere* rec. Capell.

Act III: Scene 2

- [SCENE II.](#)] SCENE IV. Pope.
- [11.](#) *company*] *your company* Collier MS.
- [19.](#) Ford. *Sir John Falstaff!*] omitted in F3 F4 and Rowe.
- [20.](#) *on's*] *on his* Rowe.
- [25.](#) SCENE V. Pope.
- [37.](#) [Clock heard] Capell.
- [39.](#) *search: there*] *search where* Collier MS.
- [42.](#) SCENE VI. Pope.
- [46-48.](#) Printed as verse in Ff Q3 and Rowe.
- [47.](#) *her*] *here* F2.

- [59.](#) *April*] *all April* (Q1 Q2).
[60.](#) *buttons*] *betmes* (Q1 Q2). *destiny* Anon. conj.
[63.](#) *Poins*] *Poyntz* F1 Q3 F2. *Poinz* F3 F4.

Act III: Scene 3

- [SCENE III.](#)] SCENE VII. Pope.
[7, 8.](#) Mrs Ford. *Marry ... Robert*] omitted in Q3.
[20.](#) *your*] *the* Q3.
[36.](#) SCENE VIII. Pope. *thee*] Ff Q3 om. (Q1 Q2) Dyce.
[38.](#) *my*] om. Q3.
[41.](#) *Mistress*] *Master* Q3.
[49.](#) *tire-valiant*] Ff Q3. *tire-vellet* (Q1 Q2). *tire-vailant* Warburton. *tire-velvet* Heath conj. *tire-volant* Becket conj.
tire of Venetian admittance] Ff Q3. *Venetian attire* (Q1 Q2) Pope. *tire of Venetian addition* Hanmer.
[52.](#) *By the Lord, thou art a traitor*] (Q1 Q2) Singer. *Thou art a tyrant* Ff Q3. *Thou art a traitor* Warburton. *By the Lord, thou art a tyrant* Collier.
[53.](#) *fixture*] F1 Q3. *fixure* F2 F3 F4.
[55, 56.](#) *foe were not, Nature*] F2 F3 F4. *foe, were not Nature* F1 Q3. *foe were not; Nature is* Capell.
[58.](#) *persuade thee there's*] *persuade thee There's* (Q1 Q2). *persuade Thee. There's* Ff Q3.
[62.](#) *simple*] F1 Q3 F2. *simpling* F3 F4.
[74.](#) [Within] F2. Re-enter Robin. Capell.
[75.](#) *sweating*] F1 Q3. *swearing* F2 F3 F4.
[81.](#) SCENE IX. Pope.
Re-enter...] Enter Mis. Page. F2.
[96.](#) *'Tis not so*] *Speak louder. 'Tis not so* Theobald (from Q1 Q2).
[110.](#) *and*] om. Q3.
[119.](#) [Coming forward] Enter F. Rowe. [Starting from his concealment. Capell.
[124.](#) *I love thee*] Ff Q3. *I love thee and none but thee* (Q1 Q2) Malone.
[125.](#) [Gets ... linen.] Rowe.
[128.](#) *John! Robert*] *John Rugby* Q3.
[Exit Robin.] Malone.
[132.](#) SCENE X. Pope.
[134.](#) *How now!*] *How now? who goes here?* Halliwell (from Q1 Q2). *How now! what's here?* S. Verges conj.

[140.](#) [Exeunt ... basket.] Rowe.
[144.](#) [Locking the door.] Capell.
[144, 145.](#) *So, now uncape*] om. Pope. *So, now uncouple* Hanmer.
[155.](#) SCENE XI. Pope.
[159.](#) *who*] *what* Grant White (Ritson conj.).
[170.](#) *foolish*] F2 F3 F4. *foolishion* F1 Q3. *foolish eye on—carry on* Jackson conj.
[174.](#) *to-morrow, eight*] F1 Q3. *to-morrow by eight* F2 F3 F4.
[178.](#) [Aside to Mrs Ford] Capell.
[179.](#) *You use...*] *I, I; peace;—You use...* Theobald (from Q1 Q2).
[180.](#) *Ay, I*] *I, I* F1 Q3 F2. *I, I, I* F3 F4.
[181.](#) *you*] *me* Capell conj.
[188.](#) *at the day of judgement*] F1 Q3. om. F2 F3 F4.
[211.](#) Theobald inserts (from Q1 Q2) Evans. *In your teeth: for shame!*

Act III: Scene 4

[SCENE IV.](#)] SCENE XII. Pope.
[7.](#) *Besides these, other*] Ff Q3. *Besides, these other* S. Walker conj.
[12.](#) *my*] *the* Capell (altered to *my* in his own hand).
[20.](#) *opportunity*] *importunity* Hanmer.
[22.](#) SCENE XIII. Pope.
[28.](#) *but that*] F1 Q3 F2. *but* F3 F4.
[40.](#) *pen*] *henloft* (Q1 Q2) Halliwell.
[62.](#) *my*] om. Q3.
 hath] *have* F4.
[65.](#) *ask*] om. Q3.
[66.](#) SCENE XIV. Pope.
[67.](#) *Fenton*] *Fenter* F1.
[75.](#) *mind*] *wind* F2.
[80.](#) *of*] *or* Q3.
[85, 86.](#) Anne. *Alas, ... turnips!*] Anne. *Alas, ... earth.* Quick. *And ... turnips* Warburton.
[92.](#) *angry*] *angry else* S. Verges conj.
[93.](#) *gentle*] *my gentle* Capell.
[95.](#) *and*] *or* Hanmer.

Act III: Scene 5

[SCENE V.](#)] SCENE XV. Pope.

[5.](#) *in*] *into* Rowe.

[9.](#) *blind bitch's*] *bitch's blind* Hanmer.

[16.](#) *mummy*] *mummy. Now, is the sack brewed?* Theobald (from Q1 Q2).

[22.](#) SCENE XVI. Pope.

[24.](#) *pottle*] *posset* R. G. White.

[60.](#) *sped you*] *you sped* Rowe.

[62.](#) *How so, sir*] F1 Q3 F2. *How Sir* F3 F4.

[65.](#) *me*] om. F4.

[77.](#) *in*] by (Q1 Q2) Theobald.

distraction] *direction* Hanmer.

[80.](#) *By the Lord*] (Q1 Q2) Malone. *yes* F1 Q3. *yea* F2 F3 F4.

[83.](#) *smell*] *smells* Hanmer.

[96.](#) *several*] *egregious* (Q1 Q2) Pope.

[106.](#) *in*] *is* F2.

[107.](#) *surge*] *forge* Capell conj.

[110.](#) *have suffered*] *suffered* F4.

[130.](#) *nor*] *not* Q3.

[134.](#) *one*] *me* Dyce.

[Exit.] Rowe. [Exeunt. Ff Q3.

Act IV: Scene 1

[\[A Street\]](#) Capell. Page's House. Pope.

[10.](#) *let*] *get* Collier MS.

[25.](#) *polecats*] *powlcat* Q3.

[41.](#) *Accusativo*] *accusative* F3 F4.

hinc] *hunc* Halliwell.

[43.](#) *hung*] Pope. *hing* Ff Q3.

[56.](#) *Jenny's*] *Ginyes* Ff Q3.

[63.](#) *lunaties*] Ff Q3. *lunacies* Rowe. *lunaticks* Capell.

[64.](#) *of*] *and* Collier MS.

[65.](#) *desires*] *desire* Pope.

[70.](#) [71.](#) *quæ ... quæ*] *que ... ques* Ff Q3.

Act IV: Scene 2

- [18.](#) *lunes*] Theobald. *lines* Ff Q3. *vaine* (Q1 Q2).
- [33.](#) *street*] F1 Q3. *streets* F2 F3 F4.
- [39.](#) Re-enter F.] Enter. F2.
- [40.](#) SCENE III. Pope.
- [43.](#) *pistols*] *Pistol* Jackson conj.
- [48.](#) *Creep into the kiln-hole*] Given to Mrs Page by Dyce (Malone conj.).
- [55.](#) Mrs Page] (Q1 Q2) Malone. Mist. Ford. Ff Q3.
- [57.](#) Mrs Ford] om. F2 F3 F4.
- [62.](#) *a mischief*] *mischief* F4.
- [63.](#) [73.](#) [85.](#) [150.](#) [and passim.](#) Brentford] Brainford (Q1 Q2) Ff Q3.
- [66.](#) *thrummed*] *thrum'd* F1 F2 F3. *thrumb* F4.
- [89.](#) *him*] F2 F3 F4. om. F1 Q3.
- [98.](#) *knight*] F1 Q3. *the knight* F2 F3 F4.
- [99.](#) *as lief*] F2 F3 F4. *lief* as F1 Q3.
- [100.](#) SCENE IV. Pope.
- [102.](#) *villain*] *villains* Dyce.
- Youth in a basket*] *you youth in a basket come out here* Malone (from Q1 Q2).
- [103.](#) *ging*] F2 F3 F4. *gin* F1 Q3 *gang* Rowe.
- [104.](#) *shamed*] *ashamed* F2.
- [105.](#) *wife*] om. Rowe.
- [159.](#) *not*] om. F1.
- [160.](#) SCENE V. Pope.
- Re-enter ... clothes] Rowe. Enter Fal. Ff. and Mistress Page] Pope.
- [163.](#) *hag*] F3 F4. *ragge* F1. *hagge* Q3. *rag* F2.
- [170.](#) *By yea and no*] *By Jeshu* (Q1 Q2).
- [171.](#) *'oman*] *'omans* Q3.
- [172.](#) *his*] Ff Q3. *her* (Q1 Q2) Pope.
- [175.](#) *trail*] F1 Q3 F2 F3. *Tryal* F4.
- [188.](#) *fine*] *find* Q3.
- [193.](#) *brains*] *brain* F3 F4.
- [197.](#) *period*] *right period* Hanmer.
- [198.](#) *the jest*] *jest* Q3.
- [199.](#) *it, then; shape it:] it, then shape it:* Ff Q3.

Act IV: Scene 3

[SCENE III.](#)] SCENE VI. Pope.

- [1.](#) *Germans desire*] Capell. *Germane desires* Ff Q3.
- [7.](#) *Ay*] om. F3 F4.
- [9.](#) *house*] (Q1 Q2) Rowe. *houses* Ff Q3.
- [11.](#) *come off*] *compt off* Theobald (Warburton). *not come off* Capell.

Act IV: Scene 4

[SCENE IV.](#)] SCENE VII. Pope.

- [1.](#) *'oman*] *o'mans* Q3.
- [7.](#) *cold*] Rowe. *gold* Ff Q3.
- [9.](#) *as faith*] F1 Q3. *of faith* F2 F3 F4.
- [11.](#) *as extreme*] F1 Q3. om. *as* F2 F3 F4.
- [11.](#), [12.](#) Printed in one line in Ff Q3.
- [20.](#) *say*] see Collier MS.
in the rivers] F1 Q3. *into the river* F2 F3 F4.
- [22.](#) *terrors*] *terror* Q3.
- [29.](#) *midnight*] F1 Q3. *of midnight* F2 F3 F4.
- [30.](#) *great ragg'd*] *ragged* Pope.
- [31.](#) *tree*] *trees* Hanmer.
- [41.](#) Here Theobald inserts from Q1 Q2, *We'll send him word to meet us in the field, Disguised like Herne* [*Horne* Q1 Q2] *with huge horns on his head*. Malone gives the second line only. See [note \(VIII\)](#).
- [56.](#) *to-pinch*] Steevens (Tyrwhitt conj.).] *to pinch* Ff Q3. *too, pinch* Warburton.
fairy-like, to-pinch] *like to fairies pinch* Hanmer.
- [60.](#) *him sound*] F2 F3 F4. *him, sound*, F1 Q3. *him round*, Pope. *him soundly* Collier MS.
- [67.](#) *taber*] *taper* Pope.
- [72.](#) *time*] *tire* Theobald.
- [75.](#) *in name*] *in the name* Q3.
- [86.](#) *he*] *him* Hanmer.

Act IV: Scene 5

[SCENE V.](#)] SCENE VIII. Pope.

- [2.](#) *snap*] *nap* Q3.
- [17.](#) [Above] Theobald. Enter Falstaff. Rowe. om. Ff Q3.
- [27.](#) *Master Slender*] Steevens. *my master Slender*, Ff Q3.

- [28.](#) *thorough*] F₁ Q₃. *through* F₂ F₃ F₄.
- [39.](#) Sim. *I may...*] Rowe. Fal. *I may...* Ff Q₃. Fal. *You may...* Collier MS.
- [40.](#) Host.] Fal. Warburton.
Conceal them, or] *Conceal them, and* Hanmer. *Aye conseil them or* Becket conj.
- [39.](#) [40.](#) *conceal, Conceal*] *reveal, Reveal* Farmer conj.
- [42.](#) *master's*] *master* Q₃.
- [49.](#) *Ay, sir; like*] Ff Q₃. *I tike*, (Q₁ Q₂). *Ay, sir Tike*, Steevens (Farmer conj.). *Ay, sir, tike*, Collier. See [note \(ix\)](#).
- [58.](#) SCENE IX. Pope.
- [61.](#) *with*] *with by* Collier MS.
- [71.](#) *Readins*] *Reading* F₄.
- [80.](#) *grand*] *agrand* F₃ F₄.
- [85.](#) [Exeunt H. and B.] Capell. [Exit F₂. om. F₁ Q₃.
- [94.](#) [*to say my prayers*] (Q₁ Q₂) Pope. om. Ff Q₃.
- [95.](#) *repent*] *pray and repent* Collier MS.
- [96.](#) SCENE X. Pope.
- [110.](#) *an old woman*] *a wode woman* Theobald.

Act IV: Scene 6

- [SCENE VI.](#)] Ff Q₃. SCENE XI. Pope. Theobald continues Sc. 5.
The same] Another room. Capell.
- [14.](#) *whereof*] *whereof's* Pope.
- [16.](#) *fat Falstaff*] F₁ Q₃. *wherein fat Falstaff* (Q₁ Q₂) Malone. *fat sir John Falstaffe* F₂ F₃ F₄.
fat Falstaff, he S. Walker conj. *therein fat Falstaff* Id. conj.
- [17.](#) *scene*] *scare* (Q₁ Q₂). *share* S. Verges conj. *scene in it* Capell.
- [27.](#) *even*] *ever* Pope.
- [39.](#) *denote*] Capell (Steevens conj.). *devote* Ff Q₃.
- [50.](#) *marrying*] *marriage* S. Walker conj.
- [51.](#) *ceremony*] *matrimony* (Q₁ Q₂).

Act V: Scene 1

- [ACT V. SCENE I.](#)] ACT IV. (continued). SCENE XII. Pope.

Act V: Scene 2

- [SCENE II.](#)] ACT V. SCENE I. Pope.

Windsor Park] Pope. [A street. Capell.
[3.](#) *daughter*] om. F₁ Q₃.

Act V: Scene 3

[SCENE III.](#)] SCENE II. Pope.
A street, &c.] [Another street, &c. Capell.
[12.](#) *Hugh*] Capell. *Herne* Ff Q₃. *Evans* Theobald (Thirlby conj.).
[19.](#) *every way*] F₁ Q₃. om. F₂ F₃ F₄.

Act V: Scene 4

[SCENE IV.](#)] Scene II. continued in Pope.
[3.](#) *pid*] F₁ Q₃. *bid* F₂ F₃ F₄.

Act V: Scene 5

[SCENE V.](#)] SCENE III. Pope.
[Enter F...](#)] Enter Sir John with a Buck's head upon him (Q₁ Q₂).
[22.](#) *bribe*] Theobald. *brib'd* Ff Q₃.
[32-34.](#) Printed as verse in Ff Q₃.
[34.](#) Enter ... tapers] See [note \(x\)](#).
[35.](#) Quick.] Qui. Ff Q₃.
[37.](#) *orphan*] *ouphan* Theobald (Warburton).
[41.](#) *shalt thou leap*] *when thou'st leapt* Collier MS. *having leapt* Singer.
[42.](#) *unswept*] *to sweep* S. Verges conj.
[46.](#) [Lies ... face] Rowe.
[47.](#) *Bede*] Ff Q₃. *Pede* Theobald. *Pead* (Q₁ Q₂).
[51.](#) *as*] *that* F₄.
[53.](#) Quick.] Qu. F₁ Q₃ F₂. Qui. F₃ F₄.
[57.](#) *state as*] *site as* Hanmer. *seat as* S. Walker conj.
[58.](#) *and*] *as* Theobald (Warburton).
[63.](#) *nightly, meadow-fairies,*] Capell. *Nightly-meadow-Fairies* Ff Q₃.
[66.](#) *More*] *Mote* F₁ Q₃.
[68.](#) *emerald tufts*] *Emrold-tuffes* Ff Q₃.
purple] *purpled* Warburton.
[69.](#) *sapphire, pearl*] Theobald. *saphire-pearle* Ff Q₃.
and] *in* Warburton.

- [75.](#) *Pray you*] om. Pope.
- [86.](#) [They burn ... tapers.] Rowe.
- [90.](#) *time*] *time*. Eva. *It is right, indeed, he is full of lecheries and iniquity*. Theobald (from Q1 Q2).
- [91.](#) *sinful*] *simple* Pope.
- [93.](#) *a bloody fire*] *i' th' blood a fire*] Hanmer.
- [95.](#) *heart*] *the heart* Hanmer.
- [97.](#) *Mutually*] *mutuall* Q3.
- [100.](#) The stage direction which follows was inserted by Theobald from Q1 Q2, with some verbal changes.
- [101.](#) Enter...] Enter... They lay hold on him. Rowe.
- [101, 102.](#) Printed as prose in Ff Q3.
- [105.](#) *these, husband*] *these husband* F1 Q3. *these husbands* F2 F3 F4. *these, husbands* Hanmer.
yokes] *yoakes* F1 Q3. *okes* F2 F3. *oaks* F4. *oaks* [Pointing to the horns. Hanmer.
fair yokes] *fairy jokes* Jackson conj.
- [111.](#) *paid to Master Brook*] *paid to M. Foord* (Q1 Q2). *pay'd too, Master Brook* Capell.
- [120.](#) *the sudden*] *with the sudden* Hanmer.
- [136.](#) *nelly*] F2 F3 F4. *belly* F1 Q3.
- [148.](#) *as slanderous*] *slanderous* Q3.
- [152.](#) *sack, and wine*] *sacks, and wines* Pope.
- [153.](#) *starings*] F1 Q3. *staring* F2 F3 F4.
- [156.](#) *is a plummet o'er me*] *is plummet o'er me* Q3. *has a plume o' me* Johnson conj. *is a planet o'er me* Farmer conj.
- [162.](#) After this line Theobald inserts from Q1 Q2: *Mrs Ford. Nay, husband, let that go to make amends; Forgive that sum, and so we'll all be friends. Ford. Well, here's my hand: all is forgiven at last.*
- [167, 168.](#) Given to Mrs Ford in Q3. [Aside] Theobald.
- [169.](#) SCENE VI. Pope.
Whoa] *What* Rowe.
- [177.](#) *i' the*] *i't* F2.
- [186.](#) *white*] Pope. *green* Ff Q3.
- [190, 196.](#) *green*] Pope. *white* Ff Q3.
- [190.](#) *into*] *in* Q3.
- [193.](#) SCENE VII. Pope.
- [194.](#) *un garçon*] Capell. *oon garsoon* F1 Q3. *one garsoon* F2 F3 F4.
un paysan] Capell. *oon pesant* Ff Q3.
boy] *boe* F2 F3 F4.

[196.](#) *did you]* *did you not* Rowe.

[214.](#) *title]* *guile* Collier MS.

[225.](#) After this line Pope, followed by Theobald, inserts from Q1 Q2: Evans [aside to Fenton]

I will dance and eat plums at your wedding.

[231.](#) *Let it be so. Sir John,]* *Let it be so (Sir John:)* Ff Q3.



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A

Pleasant Conceited Comedie,

of

Syr Iohn Falstaffe,

and

the merry Wiues of *VVindsor*.

Enter Iustice Shallow, Syr Hugh, Maister Page, and Slender.

Shal. Nere talke to me, Ile make a star-chamber matter of it.
The Councell shall know it.

Page. Nay good maister *Shallow* be perswaded by mee.

Slen. Nay surely my vncle shall not put it vp so.

5 *Sir Hu.* Wil you not heare reasons M. *Slenders?*

You should heare reasons.

Shal. Tho he be a knight, he shall not thinke to carrie it so
away.

M. Page I will not be wronged. For you
Syr, I loue you, and for my cousen,
10 He comes to looke vpon your daughter.

Pa. And heres my hand, and if my daughter
Like him so well as I, wee'l quickly haue it a match:
In the meane time let me entreate you to soiourne
Here a while. And on my life Ile vndertake
15 To make you friends.

Sir Hu. I pray you *M. Shallowes* let it be so.
The matter is pud to arbitarments.
The first man is *M. Page*, videlicet *M. Page*.
The second is my selfe, videlicet my selfe.
20 The third and last man, is mine host of the gartyr.

Enter Syr Iohn Falstaffe, Pistoll, Bardolfe, and Nim.

Heere is sir *Iohn* himselfe now, looke you.

Fal. Now *M. Shallow*, youle complaine of me to the Councell,
I heare?

Shal. Sir *Iohn*, sir *Iohn*, you haue hurt my keeper,
I. 25 Kild my dogs, stolne my deere.

Fal. But not kissed your keepers daughter.

Shal. Well this shall be answered.

Fal. He answere it strait. I haue done all this.
This is now answred.

30 *Shal.* Well, the Councell shall know it.

Fal. Twere better for you twere knowne in counsell,
Youle be laught at.

Sir Hugh. Good vrdes sir *Iohn*, good vrdes.

Fal. Good vrdes, good Cabidge.
35 *Slender* I brake your head,
What matter haue you against mee?

Slen. I haue matter in my head against you and your cogging companions, *Pistoll* and *Nym*. They carried mee to the Tauerne, and made mee drunke, and afterward picked my pocket.

40 *Fal.* What say you to this *Pistoll*, did you picke Maister *Slenders* purse *Pistoll*?

Slen. I by this handkercher did he. Two faire shouell boord shillings, besides seuen groats in mill sixpences.

Fal. What say you to this *Pistoll*?

45 *Pist.* Sir *Iohn*, and Maister mine, I combat craue
Of this same laten bilbo. I do retort the lie
Euen in thy gorge, thy gorge, thy gorge.

Slen. By this light it was he then.

Nym. Syr my honor is not for many words,
1. 50 But if you run bace humors of me,
I will say mary trap. And there's the humor of it.

Fal. You heare these matters denide gentlemen,
You heare it.

Enter Mistresse Foord, Mistresse Page, and her daughter Anne.

Pa. No more now,
55 I thinke it be almost dinner time,
For my wife is come to meete vs.

Fal. *Mistresse Foord*, I think your name is,
If I mistake not.

Syr Iohn kisses her.

Mis. Ford. Your mistake sir is nothing but in the *Mistresse*.
60 But my husbands name is *Foord* sir.

Fal. I shall desire your more acquaintance.
The like of you good misteris *Page*.

Mis. Pa. With all my hart sir *Iohn*.
Come husband will you goe?
65 Dinner staies for vs.

Pa. With all my hart, come along Gentlemen.

Exit all, but Slender and Mistresse Anne.

Anne. Now forsooth why do you stay me?
What would you with me?

Slen. Nay for my owne part, I would litle or nothing with you.
70 I loue you well, and my vncle can tell you how my liuing
stands. And if you can loue me why so. If not, why then happie
man be his dole.

An. You say well M. *Slender*.
But first you must giue me leaue to
I. 75 Be acquainted with your humor,
And afterward to loue you if I can.

Slen. Why by God, there's neuer a man in christendome can
desire more. What haue you beares in your Towne mistresse
Anne, your dogs barke so?

80 *An.* I cannot tell M. *Slender*, I think there be.

Slen. Ha how say you? I warrant your afeard of a Beare let
loose, are you not?

An. Yes trust me.

Slen. Now that's meate and drinke to me,
85 He run youn to a beare, and take her by the mussell,
You neuer saw the like.
But indeed I cannot blame you,
For they are maruellous rough things.

Anne. Will yo go into dinner M. *Slendor*?
90 The meate staies for you.

Slen. No faith not I. I thanke you,
I cannot abide the smell of hot meate
Nere since I broke my shin. Ile tel you how it came
By my troth. A Fencer and I plaid three venies
95 For a dish of stewd prunes, and I with my ward
Defending my head, he hot my shin. Yes faith.

Enter Maister Page.

Pa. Come, come Maister *Slender*, dinner staies for you.

Slen. I can eate no meate, I thanke you.

Pa. You shall not choose I say.

1. 100 *Slen.* Ile follow you sir, pray leade the way.
Nay be God misteris *Anne*, you shall goe first,
I haue more manners then so, I hope.

An. Well sir, I will not be troublesome.

Exit omnes.

[SC. II.] *Enter Sir Hugh and Simple, from dinner.*

Sir Hu. Hark you *Simple*, pray you beare this letter to doctor
Cayus house, the French Doctor. He is twell vp along the street,
and enquire of his house for one mistris *Quickly*, his woman, or
his try nurse, and deliuer this Letter to her, it tis about Maister
Slender. 5 Looke you, will you do it now?

Sim. I warrant you sir.

Sir Hu. Pray you do, I must not be absent at the grace.
I will goe make an end of my dinner,
There is pepions and cheese behinde.

Exit omnes.

[SC. III.] *Enter Sir Iohn Falstaffes Host of the Garter, Nym,*
Bardolfe, Pistoll, and the Boy.

Fal. Mine Host of the Garter.

Host. What ses my bully Rooke?
Speake schollerly and wisely.

Fal. Mine Host, I must turne away some of my followers.

5 *Host.* Discard bully, *Hercules* cassire.
Let them wag, trot, trot.

Fal. I sit at ten pound a weeke.

Host. Thou art an Emperor *Cæsar*, *Phesser* and *Kesar* bully.
Ile entertaine *Bardolfe*. He shall tap, he shall draw.
10 Said I well, bully *Hector*?

Fal. Do good mine Host.

Host. I haue spoke. Let him follow. *Bardolfe*
Let me see thee froth, and lyme. I am at
A word. Follow, follow.

Exit Host.

15 *Fal.* Do *Bardolfe*, a Tapster is a good trade,
An old cloake will make a new Ierkin,
A withered seruingman, a fresh Tapster:
Follow him *Bardolfe*.

Bar. I will sir, Ile warrant you Ile make a good shift to liue.

Exit Bardolfe.

20 *Pis.* O bace gongarian wight, wilt thou the spicket willd?

Nym. His minde is not heroick. And theres the humor of it.

Fal. Well my Laddes, I am almost out at the heeles.

Pis. Why then let cybes insue.

Nym. I thanke thee for that humor.

III. 25 *Fal.* Well I am glad I am so rid of this tinder Boy.
His stealth was too open, his filching was like

An vnskilfull singer, he kept not time.

Nym. The good humour is to steale at a minutes rest.

Pis. Tis so indeed *Nym*, thou hast hit it right.

30 *Fal.* Wel, afore God, I must cheat, I must conycatch.
Which of you knowes *Foord* of this Towne?

Pis. I ken the wight, he is of substance good.

Fal. Well my honest Lads, Ile tell you what
I am about.

Pis. Two yards and more.

Fal. No gibes now *Pistoll*: indeed I am two yards
In the wast, but now I am about no wast:
Briefly, I am about thrift you rogues you,
I do intend to make loue to *Foords* wife,
40 I espie entertainment in her. She carues, she
Discourses. She giues the lyre of inuitation,
And euery part to be constured rightly is, I am
Syr Iohn Falstaffes.

Pis. Hee hath studied her well, out of honestie
45 Into English.

Fal. Now the report goes, she hath all the rule
Of her husbands purse. She hath legians of angels.

Pis. As many diuels attend her.
And to her boy say I.

III. 50 *Fal.* Heree's a Letter to her. Heeres another to misteris
Page. Who euen now gaue me good eies too, examined my
exteriors with such a greedy intention, with the beames of her
beautie, that it seemed as she would a scorged me vp like a
burning glasse. Here is another Letter to her, shee beares the
purse too. They shall be Excheckers 55 to me, and Ile be cheaters
to them both. They shall be my East and West Indies, and Ile
trade to them both. Heere beare thou this Letter to mistresse

Foord. And thou this to mistresse *Page*. Weelethriue Lads, we will thriue.

Pist. Shall I sir Panderowes of *Troy* become?

60 And by my sword were steele.

Then Lucifer take all.

Nym. Here, take your humor Letter againe,

For my part, I will keepe the hauior

Of reputation. And theres the humor of it.

65 *Fal.* Here sirrha beare me these Letters titely,

Saile like my pinnice to the golden shores:

Hence slaues, avant. Vanish like hailstones, goe.

Falstaffe will learne the humor of this age,

French thrift you rogue, my selfe and scirted *Page*.

Exit Falstaffe, and the Boy.

70 *Pis.* And art thou gone? Teaster Ile haue in pouch

When thou shalt want, bace Phrygian Turke,

Nym. I haue operations in my head, which are humors of reuenge.

Pis. Wilt thou reuenge?

III. 75 *Nym.* By *Welkin* and her Fairies.

Pis. By wit, or sword?

Nym. With both the humors I will disclose this loue to *Page*.

He poses him with Iallowes,

And theres the humor of it.

80 *Pis.* And I to *Foord* will likewise tell

How *Falstaffe* varlot vilde,

Would haue her loue, his doue would proue,

And eke his bed defile.

Nym. Let vs about it then.

85 *Pis.* He second thee: sir Corporall *Nym* troope on.

Exit omnes.

[SC. IV.] Enter Mistresse Quickly, and Simple.

Quic. M. *Slender* is your masters name say you?

Sim. I indeed that is his name.

Quic. How say you? I take it hee is somewhat a weakly man:
And he has as it were a whay coloured beard.

5 *Sim.* Indeed my maisters beard is kane colored.

Quic. Kane colour, you say well.
And is this Letter from sir *You*, about misteris *An*,
Is it not?

Sim. I indeed is it.

10 *Quic.* So: and your Maister would haue me as it twere to
speak to misteris *Anne* concerning him: I promise you my M.
hath a great affected mind to mistresse *Anne* himselfe. And if
he should know that I should as they say, giue my verdict for any
one but himselfe, I should heare of it throughly: For I tell you
friend, he puts all his priuities 15 in me.

Sim. I by my faith you are a good staie to him.

Quic. Am I? I and you knew all yowd say so:
Washing, brewing, baking, al goes through my hands,
Or else it would be but a woe house.

20 *Sim.* I beshrow me, one woman to do all this, Is very
painfull.

Quic. Are you auised of that? I, I warrant you,
Take all, and paie all, all goe through my hands,
And he is such a honest man, and he should chance
iv. 25 To come home and finde a man here, we should
Haue no who with him. He is a parlowes man.

Sim. Is he indeed?

Quic. Is he, quoth you? God keepe him abroad:
Lord blesse me, who knocks there?
30 For Gods sake step into the Counting-house,
While I go see whose at doore.

He steps into the Counting-house.

What *Iohn Rugby*, *Iohn*,
Are you come home sir alreadie?

And she opens the doore.

Doct. I begar I be forget mine oyntment,
35 Where be *Iohn Rugby*?

Enter Iohn.

Rug. Here sir, do you call?

Doct. I you be *Iohn Rugby*, and you be *Iack Rugby*
Goe run vp met your heeles, and bring away
De oyntment in the vindoe present:
40 Make haste *Iohn Rugby*. O I am almost forget
My simples in a boxe in de Counting-house:
O Ieshu vat be here, a deuella, a deuella?
My Rapier *Iohn Rugby*, Vat be you, vat make
You in my Counting-house?
45 I tinck you be a teefe.

Quic. Ieshu blesse me, we are all vndone.

Sim. O Lord sir no: I am no theefe,
I am a Seruingman:
My name is *Iohn Simple*, I brought a Letter sir
IV. 50 From my M. *Slender*, about misteris *Anne Page*
Sir: Indeed that is my comming.

Doct. I begar is dat all? *Iohn Rugby* giue a ma pen
An Inck: tarche vn pettit tarche a little.

The Doctor writes.

Sim. O God what a furious man is this?

55 *Quic.* Nay it is well he is no worse:
I am glad he is so quiet.

Doc. Here giue that same to sir *Hu*, it ber ve challenge
Begar tell him *I* will cut his nase, will you?

Sim. *I* sir, *I*le tell him so.

60 *Doc.* Dat be vell, my rapier *Iohn Rugby*, follow may.

Exit Doctor.

Quic. Well my friend, *I* cannot tarry, tell your
Maister *I*le doo what *I* can for him,
And so farewell.

Sim. Marry will *I*, *I* am glad *I* am got hence.

Exit omnes.

[*Sc. v.*] *Enter Mistresse Page, reading of a Letter.*

Mis. Pa. Mistresse Page *I* loue you. Ask me no reason,
Because theyr impossible to alledge. Your faire,
And *I* am fat. You loue sack, so do *I*:
As *I* am sure *I* haue no mind but to loue,
5 So *I* know you haue no hart but to grant
A souldier doth not vse many words where a knowes
A letter may serue for a sentence. *I* loue you,
And so *I* leaue you.

Yours Syr Iohn Falstaffe.

10 Now Ieshu blesse me, am *I* methomorphised?
I think *I* knowe not my selfe. Why what a Gods name doth this
man see in me, that thus he shootes at my honestie? Well but
that *I* knowe my owne heart, *I* should scarcely perswade my
selfe *I* were hand. Why what an vnreasonable wooll sack is this.
He was neuer 15 twice in my companie, and if then *I* thought *I*
gaue such assurance with my eies, *I*de pull them out, they should
neuer see more holie daies. Well, *I* shall trust fat men the worse

while I liue for his sake. O God, that I knew how to be reuenged
of him. But in good time, heeres mistresse *Foord*.

Enter Mistresse Foord.

20 *Mis. For.* How now mistris *Page*, are you are reading Loue
letters? How do you woman?

Mis. Pa. O woman I am I know not what:
In loue vp to the hard eares. I was neuer in such a case in my
life.

Mis. Ford. In loue, now in the name of God with whom?

v. 25 *Mis. Pa.* With one that sweares he loues me,
And I must not choose but do the like againe:
I prethie looke on that Letter.

Mis. For. He match your letter iust with the like,
Line for line, word for word. Onely the name
30 Of misteris *Page*, and misteris *Foord* disagrees:
Do me the kindnes to looke vpon this.

Mis. Pa. Why this is right my letter.
O most notorious villaine!
Why what a bladder of iniquity is this?
35 Lets be reuenged what so ere we do.

Mis. For. Reuenged, if we liue weel be reuenged.
O Lord if my husband should see this Letter,
Ifaith this would euen giue edge to his Iealousie.

Enter Ford, Page, Pistoll, and Nym.

Mis. Pa. See where our husbands are,
40 Mine's as far from Iealousie,
As I am from wronging him.

Pis. Ford the words I speake are forst:
Beware, take heed, for *Falstaffe* loues thy wife:
When *Pistoll* lies do this.

45 *Ford.* Why sir my wife is not young.

Pis. He wooes both yong and old, both rich and poore,
None comes amis. I say he loues thy wife:
Faire warning did I giue, take heed,
For sommer comes, and cuckoo birds appeare;
v. 50 *Page* belieue him what he ses. Away sir Corporal *Nym*.

Exit Pistoll:

Nym. Syr the humor of it is, he loues your wife,
I should ha borne the humor Letter to her:
I speake and I auouch tis true: My name is *Nym*.
Farwell, I loue not the humor of bread and cheese:
55 And theres the humor of it.

Exit Nym.

Pa. The humor of it, quoth you:
Heres a fellow frites humor out of his wits.

Mis. Pa. How now sweet hart, how dost thou?

Enter Mistresse Quickly.

Pa. How now man? how do you mistris *Ford*?

60 *Mis. For.* Well I thanke you good M. *Page*.
How now husband, how chaunce thou art so melancholy?

Ford. Melancholy, I am not melancholy.
Goe get you in, goe.

Mis. For. God saue me, see who yonder is:
65 Weele set her a worke in this businesse.

Mis Pa. O sheele serue excellent.
Now you come to see my daughter *An* I am sure.

Quic. I forsooth that is my comming.

Mis. Pa. Come go in with me. Come *Mis. Ford*.

70 *Mis. For.* I follow you *Mistresse Page*.

Exit Mistresse Ford, Mis. Page, and Quickly.

For. M. *Page* did you heare what these fellows said?

Pa. Yes M. *Ford*, what of that sir?

For. Do you thinke it is true that they told vs?

Pa. No by my troth do I not,

v. 75 I rather take them to be paltry lying knaues,

Such as rather speakes of enuie,

Then of any certaine they haue

Of any thing. And for the knight, perhaps

He hath spoke merrily, as the fashion of fat men

80 Are: But should he loue my wife,

Ifaith Ide turne her loose to him:

And what he got more of her,

Then ill lookes, and shrowd words,

Why let me beare the penaltie of it.

85 *For.* Nay I do not mistrust my wife,

Yet Ide be loth to turne them together,

A man may be too confident.

Enter Host and Shallow.

Pa. Here comes my ramping host of the garter,

Ther's either lickor in his hed, or mony in his purse,

90 That he lookes so merily. Now mine Host?

Host. God blesse you my bully rookes, God blesse you.

Cauallera Iustice I say.

Shal. At hand mine host, at hand. M. *Ford*. god den to you

God den and twentie good M. *Page*.

95 I tell you sir we haue sport in hand.

Host. Tell him cauelira Iustice: tell him bully rooke.

Ford. Mine Host a the garter:

Host. What ses my bully rooke?

Ford. A word with you sir.

Ford and the Host talkes.

v. 100 *Shal.* Harke you sir, Ile tell you what the sport shall be
Doctor Cayus and sir *Hu* are to fight,
My merrie Host hath had the measuring
Of their weapons, and hath
Appointed them contrary places. Harke in your eare:

105 *Host:* Hast thou no shute against my knight, My guest, my
cauellira.

For. None I protest: But tell him my name
Is Rrooke, onlie for a Iest.

Host: Thy hand bully: thou shalt
110 Haue egres and regres, and thy Name shall be *Brooke*:
Sed I well bully Hector?

Shal. I tell you what M. *Page*, I beleeeue
The Doctor is no Iester, heele laie it on:
For tho we be Iustices and Doctors,
115 And Church men, yet we are
The sonnes of women M. *Page*:

Pa: True maister *Shallow*:

Shal: It will be found so maister *Page*:

Pa. Maister *Shallow*, you your selfe
120 Haue bene a great fighter,
Though now a man of peace:

Shal: M. *Page*, I haue seene the day that yong
Tall fellowes with their stroke and their passado,
I haue made them trudge Maister *Page*,
v. 125 A tis the hart, the hart doth all: I
Haue seene the day, with my two hand sword
I would a made you foure tall Fencers
Scipped like Rattes.

Host. Here boyes, shall we wag, shall we wag?

Shal. Ha with you mine host.

Exit Host and Shallow.

Pa. Come M. *Ford*, shall we to dinner?
I know these fellowes sticks in your minde.

For. No in good sadnesse, not in mine:
Yet for all this Ile try it further,
135 I will not leaue it so:
Come M. *Page*, shall we to dinner?

Page. With all my hart sir, Ile follow you.

Exit omnes.

[Sc. vi.] *Enter Syr Iohn, and Pistoll.*

Fal. Ile not lend thee a peny.

Pis. I will retort the sum in equipage.

Fal. Not a pennie: *I* haue beene content you shuld lay my countenance to pawne: *I* haue grated vpon my good friends for 3 repriues, 5 for you and your Coach-follow *Nym*, else you might a looked thorow a grate like a geminy of babones. I am damned in hell for swearing to Gentlemen your good souldiers and tall fellowes: and when mistrisse *Briget* lost the handle of her Fan, I tooked on my ho- thou hadst it not.

10 *Pis.* Didst thou not share? hadst thou not fifteene pence?

Fal. Reason you rogue, reason.

Doest thou thinke Ile indanger my soule gratis?

In briefe, hang no more about mee, I am no gybit for you.

A short knife and a throng to your manner of pickt hatch, goe.

Youle not 15 beare a Letter for me you rogue you: you stand vpon your honor. Why thou vnconfinable basenesse thou, tis as much as I can do to keepe the termes of my honor precise. I, I my selfe sometimes, leauing the feare of God on the left hand,

am faine to shuffel, to filch and to lurch. And yet you stand vpon
your honor, you rogue. You, 20 you.

Pis. I do recant: what woulst thou more of man?

Fal. Well, gotoo, away, no more.

Enter Mistresse Quickly.

Quic. Good you god den sir.

Fal. Good den faire wife.

VI. 25 *Quic.* Not so ant like your worship.

Fal. Faire mayd then.

Quic. That I am Ile be sworne, as my mother was
The first houre I was borne.

Sir I would speake with you in priuate.

30 *Fal.* Say on I prethy, heeres none but my owne houshold.

Quic. Are they so? Now God blesse them, and make them his
seruants.

Syr I come from Mistresse *Foord*.

Fal. So from Mistresse *Foord*. Goe on.

35 *Quic.* I sir, she hath sent me to you to let you
Vnderstand she hath receiued your Letter,
And let me tell you, she is one stands vpon her credit.

Fal. Well, come Misteris *Ford*, Misteris *Ford*.

Quic. I sir, and as they say, she is not the first
40 Hath bene led in a fooles paradise.

Fal. Nay prethy be briefe my good she *Mercury*.

Quic. Mary sir, sheed haue you meet her betweene eight and
nine.

Fal. So betweene eight and nine:

45 *Qu.* I forsooth, for then her husband goes a birding,

Fal. Well commend me to thy mistress, tel her
I will not faile her: Boy giue her my purse.

Quic. Nay sir I haue another arant to do to you
From misteris *Page*:

VI. 50 *Fal.* From misteris *Page*? I prethy what of her?

Qu. By my troth *I* think you work by *Inchantments*,
Els they could neuer loue you as they doo:

Fal. Not *I*, *I* assure thee; setting the attraction of my
Good parts aside, *I* vse no other *inchantments*:

55 *Quic.* Well sir, she loues you extreemly:
And let me tell you, shees one that feares God,
And her husband giues her leaue to do all:
For he is not halfe so iealousie as *M. Ford* is.

Fal. But harke thee, hath misteris *Page* and mistress *Ford*,
60 Acquainted each other how dearly they loue me?

Quic. O God no sir: there were a iest indeed.

Fal. Well farwel, commend me to misteris *Ford*,
I will not faile her say.

Quic. God be with your worship.

Exit Mistresse Quickly.

Enter Bardolfe.

65 *Bar.* Sir, heer's a Gentleman,
One *M. Brooke*, would speak with you,
He hath sent you a cup of sacke.

Fal. *M. Brooke*, hees welcome: bid him come vp,
Such *Brookes* are alwaies welcome to me:
70 A *Iack*, will thy old bodie yet hold out?
Wilt thou after the expence of so much mony
Be now a gainer? Good bodie *I* thanke thee,

And Ile make more of thee then *I* ha done:
Ha, ha, misteris *Ford*, and misteris *Page*, haue
VI. 75 *I* caught you a the hip? go too.

Enter Foord disguised like Brooke.

For. God saue you sir.

Fal. And you too, would you speak with me?

For. Mary would *I* sir, *I* am somewhat bolde to trouble you,
My name is *Brooke*.

80 *Fal.* Good M. *Brooke* your verie welcome.

For. Ifaith sir *I* am a gentleman and a traueller,
That haue seen somewhat. And *I* haue often heard
That if mony goes before, all waies lie open.

Fal. Mony is a good souldier sir, and will on.

85 *For.* Ifaith sir, and *I* haue a bag here,
Would you wood helpe me to beare it.

Fal. O Lord, would *I* could tell how to deserue
To be your porter.

For. That may you easily sir *Iohn*: *I* haue an earnest
90 Sute to you. But good sir *Iohn* when *I* haue
Told you my grieve, cast one eie of your owne
Estate, since your selfe knew what tis to be
Such an offender.

Fal. Verie well sir, proceed.

95 *For.* Sir *I* am deeply in loue with one *Fords* wife
Of this Towne. Now sir *Iohn* you are a gentleman
Of good discoursing, well beloued among Ladies,
A man of such parts that might win 20. such as she.

Fal. O good sir.

VI. 100 *For.* Nay beleeeue it sir *Iohn*, for tis time. Now my loue

Is so grounded vpon her, that without her loue
I shall hardly liue.

Fal. Haue you importuned her by any means?

Ford. No neuer sir.

105 *Fal.* Of what qualitie is your loue then?

Ford. Ifaith sir, like a faire house set vpon
Another mans foundation.

Fal. And to what end haue you vnfolded this to me?

For. O sir, when I haue told you that, I told you all:

110 For she sir stands so pure in the firme state
Of her honestie, that she is too bright to be looked
Against: Now could I come against her
With some detection, I should sooner perswade her
From her marriage vow, and a hundred such nice
115 Tearmes that sheele stand vpon.

Fal. Why would it apply well to the veruensie of your
affection,

That another should possesse what you would enjoy?
Meethinks you prescribe verie preposterously
To your selfe.

120 *For.* No sir, for by that meanes should I be certaine of that
which I now misdoubt.

Fal. Wel M. *Brooke*, Ile first make bold with your mony,
Next, giue me your hand. Lastly, you shall
And you will, enioy *Fords* wife.

VI. 125 *Foord.* O good sir.

Fal. M. *Brooke*, I say you shall.

For. Want no mony syr *Iohn*, you shall want none.

Fal. Want no misteris *Ford* M. *Brooke*,
You shall want none. Euen as you came to me,

130 Her spokes mate, her go between parted from me:
I may tell you M. *Brooke*, I am to meet her
Betweene 8 and 9, for at that time the Iealous
Cuckally knaue her husband wil be from home,
Come to me soone at night, you shall know how
135 I speed M. *Brooke*.

Ford. Sir do you know *Ford*?

Fal. Hang him poore cuckally knaue, I know him not,
And yet I wrong him to call him poore. For they
Say the cuckally knaue hath legions of angels,
140 For the which his wife seemes to me well fauored,
And Ile vse her as the key of the cuckally knaues
Coffer, and there's my randeuowes.

Foord. Meethinkes sir it were good that you knew
Ford, that you might shun him.

145 *Fal*. Hang him cuckally knaue, Ile stare him
Out of his wits, Ile keepe him in awe
With this my cudgell: It shall hang like a meator
Ore the wittolly knaues head, M. *Brooke* thou shalt
See I will predominate ore the peasant,
VI. 150 And thou shalt lie with his wife. M. *Brooke*
Thou shalt know him for knaue and cuckold,
Come to me soone at night.

Exit Falstaffe.

Ford. What a damned epicurian is this?
My wife hath sent for him, the plot is laid:
155 *Page* is an Asse, a foole. A secure Asse,
Ile sooner trust an Irishman with my
Aquauita bottle, Sir *Hu* our parson with my cheese,
A theefe to walke my ambling gelding, then my wife
With her selfe: then she plots, then she ruminates,
160 And what she thinkes in her hart she may effect,
Sheele breake her hart but she will effect it.

God be praised, God be praised for my iealousie:
Well Ile go preuent him, the time drawes on,
Better an houre too soone, then a minit too late,
165 Gods my life cuckold, cuckold.

Exit Ford.

[SC. VII.] *Enter the Doctor and his man.*

Doc. *Iohn Rugbie* goe looke met your eies ore de stall,
And spie and you can see de parson.

Rug. Sir I cannot tell whether he be there or no,
But I see a great many comming.

5 *Doc.* Bully moy, mon rapier *Iohn Rugabie*, begar de
Hearing be not so dead as I shall make him.

Enter Shallow, Page, my Host, and Slender.

Pa. God saue you M. Doctor *Cayus*.

Shal. How do you M. Doctor?

Ho. God blesse thee my bully doctor, God blesse thee,

10 *Doct.* Vat be all you, Van to tree come for, a?

Host. Bully to see thee fight, to see thee foine, to see thee
trauerse, to see thee here, to see thee there, to see thee passe the
punto. The stock, the reuerse, the distance: the montnce is a dead
my francoyes? Is a dead my Ethiopian? Ha, what ses my gallon?
my 15 escuolapis? Is a dead bullies taile, is a dead?

Doct. Begar de preest be a coward Iack knaue,
He dare not shew his face.

Host. Thou art a castallian king vrinall.
Hector of *Greece* my boy.

20 *Sha.* He hath showne himselfe the wiser man, M. Doctor:
Sir *Hugh* is a parson, and you a Phisition. You must
Goe with me, M. Doctor.

Host. Pardon bully Iustice. A word monsire mockwater.

Doct. Mockwater, vat me dat?

VII. 25 *Host.* That is in our English tongue, Vallor bully, vallor.

Doct. Begar den I haue as mockuater as de Inglish Iack dog, knaue.

Host. He will claperclaw thee titely bully.

Doct. Claperclawe, vat be dat?

30 *Host.* That is, he will make thee amends.

Doct. Begar I do looke he shal claperclaw me den,
And Ile prouoke him to do it, or let him wag:
And moreouer bully, but M. *Page* and M. *Shallow*,
And eke cauellira *Slender*, go you all ouer the fields to
Frogmore?

35 *Pa.* Sir *Hugh* is there, is hee?

Host. He is there: go see what humor hee is in,
Ile bring the Doctor about by the fields:
Will it do well?

Shal. We wil do it my host. Farewel M. Doctor.

Exit all but the Host and Doctor.

40 *Doc.* Begar I will kill de cowardly Iack preest,
He is make a foole of moy.

Host. Let him die, but first sheth your impatience,
Throw cold water on your collor, com go with me
Through the fields to *Frogmore*, and Ile bring thee
45 Where mistris *An Page* is a feasting at a farm house,
And thou shalt wear hir cried game: sed I wel bully.

Doct. Begar excellent vel: and if you speake pour moy, I shall
procure you de gesse of all de gentlemen mon patinces. I begar *I*
sall.

VII. 50 *Host.* For the which Ile be thy aduersary
To misteris *An Page*: sed *I* well?

Doct. I begar excellent.

Host. Let vs wag then.

Doct. Alon, alon, alon.

Exit omnes.

[SC. VIII.] *Enter syr Hugh and Simple.*

Sir Hu. I pray you do so much as see if you can espie
Doctor *Cayus* comming, and giue me intelligence,
Or bring me vrde if you please now.

Sim. I will sir.

5 *Sir Hu.* Ieshu ples mee, how my hart trobes, and trobes,
And then she made him bedes of Roses,
And a thousand fragrant poses,
To shallow riueres. Now so kad vdge me, my hart
Swellles more and more. Mee thinks *I* can cry
10 Verie well. There dwelt a man in *Babylon*,
To shallow riuers and to falles,
Melodious birds sing Madrigalles.

Sim. Sir here is *M. Page*, and *M. Shallow*,
Comming hither as fast as they can.

15 *Sir Hu.* Then it is verie necessary *I* put vp my sword,
Pray give me my cowne too, marke you.

Enter Page, shallow, and Slender.

Pa. God saue you sir *Hugh*.

Shal. God saue you *M. parson*.

Sir Hu. God plesse you all from his mercies sake now.

20 *Pa.* What the word and the sword, doth that agree well?

Sir Hu. There is reasons and causes in all things,
I warrant you now.

Pa. Well sir *Hugh*, we are come to crane
Your helpe and furtherance in a matter.

VIII. 25 *Sir Hu.* What is *I* pray you?

Pa. Ifaith tis this sir *Hugh*. There is an auncient friend of ours,
a man of verie good sort, so at oddes with one patience, that *I*
am sure you would hartily grieue to see him. Now sir *Hugh*, you
are a scholler well red, and verie perswasieue, we would intreate
you to see 30 if you could intreat him to patience.

Sir Hu. *I* pray you who is it? Let vs know that.

Pa. I am shure you know him, tis Doctor *Cayus*.

Sir Hu. *I* had as leeuue you should tel me of a messe of poredge,
35 He is an arant lowsie beggerly knaue:
And he is a coward beside.

Pa. Why Ile laie my life tis the man
That he should fight withall.

Enter Doctor and the Host, they offer to fight.

Shal. Keep them asunder, take away their weapons.

40 *Host.* Disarme, let them question.

Shal. Let them keepe their limbs hole, and hack our English.

Doct. Harke van vrd in your eare. You be vn daga
And de *Iack*, coward preest.

45 *Sir Hu.* Harke you, let vs not be laughing stockes to other
mens humors. By Ieshu *I* will knock your vrinalls about your
knaues cock-comes, for missing your meetings and
appointments.

Doct. O Ieshu mine host of de garter, *Iohn Rogoby*,
Haue *I* not met him at de place he make apoint,

Haue I not?

VIII. 50 *Sir Hu.* So kad vdge me, this is the pointment place,
Witnes by my Host of the garter.

Host. Peace I say gawle and gawlia, French and Wealch,
Soule curer and bodie curer.

Doc. This be verie braue, excellent.

55 *Host.* Peace *I* say, heare mine host of the garter,
Am *I* wise? am I polliticke? am *I* Matchaul?
Shal *I* lose my doctor? No, he giues me the motions
And the potions. Shal *I* lose my parson, my sir *Hu*?
No, he giues me the prouerbes, and the nouerbes:
60 Giue me thy hand terestiall, So giue me thy hand celestiall:
So boyes of art I haue deceiued you both,
I haue directed you to wrong places,
Your hearts are mightie, you skins are whole,
65 *Bardolfe* laie their swords to pawne. Follow me lads
Of peace, follow me. Ha, ra, la. Follow.

Exit Host.

Shal. Afore God a mad host, come let vs goe.

Doc. *I* begar haue you mocka may thus?
I will be euen met you my Iack Host.

70 *Sir Hugh.* Giue me your hand doctor *Cayus*,
We be all friends:
But for mine hosts foolish knauery, let me alone.

Doc. *I* dat be veil begar *I* be friends.

(Exit omnes.

[Sc. IX.] *Enter M. Foord.*

For. The time drawes on he shuld come to my house,
Well wife, you had best worke closely,
Or *I* am like to goe beyond your cunning:

I now wil seeke my guesse that comes to dinner,
5 And in good time see where they all are come.

Enter Shallow, Page, host, Slender, Doctor, and sir Hugh.

By my faith a knot well met: your welcome all.

Pa. I thanke you good M. *Ford*.

For. Welcome good M. *Page*,
I would your daughter were here.

10 *Pa.* I thank you sir, she is very well at home.

Slen. Father *Page* I hope I haue your consent
For Misteris *Anne*?

Pa. You haue sonne *Slender*, but my wife here,
Is altogether for maister Doctor.

15 *Doc.* Begar I tanck her hartily.

Host. But what say you to yong Maister *Fenton*?
He capers, he daunces, he writes verses, he smelles
All April and May: he wil cary it, he wil carit,
Tis in his betmes he wil carite.

20 *Pa.* My host not with my consent: the gentleman is
Wilde, he knowes too much: If he take her,
Let him take her simply: for my goods goes
With my liking, and my liking goes not that way.

For. Well, I pray go home with me to dinner:
IX. 25 Besides your cheare Ile shew you wonders: Ile
Shew you a monster. You shall go with me
M. *Page*, and so shall you sir *Hugh*, and you Maister Doctor.

S. Hu. If there be one in the company, I shal make two:

Doc. And dere be ven to, I sail make de tird:

Sir Hu. In your teeth for shame,

Shal. wel, wel, God be with you, we shall haue the fairer

Wooing at Maister Pages:

Exit Shallow and Slender.

Host. Ile to my honest knight sir *Iohn Falstaffe*,
And drinke Canary with him.

Exit host.

35 *For.* I may chance to make him drinke in pipe wine,
First come gentlemen.

Exit omnes.

[Sc. x.] *Enter Mistresse Ford, with two of her men, and a great
buck basket.*

Mis. For. Sirrha, if your M. aske you whither
You carry this basket, say to the Launderers,
I hope you know how to bestow it?

Ser. I warrant you misteris.

Exit seruant.

5 *Mis. For.* Go get you in. Well sir *Iohn*,
I beleeeue I shall serue you such a trick,
You shall haue little mind to come againe.

Enter Sir Iohn.

Fal. Haue I caught my heauenlie Iewel?
Why now let me die. *I* haue liued long inough.
10 This is the happie houre *I* haue desired to see,
Now shall I sin in my wish,
I would thy husband were dead.

Mis. For. Why how then sir *Iohn*?

Fal. By the Lord, Ide make thee my Ladie.

15 *Mis. For.* Alas sir *Iohn*, *I* should be a verie simple Ladie.

Fal. Goe too, I see how thy eie doth emulate the Diamond.

And how the arched bent of thy brow
Would become the ship tire, the tire vellet,
Or anie Venetian attire, I see it.

20 *Mis. For.* A plaine kercher sir *Iohn*, would fit me better.

Fal. By the Lord thou art a traitor to saie so:
What made me loue thee? Let that perswade thee
Ther's somewhat extraordinarie in thee: Goe too *I* loue thee:
Mistris Ford, *I* cannot cog, *I* cannot prate, like one
x. 25 Of these fellowes that smels like Bucklers-berie,
In simple time, but *I* loue thee,
And none but thee.

Mis. For. Sir *Iohn*, I am afraid you loue misteris *Page*.

Fal. I thou mightest as well saie
30 I loue to walke by the Counter gate,
Which is as hatefull to me
As the reake of a lime kill.

Enter Mistresse Page.

Mis. Pa. Mistresse Ford, *Mis. Ford*, where are you?

Mis. For. O Lord step aside good sir *Iohn*.

Falstaffe stands behind the aras.

35 How now Misteris *Page*, what's the matter?

Mis. Pa. Why your husband woman is comming,
With halfe *Windsor* at his heeles,
To looke for a gentleman, that he ses
Is hid in his house: his wifes sweet hart.

40 *Mis. For.* Speak louder. But *I* hope tis not true Misteris *Page*.

Mis. Pa. Tis too true woman. Therefore if you
Haue any here, away with him, or your vndone for euer.

Mis. For. Alas mistresse *Page*, what shall *I* do?
Here is a gentleman my friend, how shall I do?

45 *Mis. Pa.* Gode body woman, do not stand what shal I do, and
what shall *I* do. Better any shift, rather then you shamed. Looke
heere, here's a buck-basket, if hee be a man of any reasonable
sise, heele in here.

Mis. For. Alas I feare he is too big.

x. 50 *Fal.* Let me see, let me see, Ile in, Ile in,
Follow your friends counsell.

Mis. Pa. Fie sir *Iohn*, is this your loue? Go too. (Aside.

Fal. I loue thee, and none but thee:
Helpe me to conuey me hence,
55 Ile neuer come here more.

*Sir Iohn goes into the basket, they put cloathes ouer him, the
two men carries it away: Foord meetes it, and all the rest,
Page, Doctor, Priest, Slender, Shallow.*

Ford. Come pray along, you shall see all.
How now who goes heare? whither goes this?
Whither goes it? set it downe.

Mis. For. Now let it go, you had best meddle with 60 buck-
washing.

Ford. Buck, good buck, pray come along,
Master *Page* take my keyes: helpe to search. Good
Sir *Hugh* pray come along, helpe a little, a little,
He shew you all.

65 *Sir Hu.* By Ieshu these are iealosies and distemperes.

Exit omnes.

Mis. Pa. He is in a pittifull taking.

Mis. I wonder what he thought
When my husband bad them set downe the basket.

Mis. Pa. Hang him dishonest slaue, we cannot vse
Him bad inough. This is excellent for your

Husbands iealousie.

Mi. For. Alas poore soule it grieues me at the hart,
But this will be a meanes to make him cease
His iealous fits, if *Falstaffes* love increase.

x. 75 *Mis. Pa.* Nay we wil send to *Falstaffe* once again,
Tis great pittie we should leaue him:
What wiues may be merry, and yet honest too.

Mi. For. Shall we be condemnd because we laugh?
Tis old, but true: still sowes eate all the draffe.

Enter all.

80 *Mis. Pa.* Here comes your husband, stand aside.

For. I can find no body within, it may be he lied.

Mis. Pa. Did you heare that?

Mis. For. I, I, peace.

For. Well, Ile not let it go so, yet Ile trie further.

85 *S. Hu.* By Ieshu if there be any body in the kitchin
Or the cuberts, or the presse, or the buttery,
I am an arrant Iew: now God plesse me:
You serue me well, do you not?

Pa. Fie M. *Ford* you are too blame:

90 *Mis. Pa.* I faith tis not well M. *Ford* to suspect
Her thus without cause.

Doc. No by my trot it be no vell:

For. Wel, I pray bear with me, M. *Page* pardon me.
I suffer for it, I suffer for it:

95 *Sir Hu:* You suffer for a bad conscience looke you now:

Ford: Well I pray no more, another time Ile tell you all:
The mean time go dine with me, pardon me wife,
I am sorie; M. *Page*, pray goe in to dinner,

Another time Ile tell you all.

x. 100 Pa: Wel let it be so, and to morrow I inuite you all
To my house to dinner: and in the morning wee
A birding, I haue an excellent Hauke for the bush.

Ford: Let it be so: Come M. Page, come wife;
I pray you come in all, y'are welcome, pray come in.

105 Sir Hu: By so kad vdgme, M. Fordes is
Not in his right wittes:

Exit omnes:

[Sc. XL.] Enter sir Iohn Falstaffe.

Fal: Bardolfe brew me a pottle sack presently:

Bar: With Egges sir?

Fal: Simply of it selfe, Ile none of these pullets sperme
In my drink: goe make haste.

5 Haue I liued to be carried in a basket

And throwne into the Thames like a barow of Butchers offoll.
Well, and I be serued such another tricke, Ile giue them leaue to
take out my braines and butter them, and giue them to a dog for
a new-yeares gift. Sblood, the rogues slided me in with as little
remorse as if they 10 had gone to drowne a blinde bitches
puppies in the litter: and they might know by my sise I haue a
kind of alacritie in sinking: and the bottom had bin as deep as
hell I should downe. I had bene drowned, but that the shore was
sheluie and somewhat shallowe: a death that I abhorre. For you
know the water swelles a man: and what a thing 15 should I haue
bene when I had bene swelled? By the Lord a mountaine of
money. Now is the Sacke brewed?

Bar. I sir, there's a woman below would speake with you.

Fal. Bid her come vp. Let me put some Sacke among this cold
water, for my belly is as cold as if I had swallowed snow-balles
20 for pilles.

Enter Mistresse Quickly.

Now whats the newes with you?

Quic. I come from misteris *Ford* forsooth.

Fal. Misteris *Ford*, I haue had *Ford* inough,
I haue bene throwne into the *Ford*, my belly is full
XI. 25 Of *Ford*: she hath tickled mee.

Quic. O Lord sir, she is the sorrowfullest woman that her
seruants mistooke, that euer liued. And sir, she would desire you
of all loues you will meet her once againe, to morrow sir,
betweene ten and eleuen, and she hopes to make amends for all.

30 *Fal.* Ten, and eleuen, saiest thou?

Quic. I forsooth.

Fal. Well, tell her Ile meet her. Let her but think
Of mans frailtie: Let her iudge what man is,
And then thinke of me. And so farwell.

35 *Quic.* Youle not faile sir?

Exit mistresse Quickly.

Fal. I will not faile. Commend me to her.
I wonder I heare not of M. *Brooke*, I like his
Mony well. By the masse here he is.

Enter Brooke.

For. God saue you sir.

40 *Fal.* Welcome good M. *Brooke*. You come to know how
matters goes.

Ford. Thats my comming indeed sir Iohn.

Fal. M. *Brooke* I will not lye to you sir,
I was there at my appointed time.

45 *For.* And how sped you sir?

Fal. Verie ilfauouredly sir.

For. Why sir, did she change her determination?

Fal. No M. *Brooke*, but you shall heare. After we had kissed and imbraced, and as it were euen amid the prologue of our incounter, XI. 50 who should come, but the iealous knaue her husband, and a rabble of his companions at his heeles, thither prouoked and instigated by his distemper. And what to do thinke you? to search for his wiues loue. Euen so, plainly so.

For. While ye were there?

55 *Fal.* Whilst I was there.

For. And did he search and could not finde you?

Fal. You shall heare sir, as God would haue it,
A litle before comes me one *Pages* wife,
Giues her intelligence of her husbands
60 Approach: and by her inuention, and *Fords* wiues
Distraction, conueyd me into a buck-basket.

Ford. A buck basket!

Fal. By the Lord a buck-basket, rammed me in
With foule shirts, stokins, greasie napkins,
65 That M. *Brooke*, there was a compound of the most
Villanous smel, that euer offended nostrill.
Ile tell you M. *Brooke*, by the Lord for your sake
I suffered three egregious deaths: First to be
Crammed like a good bilbo, in the circomference
70 Of a pack, Hilt to point, heele to head: and then to
Be stewed in my owne grease like a Dutch dish:
A man of my kidney; by the Lord it was maruell I
Escaped suffication; and in the heat of all this,
To be throwne into Thames like a horshoo hot:
XI. 75 Maister *Brooke*, thinke of that hissing heate, Maister
Brooke.

Ford. Well sir then my shute is void?

Youle vndertake it no more?

Fal. M. Brooke, Ile be throwne into Etna
As *I* haue bene in the Thames,
80 Ere I thus leaue her: *I* haue receiued
Another appointment of meeting,
Betweene ten and eleuen is the houre.

Ford: Why sir, tis almost ten already:

Fal: Is it? why then will *I* addresse my selfe
85 For my appointment: M. Brooke, come to me soone
At night, and you shall know how *I* speed,
And the end shall be, you shall enjoy her loue:
You shall cuckold Foord: come to mee soone at at night.

Exit Falstaffe.

For. Is this a dreame? Is it a vision?
90 Maister Ford, maister Ford, awake maister Ford,
There is a hole made in your best coat M. Ford,
And a man shall not onely endure this wrong,
But shall stand vnder the taunt of names,
Lucifer is a good name, *Barbason* good: good
95 Diuels names: but cuckold, wittold, godeso
The diuel himselfe hath not such a name:
And they may hang hats here, and napkins here
Vpon my homes: well Ile home, *I* ferit him,
And vnlesse the diuel himselfe should aide him.
XI. 100 Ile search vnpossible places: Ile about it, Least
I repent too late:

Exit omnes.

[SC. XII.] *Enter M. Fenton, Page, and mistresse Quickly.*

Fen: Tell me sweet Nan, how doest thou yet resolute,
Shall foolish *Slender* haue thee to his wife?
Or one as wise as he, the learned Doctor?
Shall such as they enjoy thy maiden hart?

5 Thou knowst that *I* haue alwaies loued thee deare,
And thou hast oft times swore the like to me.

An: Good M. *Fenton*, you may assure your selfe
My hart is settled vpon none but you,
Tis as my father and mother please:
10 Get their consent, you quickly shall haue mine.

Fen: Thy father thinks I loue thee for his wealth,
Tho I must needs confesse at first that drew me,
But since thy vertues wiped that trash away,
I loue thee *Nan*, and so deare is it set,
15 That whilst I liue, I nere shall thee forget.

[*Quic:*] Godes pitie here comes her father.

Enter M. Page his wife, M. Shallow, and Slender.

Pa. M. *Fenton* I pray what make you here?
You know my answeere sir, shees not for you:
Knowing my vow, to blame to vse me thus.

20 *Fen.* But heare me speake sir.

Pa. Pray sir get you gon: Come hither daughter,
Sonne *Slender* let me speak with you. *(they whisper.*

Quic. Speake to misteris *Page*.

Fen. Pray misteris *Page* let me haue your consent.

Mis. Pa. Ifaith M. *Fenton* tis as my husband please.
For my part, Ile neither hinder you, nor further you.

Quic. How say you this was my doings?
I bid you speake to misteris *Page*.

Fen. Here nurse, theres a brace of angels to drink,
30 Worke what thou canst for me, farwell. *(Exit Fen.*

Quic. By my troth so I will, good hart.

Pa. Come wife, you an *I* will in, wee leaue M. *Slender*

And my daughter to talke together. M. *Shallow*,
You may stay sir if you please.

Exit Page and his wife.

35 *Shal.* Mary I thanke you for that:
To her cousin, to her.

Slen. Ifaith I know not what to say.

An. Now M. *Slender*, what's your will?

40 *Slen.* Godeso, theres a *Iest* indeed: why misteris *An*, I neuer
made will yet: I thank God I am wise inough for that.

Shal. Fie cusse fie, thou art not right,
O thou hadst a father.

Slen. I had a father misteris *Anne*, good vncle
Tell the *Iest* how my father stole the goose out of
45 The henloft. All this is nought, harke you mistresse *Anne*.

Shal. He will make you ioynter of three hundred pound a yeare,
he shall make you a Gentlewoman.

Slend. I be God that I vill, come cut and long taile, as good as
any is in *Glostershire*, vnder the degree of a Squire.

XII. 50 *An.* O God how many grosse faults are hid
And couered in three hundred pound a yeare?
Well M. *Slender*, within a day or two Ile tell you more.

Slend. I thanke you good misteris *Anne*, vncle I shall haue her.

Quic. M. *Shallow*, M. *Page* would pray you to come you, and
you 55 M. *Slender*, and you mistris *An*.

Slend. Well Nurse, if youle speake for me,
Ile giue you more than Ile talke of.

Exit omnes but Quickly.

Quic. Indeed I will, Ile speake what I can for you,
But specially for M. *Fenton*:

60 But specially of all for my Maister.
And indeed I will do what I can for them all three.

Exit.

Enter misteris Ford and her two men.

Mis. For. Do you heare? when your M. comes take vp this basket as you did before, and if your M. bid you set it downe, obey him.

65 *Ser.* I will forsooth.

Enter Syr Iohn.

Mis. For. Syr Iohn welcome.

Fal. What are you sure of your husband now?

Mis. For. He is gone a birding sir Iohn, and I hope will not come home yet.

Enter mistresse Page.

70 Gods body here is misteris Page,
Step behind the arras good sir Iohn.

He steps behind the arras.

Mis. Pa. Misteris Ford, why woman your husband is in his old vaine againe, hees comming to search for your sweet heart, but I am glad he is not here.

XII. 75 *Mis. For.* O God misteris Page the knight is here,
What shall I do?

Mis. Pa. Why then you'r vndone woman, vnles you make some meanes to shift him away.

Mis. For. Alas I know no meanes, unlesse 80 we put him in the basket againe.

Fal. No Ile come no more in the basket,
Ile creep vp into the chimney.

Mis. For. There they use to discharge their Fowling peeces.

Fal. Why then Ile goe out of doores.

85 Mi. Pa. Then your vndone, your but a dead man.

Fal. For Gods sake deuise any extremitie,
Rather then a mischiefe.

Mis. Pa. Alas I know not what meanes to make,
If there were any womans apparell would fit him,
90 He might put on a gowne and a mufler, And so escape.

Mi. For. Thats wel remembred, my maids Aunt
Gillian of Brainford, hath a gowne aboue.

Mis. Pa. And she is altogether as fat as he.

95 Mis. For. I that will serue him of my word.

Mis. Pa. Come goe with me sir Iohn, Ile helpe to dresse you.

Fal. Come for God sake, any thing.

Exit Mis. Page and Sir Iohn.

*Enter M. Ford, Page, Priest, Shallow, the two men carries the
basket, and Ford meets it.*

For. Come along I pray, you shal know the cause,
How now whither goe you? Ha whither go you?
XII. 100 Set downe the basket you ssaue,
You panderly rogue, set it downe.

Mis. For. What is the reason that you vse me thus?

For. Come hither set downe the basket,
Misteris Ford the modest woman,
105 Misteris Ford the vertuous woman,
She that hath the ieaious foole to her husband,
I mistrust you without cause do I not?

Mis. For. I Gods my record do you. And if
you mistrust me in any ill sort.

110 *Ford.* Well sed brazen face, hold it out,
You youth in a basket, come out here,
Pull out the cloathes, search.

Hu. Ieshu plesse me, will you pull vp your wiues cloathes.

Pa. Fie M. *Ford*, you are not to go abroad if you be in these fits.

115 *Sir Hugh.* By so kad vdge me, tis verie necessarie
He were put in pethlem.

For. M. *Page*, as *I* am an honest man M. *Page*,
There was one conueyd out of my house here yesterday out of
this basket, why may he not be here now?

120 *Mi. For.* Come mistris *Page*, bring the old woman downe.

For. Old woman, what old woman?

Mi. For. Why my maidens Ant, *Gillian* of *Brainford*.

A witch, haue I not forewarned her my house,
Alas we are simple we, we know not what

XII. 125 *Is* brought to passe vnder the colour of fortune-Telling.
Come downe you witch, come downe.

*Enter Falstaffe disguised like an old woman, and misteris Page
with him, Ford beates him, and hee runnes away.*

Away you witch get you gone.

Sir Hu. By Ieshu I verily thinke she is a witch indeed,
I espied vnder her mufler a great beard.

130 *Ford.* Pray come helpe me to search, pray now.

Pa. Come weele go for his minds sake.

Exit omnes.

Mi. For. By my troth he beat him most extreamly.

Mi. Pa. I am glad of it, what shall we proceed any further?

Mi. For. No faith, now if you will let vs tell our husbands of it.
135 For mine I am sure hath almost fretted himselfe to death.

Mi. Pa. Content, come weelee go tell them all,
And as they agree, so will we proceed.

Exit both.

[SC. XIII.] *Enter Host and Bardolfe.*

Bar. Syr heere be three Gentlemen come from the Duke the
Stanger sir, would haue your horse.

Host. The Duke, what Duke? let me speake with the
Gentlemen, do they speake English?

5 *Bar.* He call them to you sir.

Host. No *Bardolfe*, let them alone, He sauce them:
They haue had my house a weeke at command,
I haue turned away my other guesse,
They shall haue my horses *Bardolfe*,
10 They must come off, He sawce them.

Exit omnes.

[SC. XIV.] *Enter Ford, Page, their wives, Shallow and Slender, Syr*
Hu.

Ford. Well wife, heere take my hand, vpon my soule I loue thee
dearer then I do my life, and ioy I haue so true and constant
wife, my iealousie shall neuer more offend thee.

Mi. For. Sir I am glad, and that which I haue done,
5 Was nothing else but mirth and modestie.

Pa. I misteris *Ford*, *Falstaffe* hath all the griefe,
And in this knauerie my wife was the chiefe.

Mi. Pa. No knauery husband, it was honest mirth.

Hu. Indeed it was good pastimes & merriments.

10 *Mis. For.* But sweete heart shall wee leaue olde *Falstaffe* so?

Mis. Pa. O by no meanes, send to him againe.

Pa. I do not thinke heele come being so much deceiued.

For. Let me alone, Ile to him once again like *Brooke*, and know his mind whether heele come or not.

15 *Pa.* There must be some plot laide, or heele not come.

Mis. Pa. Let vs alone for that. Heare my deuice.

Oft haue you heard since *Horne* the hunter dyed,

That women to affright their litle children,

Ses that he walkes in shape of a great stagge.

20 Now for that *Falstaffe* hath bene so deceiued,

As that he dares not venture to the house,

Weele send him word to meet vs in the field,

Disguised like *Horne*, with huge horns on his head.

The houre shalbe iust betweene twelue and one,

XIV. 25 And at that time we will meet him both:

Then would I haue you present there at hand,

With litle boyes disguised and dressed like Fayries,

For to affright fat *Falstaffe* in the woods.

And then to make a period to the Iest,

30 Tell *Falstaffe* all, I thinke this will do best.

Pa. Tis excellent, and my daughter *Anne*,

Shall like a litle Fayrie be disguised.

Mis. Pa. And in that Maske Ile make the Doctor steale my

daughter *An*, and ere my husband knowes it, to carrie her to

Church, 35 and marrie her.

Mis. For. But who will buy the silkes to tyre the boyes?

Pa. That will *I* do, and in a robe of white

Ile cloath my daughter, and aduertise *Slender*

To know her by that signe, and steale her thence,

40 And vnknowne to my wife, shall marrie her.

Hu. So kad vdge me the deuises is excellent.
I will also be there, and will be like a *Iackanapes*,
And pinch him most cruelly for his lecheries.

Mis. Pa. Why then we are reuenged sufficiently.
45 First he was carried and throwne in the Thames,
Next beaten well, I am sure youle witnes that.

Mi. For. Ile lay my life this makes him nothing fat.

Pa. Well lets about this stratagem, I long
To see deceit deceiued, and wrong haue wrong.

XIV. 50 *For.* Well send to *Falstaffe*, and if he come thither,
Twill make vs smile and laugh one moneth together.

Exit omnes.

[Sc. xv.] *Enter Host and Simple.*

Host. What would thou haue boore, what thick-skin?
Speake, breath, discus, short, quick, briefe, snap.

Sim. Sir, I am sent from my M. to sir *Iohn Falstaffe*.

Host. Sir *Iohn*, theres his Castle, his standing bed, his trundle 5
bed, his chamber is painted about with the story of the prodigall,
fresh and new, goe knock, heele speak like an Antripophiginian
to thee:

Knock I say.

Sim. Sir I should speak with an old woman that went vp into 10
his chamber.

Host. An old woman, the knight may be robbed, Ile call bully
knight, bully sir *Iohn*. Speake from thy Lungs military: it is thine
host, thy Ephesian calls.

Fal. Now mine host,

15 *Host:* Here is a Bohemian tarter bully, tarries the comming
downe of the fat woman: Let her descend bully, let her descend,

my chambers are honorable, pah priuasie, fie.

Fal. Indeed mine host there was a fat woman with me,
But she is gone.

Enter sir Iohn.

20 *Sim.* Pray sir, was it not the wise woman of *Brainford*?

Fal. Marry was it Musselshell, what would you?

Sim. Marry sir my maister *Slender* sent me to her,
To know whether one *Nim* that hath his chaine,
Cousoned him of it, or no.

xv. 25 *Fal.* I talked with the woman about it.

Sim. And I pray you sir what ses she?

Fal. Marry she ses the very same man that
Beguiled maister *Slender* of his chaine,
Cousoned him of it.

30 *Sim.* May I be bolde to tell my maister so sir?

Fal. I tike, who more bolde.

Sim. I thanke you sir, I shall make my maister a glad man at
these tydings, God be with you sir.

Exit.

Host. Thou art clarkly sir *Iohn*, thou art clarkly,
35 Was there a wise woman with thee?

Fal. Marry was there mine host, one that taught
Me more wit then I learned this 7. yeare,
And I paid nothing for it,
But was paid for my learning.

Enter Bardolfe.

40 *Bar.* O lord sir cousonage, plaine cousonage.

Host. Why man, where be my horses? where be the Germanes?

Bar. Rid away with your horses:
After I came beyond Maidenhead,
They flung me in a slow of myre, & away they ran.

Enter Doctor.

45 *Doc.* Where be my Host de gartyre?

Host. O here sir in perplexitie.

Doc. I cannot tell vad be dad,
But begar I will tell you van ting,
Dear be a Garmaine Duke come to de Court,
xv. 50 Has cosened all the host of *Branford*,
And *Redding*: begar I tell you for good will,
Ha, ha, mine Host, am I euen met you?

Exit.

Enter Sir Hugh.

Sir Hu. Where is mine host of the gartyr?
Now my Host, I would desire you looke you now,
55 To haue a care of your entertainments,
For there is three sorts of cosen garmombles,
Is cosen all the Host of Maidenhead and Readings,
Now you are an honest man, and a scuruy beggerly lowsie knaue
beside:
60 And can point wrong places,
I tell you for good will, grate why mine Host.

Exit.

Host. I am cosened *Hugh*, and coy *Bardolfe*,
Sweet knight assist me, I am cosened.

Exit.

Fal. Would all the worell were cosened for me,
65 For I am cousoned and beaten too.
Well, I neuer prospered since I forswore
Myselfe at *Primero*: and my winde

Were but long inough to say my prayers,
Ide repent, now from whence come you?

Enter Mistresse Quickly.

70 *Quic.* From the two parties forsooth.

Fal. The diuell take the one partie,
And his dam the other,
And theyle be both bestowed.
I haue endured more for their sakes,
XV. 75 Then man is able to endure.

Quic. O Lord sir, they are the sorowfulst creatures
That euer liued: specially mistresse *Ford*,
Her husband hath beaten her that she is all
Blacke and blew poore soule.

80 *Fal.* What tellest me of blacke and blew,
I haue bene beaten all the colours in the Rainbow,
And in my escape like to a bene apprehended
For a witch of *Brainford*, and set in the stockes.

Quic. Well sir, she is a sorrowfull woman,
85 And I hope when you heare my errant,
Youle be perswaded to the contrarie.

Fal. Come goe with me into my chamber, Ile heare thee.

Exit omnes.

[Sc. XVI.] *Enter Host and Fenton.*

Host. Speake not to me sir, my mind is heauie,
I haue had a great losse.

Fen. Yet heare me, and as I am a gentleman,
Ile giue you a hundred pound toward your losse.

5 *Host.* Well sir Ile heare you, and at least keep your counsell.

Fen. Then thus my host. Tis not vnknown to you,

The feruent loue *I* beare to young *Anne Page*,
And mutally her loue againe to mee:
But her father still against her choise,
10 Doth seeke to marrie her to foolish *Slender*,
And in a robe of white this night disguised,
Wherein fat *Falstaffe* had a mightie scare,
Must *Slender* take her and carrie her to *Catlen*,
And there vnknowne to any, marrie her.
15 Now her mother still against that match,
And firme for Doctor *Cayus*, in a robe of red
By her deuice, the Doctor must steale her thence,
And she hath giuen consent to goe with him.

Host. Now which meanes she to deceiue, father or mother?

20 *Fen.* Both my good *Host*, to go along with me.
Now here it rests, that you would procure a priest,
And tarry readie at the appointment place,
To giue our harts vnited matrimonie.

Host. But how will you come to steale her from among them?

xvi. 25 *Fen.* That hath sweet *Nan* and I agreed vpon,
And by a robe of white, the which she weares,
With ribones pendant flaring bout her head,
I shalbe sure to know her, and conuey her thence,
And bring her where the priest abides our comming,
30 And by thy furtherance there be married.

Host. Well, husband your deuice, Ile to the Vicar,
Bring you the maide, you shall not lacke a Priest.

Fen. So shall *I* euermore be bound vnto thee,
Besides Ile always be thy faithful friend.

Exit omnes.

[*Sc. xvii.*] *Enter sir Iohn with a Bucks head upon him.*

Fal. This is the third time, well Ile venter,

They say there is good luck in old numbers,
[*Ioue* transform'd himselfe into a Bull,]
And *I* am here a Stag, and *I* thinke the fattest
5 In all *Windsor* forrest: well *I* stand here
For *Horne* the hunter, waiting my Does comming.

Enter mistris Page and mistris Ford.

Mis. Pa. Sir *Iohn*, where are you?

Fal. Art thou come my doe? What and thou too?
Welcome Ladies.

10 *Mi. For.* I I sir *Iohn*, I see you will not faile,
Therefore you deserue far better then our loues,
But it grieues me for your late crosses.

Fal. This makes amends for all.
Come diuide me betweene you, each a hanch,
15 For my horns Ile bequeath them to your husbands,
Do *I* speake like *Horne* the hunter, ha?

Mis. Pa. God forgiue me, what noise is this?

There is a noise of hornes, the two women run away.

*Enter sir Hugh like a Satyre, and boyes drest like Fayries,
mistresse Quickly, like the Queene of Fayries: they sing a
song about him, and afterward speake.*

Quic: You Fayries that do haunt these shady groues,
Looke round about the wood if you can espie
A mortall that doth haunt our sacred round:
If such a one you can espy, giue him his due,
And leaue not till you pinch him blacke and blew:
Giue them their charge *Puck* ere they part away.

Sir Hu. Come hither *Peane*, goe to the countrie houses,
xvii. 25 And when you finde a slut that lies a sleepe,
And all her dishes foule, and roome vnswept,
With youre long nailes pinch her till she crie,

And sweare to mend her sluttish huswiferie.

Fai. I warrant you I will perform your will.

30 *Hu.* Where is *Pead*? Go and see where Brokers sleep,
And Foxe-eyed Seriants with their mase,
Goe laie the proctors in the street,
And pinch the lowsie Seriants face:
Spare none of these when they are a bed,
35 But such whose nose lookes plew and red.

Quic. Away begon, his mind fulfill,
And looke that none of you stand still.
Some do that thing, some do this,
All do something, none amis.

40 *Hir Hu.* I smell a man of middle earth.

Fal. God blesse me from that wealch Fairie.

Quic. Looke euery one about this round,
And if that any here be found,
For his presumption in this place,
45 Spare neither legge, arme, head, nor face.

Sir Hu. See I haue spied one by good luck,
His bodie man, his head a buck.

Fal. God send me good fortune now, and I care not.

Quick. Go strait, and do as I commaund,
XVII. 50 And take a Taper in your hand,
And set it to his fingers endes,
And if you see it him offends,
And that he starteth at the flame,
Then is he mortall, know his name:
55 If with an F. it doth begin,
Why then be shure he is full of sin.
About it then, and know the truth,
Of this same metamorphised youth.

Sir Hugh. Giue me the Tapers, I will try
60 And if that he loue venery.

They put the Tapers to his fingers, and he starts.

Sir Hu. It is right indeed, he is full of lecheries and iniquitie.

Quic. A little distant from him stand,
And euery one take hand in hand,
And compasse him within a ring,
65 First pinch him well, and after sing.

Here they pinch him, and sing about him, and the Doctor comes one way and steales away a boy in red. And Slender another way he takes a boy in greene: And Fenton steales misteris Anne, being in white. And a noyse of hunting is made within; and all the Fairies runne away. Falstaffe pulles off his bucks head, and rises vp. And enters M. Page, M. Ford, and their wiues, M. Shallow, sir Hugh.

Fal. Horne the hunter quoth you: am I ghost?
Sblood the Fairies hath made a ghost of me:
What hunting at this time at night?
He lay my life the mad prince of *Wales*
70 Is stealing his fathers Deare. How now who haue we here,
what is all *Windsor* stirring? Are you there?

Shal. God saue you sir *Iohn Falstaffe*.

Sir Hu. God plesse you sir *Iohn*, God plesse you.

Pa. Why how now sir *Iohn*, what a pair of horns in your xvii. 75
hand?

For. Those hornes he ment to place vpon my head,
And *M. Brooke* and he should be the men:
Why how now sir *Iohn*, why are you thus amazed?
We know the Fairies man that pinched you so,
80 Your throwing in the *Thames*, your beating well,
And what's to come sir *Iohn*, that can we tell.

Mi. Pa. Sir *Iohn* tis thus, your dishonest meanes
To call our credits into question,
Did make vs vndertake to our best,
85 To turn your leaud lust to a merry Iest.

Fal. Iest, tis well, haue I liued to these yeares
To be gulled now, now to be ridden?
Why then these were not *Fairies*?

Mis. Pa. No sir *Iohn* but boyes.

90 *Fal.* By the Lord I was twice or thrise in the mind
They were not, and yet the grosnesse
Of the fopperie perswaded me they were.
Well, and the fine wits of the Court heare this,
Thayle so whip me with their keene Iests,
95 That thayle melt me out like tallow,
Drop by drop out of my grease. Boyes!

Sir Hu. I trust me boyes Sir *Iohn*: and I was
Also a Fairie that did helpe to pinch you.

Fal. I, tis well I am your May-pole,
xvii. 100 You haue the start of mee,
Am I ridden too with a wealch goate?
With a peece of toasted cheese?

Sir Hu. Butter is better then cheese sir *Iohn*,
You are all butter, butter.

105 *For.* There is a further matter yet sir *Iohn*,
There's 20. pound you borrowed of M. *Brooke* sir *Iohn*,
And it must be paid to M. *Ford* sir *Iohn*.

Mi. For. Nay husband let that go to make amends,
Forgiue that sum, and so wee le all be friends.

110 *For.* Well here is my hand, all's forgiuen at last.

Fal. It hath cost me well,
I haue beene well pinched and washed.

Enter the Doctor.

Mi. Pa. Now M. Doctor, sonne I hope you are.

Doct. Sonne begar you be de ville voman,
115 Begar I tinck to marry metres *An*, and begar
Tis a whorson garson Iack boy.

Mis. Pa. How a boy?

Doct. I begar a boy.

Pa. Nay be not angry wife, *Ile* tell thee true,
120 It was my plot to deceiue thee so:
And by this time your daughter's married
To M. *Slender*, and see where he comes.

Enter Slender.

Now sonne *Slender*,
Where's your bride?

XVII. 125 *Slen.* Bride, by Gods lyd *I* thinke theres neuer a man in
the worell hath that crosse fortune that *I* haue: begod I could cry
for verie anger.

Page. Why whats the matter sonne *Slender*?

Slen. Sonne, nay by God *I* am none of your son.

130 *Pa.* No, why so?

Slen. Why so God saue me, tis a boy that I haue married.

Page. How, a boy? why did you mistake the word?

Slen. No neither, for *I* came to her in red as you bad me, and *I*
cried mum, and hee cried budget, so well as euer you heard, and
I 135 haue married him.

Sir Hugh. Ieshu M. *Slender*, cannot you see but marrie boyes?

Pa. O *I* am vext at hart, what shal I do?

Enter Fenton and Anne.

Mis. Pa. Here comes the man that hath deceiued vs all:
How now daughter, where haue you bin?

140 *An.* At Curch forsooth.

Pa. At Church, what haue you done there?

Fen. Married to me, nay sir neuer storme,
Tis done sir now, and cannot be vndone.

Ford: Ifaith M. *Page* neuer chafe your selfe,
145 She hath made her choise wheras her hart was fixt,
Then tis in vaine for you to storme or fret.

Fal. I am glad yet that your arrow hath glanced.

Mi. For. Come mistris *Page*, Ile be bold with you,
Tis pitie to part loue that is so true.

XVII. 150 *Mis. Pa.* Altho that I haue missed in my intent,
Yet I am glad my husbands match was crossed,
Here M. *Fenton*, take her, and God giue thee ioy.

Sir Hu. Come M. *Page*, you must needs agree.

Fo. I yfaith sir come, you see your wife is wel pleased:

155 *Pa.* I cannot tel, and yet my hart's well eased,
And yet it doth me good the Doctor missed.
Come hither *Fenton*, and come hither daughter,
Go too you might haue stai'd for my good will,
But since your choise is made of one you loue,
160 Here take her *Fenton*, & both happie proue.

Sir. Hu. I wil also dance & eate plums at your weddings.

For. All parties pleased, now let vs in to feast,
And laugh at *Slender* and the Doctors ieast.
He hath got the maiden, each of you a boy
165 To waite vpon you, so God giue you ioy,
And sir *Iohn Falstaffe* now shal you keep your word,
For *Brooke* this night shall lye with mistris *Ford*.

Exit omnes.

FINIS.



CRITICAL APPARATUS

(“Linenotes”).

SCENE I.

[28](#): *strait*] *straight* Halliwell.

[85](#): *yon*] *om*.

SCENE III.

[60](#): *were*] *we are*.

SCENE IV.

[24](#): *and*] *if*.

[26](#): *who*] *hoe*.

[31](#): *doore*] *the doore*.

SCENE V.

[5](#): *grant*] *grant*. Halliwell.

[15](#): *twice*] *but twice*.

[31](#): *kindnes*] *kindness* Halliwell.

[61](#): *melancholy?*] *melancholy*. Halliwell.

[93](#): *to you*] *t’e*.

[108](#): *Rrooke*] *Brooke*.

SCENE VI.

[7](#): *mistrisse*] *mistresse* Halliwell.

[8](#): *ho-*] *honesty*.

[13](#): *A*] *I* Halliwell.

[37](#): *let me*] *I*.

stands vpon] *that stands on*.

[52](#): *they could*] *could they*.

[58](#): *iealousie*] *iealous*.

[72](#): *bodie*] *booty*.

[75](#): *a the*] *ath the*.

[124](#): *And*] *If*.

SCENE VII.

[24](#): *me*] *be*.

[45](#): *a feasting*] *feasting*.

[46:](#) *bully*] *bully*. Halliwell.

[48:](#) *gesse*] *guests*.

patinces] *patients*.

SCENE XI.

[[Sc. xi.](#)] add *and Bardolfe*.

[7, 11:](#) *and*] *if*.

[49:](#) *euen*] om.

[80:](#) *I thus*] *thus I*

[88:](#) *at at*] *at*.

SCENE XII.

[[Sc. xii.](#)] *Page*] *Anne Page*.

[16:](#) [*Quic:*] from the Catchword.

[69:](#) *home*] om.

[98:](#) *Priest*] *Hugh*.

[115:](#) *By so*] *So*.

[120:](#) *Come*] om.

[123:](#) *A witch.*] For. *A witch*.

SCENE XIV.

[10:](#) *and Slender*] *Slender and*.

The number 10 refers to the last line of Scene XIII, carried over to the "Enter..." line in Scene XIV. In the original text, the two line 10's were printed on the same page.

[14:](#) ins. he speakes aboue.

SCENE XV.

[81:](#) *bene*] om.

SCENE XVII.

[59:](#) *Tapers*] *Torches*.

[79:](#) *so*] om.

[93:](#) *and*] *if*.

[101:](#) *ridden*] *written*.

[131:](#) *that*] om. Halliwell.

[138:](#) *the man*] *he*.

[140:](#) *Curch*] *Church* Halliwell.

[147:](#) *that*] *then* Halliwell.

[154:](#) *I yfaith*] *I faith*.

[161](#): also] om.

Sources

The Quarto editions of *The Merry Wives of Windsor* are described in the introduction to the play.

The general Preface ([e-text 23041](#)) discusses the 17th- and 18th-century editions in detail; the newer (19th-century) editions are simply listed by name. The following editions may appear in the Notes. All inset text is quoted from the Preface.

Folios:

F₁ 1623; F₂ (no date given); F₃ 1663; F₄ 1685.

“The five plays contained in this volume occur in the first Folio in the same order, and ... were there printed for the first time.”

Early editions:

Rowe 1709

Pope 1715

“Pope was the first to indicate the *place* of each new scene; as, for instance, *Tempest*, I. 1. ‘On a ship at sea.’ He also subdivided the scenes as given by the Folios and Rowe, making a fresh scene whenever a new character entered—an arrangement followed by Hanmer, Warburton, and Johnson. For convenience of reference to these editions, we have always recorded the commencement of Pope’s scenes.”

Theobald 1733

Hanmer (“Oxford edition”) 1744

Warburton 1747

Johnson 1765

Capell 1768; *also Capell’s annotated copy of F₂*

Steevens 1773

Malone 1790

Reed 1803

Later editions:

Singer, Knight, Cornwall, Collier, Phelps, Halliwell, Dyce, Staunton

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